

Lloyds Metals (LLOYDSME)

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Date: 08th May , 2024

To,
BSE Limited National Stock Exchange of India Limited
Corporate Services Department Corporate Communications Department
Phiroze Jeejeebhoy Towers, Exchange Plaza, Bandra Kurla Complex,
Dalal Street, Mumbai – 400001 Bandra (East), Mumbai - 400051
BSE Scrip Code: 512455 NSE Symbol: LLOYDSME

Sub: Transcripts of the Q 4 and F.Y. 2023-24 Earnings Conference Call conducted after the Meeting of Board of Directors of the Company

Ref: Disclosure under Regulation 46(2) of the Securities Exchange Board of India (Listing Obligations and Disclosure Requirements) Regulations, 2015, ("Listing Regulations 2015")

Dear Sir / Madam,

Pursuant to Regulation 46(2) of the Securities Exchange Board of India (Listing Obligations and Disclosure Requirements) Regulations, 2015, we give below the link to the Transcripts of the Q 4 and F.Y. 2023-24 Earnings Conference Call conducted after the Meeting of Board of Directors on 03rd May , 2024, hosted on the Company's website: www.lloyds.in
The audio recordings of the Earnings Call are also made available on the Company's website at: www.lloyds.in

Kindly take note of the same.

Thanking you,
Yours faithfully,
For Lloyds Metals and Energy Limited

Trushali Shah
Company Secretary

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"Lloyds Metals and Energy Limited
Q4 FY '24 Earnings Conference Call "

May 03, 2024

MANAGEMENT : MR. RAJESH GUPTA – MANAGING DIRECTOR ,
LLOYDS METALS AND ENERGY LIMITED
MR. RIYAZ SHAIKH – CHIEF FINANCIAL OFFICER ,
LLOYDS METALS AND ENERGY LIMITED
MODERATOR : MR. SIDDHARTH GADEKAR – EQUIRUS SECURITIES

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Moderator : Ladies and gentlemen, good day and welcome to the Lloyds Metals and Energy Limited Q 4 FY '24 Earnings Conference Call, hosted by Equirus Securities.

As a reminder, all participant lines will be in the listen -only mode and there will be an opportunity for you to ask questions after the presentation concludes . Should you need assistance during the call, please signal an operator by pressing star "*" then " 0" on your touch -tone phone. Please note that this conference is being recorded.

I now hand the conference over to Mr. Siddharth Gadekar from Equirus Securities . Thank you ,

and over to you, sir.

Siddharth Gadekar: Good afternoon everyone and thank you for joining us today. We at Equir us are pleased to host Lloyds 4Q FY '24 Results Conference Call .

We have with us today Mr. Rajesh Gupta, Managing Director; Mr. Riyaz Shaikh, the CFO .

Now I would like to invite Mr. Rajesh Gupta to initiate the proceedings for the results call. Thank you.

Rajesh Gupta: Good evening everyone , and good evening , Siddharth, and congratulations to you. Thank you for joining us all for our FY '24 Results Conference Call . I trust this message finds you well. I

hope each one of you has had the opportunity to thoroughly review the detailed earnings release we had shared on the exchange and on our official website.

The results that we are presenting today mark a significant milestone in our company's journey.

We have achieved a top line of Rs. 6,000 crore mark in revenue for this year. This achievement underscores the robust performance and growth we have experienced across all segments namely, sponge, iron ore and power.

FY '24 has been pivotal for us as we have surpassed Rs. 1,000 crores in profit after tax, achieving dispatches of Rs. 10 million tons of iron ore . Looking ahead, our road map to Rs. 55 million is going to be one of its kind in the Indian iron ore space. We shall be single location mine operating at this scale.

In terms of operation, our sponge segment has recorded its best yearly production as a result of the new Konsari plant, whereas the iron ore segment continues its strong performance and also produced Rs. 10 million is also a record. Additionally, our power segment has witnessed a satisfying traction.

In FY '24, we set forth a comprehensive road map that charts our course for the future. Our direction is clear, and our execution team is fully dedicated to realizing our goals. We have spent specific timelines looking at various issues and diligently working towards them.

Just to reiterate , again to give you a brief snapshot to we would provide you with a glimpse of our plans. We are moving towards forward integration in our operation to become a value -added Lloyds Metal and Energy Limited

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steel maker with a 4.2-million -ton steel capacity in total. This includes a good mix of 3-million -ton flat products and 1.2 million ton of long products. Expanding our iron ore production is central to our plans , with beneficiation playing a crucial role.

Furthermore, addressing logistics in steel making is vital and we plan to do so through two slurry pipelines to both our plants from the mine. This not only reduces freight costs but also aligns with our commitment to environmental sustainability. We believe that establishing such a capacity without resorting to debt will be a very big differentiating factor for us.

I will now hand it over to Mr. Riyaz Shaikh – our CFO, who will provide more details on our headline numbers and elaborate on our capital expenditure also. Over to you, Riyaz.

Riyaz Shaikh: Thank you, Rajesh ji. Good evening, esteemed participants. Firstly, I thank all for taking the time to attend the company's earnings Quarter 4 and FY '24 conference call, and also thank the Equirus team for hosting the conference

all.

So, to begin with today, I am delighted to share with you our operational performance for Quarter 4 FY '24. I will then provide an overview of our full year FY '24 results and updates on our capital expenditure and dividend declaration.

Starting with Quarter 4 FY '24, our revenue witnessed an impressive growth of 74% year-on-year, primarily driven by higher volumes in our sponge and iron ore segment. Our EBITDA also mirrored this robust performance, increasing by 153% year-on-year in Quarter 4 FY '24, with both iron ore and sponge segments contributing significantly.

Moving on to the full -year FY '24 Results :

We continue to experience strong growth with revenue soaring by 90% year -on-year , predominantly led by increased volumes in our iron ore segment. Similarly, our EBITDA for FY '24 witnessed a substantial growth of 101% year-on-year , once again with the iron ore and sponge segments playing pivotal roles.

Now, on the operational front :

Our iron ore production stood at a commendable 10 million tons, while our DRI segments saw production of 2,60,000 tons. Additionally, our power division achieved sales of 188 million units during the year. On a per ton basis, our EBITDA for iron ore stood at INR 2,375 for Quarter 4 and INR 1,710 for the full year.

Now regarding our capital expenditure :

In FY '24 we invested around INR 1,700 crores. We are pleased to inform you that we have been efficiently executing our CAPEX plan. The 85 kilometers slurry pipeline project is already 50% complete and our DRI and pellet projects are progressing at a breathtaking speed. We anticipate both projects to be completed by FY '25.

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Moving on to our balance sheet :

I am proud to announce that our company remains gross debt -free, and we envision it to remain so even after executing a CAPEX of INR 33 ,000 crores.

Dwelling deeper into our returns, you will find that our ROCE remains north of 50%. However, if we adjust the CWIP numbers, our ROCE exceeds 100%. This indicates that our CAPEX projects are strategically placed to be ROIC -accretive .

We have declared a dividend this year of 100% . That is Rs. 1 per share. Looking ahead, we are optimistic that our company will achieve major milestones in the coming years.

Now I will open the floor for any questions you may have. Thank you.

Moderator: Thank you very much. We will now begin the question-and- answer session. The first question is from the line of Nikun Lahoti, who is an individual investor. Please go ahead.

Nikun Lahoti: Sir, m y question is, you mentioned in a video that in 4 to 5 years you expect the revenue to be after the steel plant coming and full expansion capacity of Rs. 25 million tons, revenue of Rs.

35,000-40,000 crore. So, what could be like revenue break-up between iron ore and steel?

Riyaz Shaikh: What is the break -up of iron ore versus steel?

Nikun Lahoti: Yes, in future like of revenue, what could be expected?

Riyaz Shaikh: So, broad basis, the figure that you are mentioning probably was given in one of my interviews.

It is a simple calculation of the current rate of steel and iron ore. Approximately, our iron ore sales at that point of time will be around 6 million tons, sorry, 9 million tons, after our whole CAPEX plan is over. And steel pe llet will be around 6 million tons, and other semis will be around half a million tons, and steel will be around 4.2 million tons. So, if you total all of that would come to 40,000 crores or probably a little more than that . The percentage of revenue I would leave for you to calculate.

Moderator: We seem to have lost the line for Mr. Lahoti. We move to the next question. The next question is from the line of Nishant Bagrecha from InCred Equities . Please go ahead.

Nishant Bagrecha: So, I have a couple of questions. Firstly, when do we expect to rec

eive all the clearance to expand

our mine to around 55 million tons? That is my first question.

Rajesh Gupta: We expect this to, in various phases there are approvals such as the IBM plan approval and ultimately the EC. We expect all that to happen by the yearend 2024-25.

Nishant Bagrecha: And sir, secondly, so just wanted to check on the volume outlook. So, how should we look at the volumes in FY '25, assuming we receive EC by the end of calendar year '24 ? And so can we see 15 -16 million tons volumes in FY '25 and then 25 million tons in '26?

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Riyaz Shaikh: As Mr. Gupta just mentioned, we are expecting clearance by the year -end. That is mostly in the last quarter of the yearend. So, we are as such projecting of around 12 to 13 million tons in this year. 10 million is for sure and if the approvals are in place, which we are expecting, so pro -rata accordingly we should be getting around 3 to 4 million additional. So, around 13 million is what we are expecting to be doing in this financial year.

Nishant Bagrecha: So, I have one more question. So, w e have taken an enabling resolution for the QIP. So, w hen do we expect to complete the process ? And again, how much are promoters going to infuse? Any color on that?

Riyaz Shaikh: The process of the same is on. As you said, we have just got a clearance last week from the shareholders. The process is on and when everything is crystallized, we should be coming back to you.

Rajesh Gupta: We are also planning that the dilution by the promoters will not be to a very large extent. There will be some dilution but not to the full extent. The promoters would be investing something. The plans are not yet freezed .

Nishant Bagrecha: And sir, last one, a bookkeeping question. Like, h ow much incentives are we likely to receive each year starting from FY '25 to FY '29? And how would the incentive structure look beyond FY '29?

Rajesh Gupta: Incentives?

Nishant Bagrecha: Yes.

Rajesh Gupta: From the state government?

Nishant Bagrecha: Yes, sir, from the state government .

Rajesh Gupta: So, these incentives are on capital basis and actually when we start the processes. So , by that time, we will have FY '25, which is the current year, we would not have much of the plans operational. We will all start operating in the last quarter as predicted. So, there will not be any major incentives. Apart from what is balanced from previous periods, we are not anticipating to

receive much incentives for FY '25. Post that, the figures are going to be approximately based on turnover et cetera and various rules. The cap that we have got is 150% of the CAPEX for one of the plants and 110% for the other plant. And at the end of the period, say 2030-31, it will be 2,500 crores approximate. So, it is going to be a phased manner of incentives.

Moderator: Thank you. The next question is from the line of Parthiv Shah from Tracom. Please go ahead.

Parthiv Shah: Sir, I just had a query on one of your slides, Slide # 19, where you mentioned the year-wise iron ore output. And it mentions that first full-year post all approvals, year one, 25 million tons, mine DSO and then subsequently year 2, year 3, year 4 onwards, you have the BHQ element. So, sir, I just want to understand, when we talk of a statistical mining capacity of 55 million tons, is that Lloyds Metal and Energy Limited

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like total, saleable iron ore output, or out of that in the BHQ share, not all will be saleable? How to look at it?

Rajesh Gupta: At the peak our iron ore mining would be 55 million tons, with 10 million tons of DSO, and 45 million tons of BHQ. The BHQ would be beneficiate down to 15 million tons. So, 10 plus 15, 25 million tons would be the usable or sellable ore that we have at the end of the period. The beneficiation will be done

through three plants, the processes are on right now to put up these plants. The investments and the planning and the testing etc. started, and the pilot plant is on, so that the first beneficiation plant we hope to have in '27-'28.

Parthiv Shah: And sir, in terms of ramping up the ore capacity, so you mentioned the FY '25, probably you are looking at 12 to 13 million tons, right? So, then, FY '26, '27, '28, any such roadmap you can give that, till the BHQ thing is up and running and proven....

Rajesh Gupta: 25 million tons EC once approved and received. It would be producing 25 million tons of usable ore on that time. Depending on the beneficiation, the usable ore would have a mix of direct sales ore as well as beneficiated ore, which is there in the slide that you are talking about.

Parthiv Shah: And sir, regarding the current fines, so are you, I am assuming you are selling the current fines in the market right now, or maybe you are providing to some pellet players till your pellet plant comes?

Rajesh Gupta: So, we are selling all of our fines to pellet or sinter plant users. That includes a pellet plant. I mean, that's what we don't have our own pellet plant, as of now. That will happen next year, where we will use some of the fines. Does that answer your question, or did I miss some nuance of the question?

Parthiv Shah: Yes. You had some trading agreement with some pellet producer.

Rajesh Gupta: So, we do have an agreement to sell fines to MRPPL, a company in Goa, which is one of the oldest pellet plants in India, in the world in fact, and all the iron ore is being purchased by them from us. So, all their ore were consumed from our mine. That's given stability of ore, all the exports and some quantities are being purchased by us back.

This is giving us two advantages. One is it ties up a little small chunk of our iron ore sales.

Number two, it also gives us the experience to do pellet seed marketing. We have established a brand called LMELPEL, and we hope to be selling that high-end pellets used for gas based DRI which is called DR Pellets to the MENA market particularly over the next year.

Parthiv Shah: Sir, just for my simplistic understanding, your quality of pellets, how close will it be to Vale pellets?

Rajesh Gupta: Vale pellets, so there are two stages to this answer. Right now we are not beneficiating our own. We are designing it and using it. We have very small quantity of 66% Fe material, which we are Lloyds Metal and Energy Limited

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using to make these pellets in MRPPL. Around 1.5 million tons, what maximum we can sell, whatever we require for export, we are giving that to him. That's number one.

So, the pellets are, the quality that MRPPL is making is nearly equal to that of Vale. I would say in a range from 0 to 100, it would be in the range of 85 to 90 is how near we are to Vale.

When we go to our own pellet plant, the same schedule will arise till our beneficiation plant starts. Once the beneficiation plant starts, our ore will get upgraded to around 66-67% Fe and at that point of time, our pellets that we make in our own plant or in any other plant, in our plant or in MRPPL would be equal to Vale quality. Obtain similar kind of premium, Vale, like you know, uses 100% beneficial ore only. So, we are able to achieve that quality without beneficiating, which is a rarity in itself in today's iron ore scenario.

Parthiv Shah: Valid point, sir. Sir, you have mentioned in your PPT that along with iron ore you also had coal. Now, am I assuming correct? You don't have any coal mine right now, right? So, your coal sourcing will come from there and how will you manage the cost of coal?

Rajesh Gupta: So, coal we are buying for our DRI plant either through auction route from WCL or importing

it. And later on we start our blast furnaces ,

the coking coal will be imported.

Parthiv Shah: Do you have any plans to bid for any coal mines in the country?

Rajesh Gupta: We haven't bid for any coal mine at the moment.

Parthiv Shah: Sir, just lastly regarding your value-added steel and talks of the 4.2 million tons per annum steel plant, flats and logs involved, just to understand, you will have better grip on your numbers because of your current backward integration nature, the type of quality of the ore that you have and your future plans and everything. So, you know, if currently say Tata Steel domestic EBITDA by ton is like the benchmark in terms of they can deliver in a good cycle, even a Rs. 20,000 EBITDA by ton, what are you expecting? What sort of EBITDA by ton in a good cycle your plant will be able to deliver?

Rajesh Gupta: Sir, you very correctly mentioned about our cost control, especially without any premium. So, our mines will fetch no premiums royalty till 2057, which is a big differentiator from every other steel maker in the country today except one. Apart from that, we are not going to have, so we have one or two players will only be left with no premium mines in 2032, '31-'32. That will further add to our competitiveness compared to every other steel maker.

Our iron ore is well stabilized. We have done good surveys and good resource calculations and exploration, and we are confident that the qualities are what I just mentioned, especially after beneficiation. For the 4.2 million tons, approximately 15 million tons of pipeline route will be used. So, though the plants are not at the pit head, for all practical purposes, the cost of transportation of iron ore is as good as that because of the pipeline route, and of course it also makes it greener. Again, with the beneficiated ore, our iron ore will be very high quality, lesser coke also greener.

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Apart from this is our IPS root. Maharashtra is one state which gives a very robust investment incentive. Our average incentive between the two plants is around 125%, which is the cap over 12 years. So, approximately, like I mentioned earlier, 2000 to 2005, the growth is flowing back to us once that peak flow happens.

So, with all of this, we believe that on the cost front, we should be amongst the most competitive players, not only in India, but in the world. Of course, only time can tell, but we are very confident of our numbers.

Regarding EBITDA, steel is a cyclical business. Between March and April, the price has gone up by Rs. 2,500 to Rs. 3,000.

Why? Difficult to answer. So, it's a cyclical business. I cannot answer about what will be the EBITDA numbers per se. But we believe that because of all this, the EBITDA numbers will always be stronger than every other steel company in India.

Parthiv Shah: One more point regarding the choking of the current infrastructure. As I understand, with only 10 million tons of iron ore mining, all the connecting roads and whatever rail infrastructure you can use are highly choked up. So, now we are talking of ramping up our ore mining. How supportive has the government been in terms of giving you both the road and the rail infrastructure or you are looking to develop the roads on your own? What is the thought process in that? Because I hear from every mining company that mining output is not an issue, but the logistics is a nightmare in our country. So, how are you tackling that challenge?

Rajesh Gupta: So, I always say one thing, my friend, that steel is more of a logistics game than steel itself. For logistics out of the mine, we are developing our mines to the extent of, you know, every year we are spending up to Rs 100-150 crore to develop the roads and maintain the roads at our end, outside the mine also, up to the stockyard and up to the railway siding. This has ensured that we have been able

to ramp up from half a million-ton dispatched in '21-'22 to '23-'24, that is 2.5 years, to 10 million ton. Our monthly averages have gone up to a run rate of around 18 to 20 million tons also in some of these months. In March, we produced very less iron ore because of reaching the capacity of 10 million tons. So, I do not think that to achieve 10 million tons we were ever choked up, to use your word. Railway facilities from the three sidings that we are using right now is quite adequate to all parts of the country. We have also over a period developed a lot of road network outside the state also. So, we are sending our material from the mine area to Raigarh, Raipur, even Orissa now in some cases, to West Bengal in some cases by road, taking advantage of incoming coal that comes in for various reasons or other inputs that are coming from the port. So, we are continuously on the watch out for looking at best logistics practices and it is a very, very important part of our business. I think that answers your questions.

Parthiv Shah: Yes, sir. Thank you very much. Answers all my questions.

Moderator: Thank you. The next question is from the line of Ritwik Sheth from One Up Financial. Please go ahead.

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Ritwik Sheth: Sir, just two questions from my end. Sir, what is the capacity of the slurry pipeline when it will completely be commissioned?

Rajesh Gupta: So, we have two pipelines planned. One is the pipeline from the mine or Hedri to our Konsari plant, both being in the district of Gadchiroli. That's a 85-kilometer pipeline with a 10 million ton capacity. That pipeline has two grinding units, 5 million ton each. The first one will be commissioned in December-January and the second grinding unit will be commissioned next year. Both these grinding units are in sync with the pellet plant. So, at the end of that period, we would be transporting 10 million tons on this pipeline, 85 kilometers.

The other pipeline that we have planned is a 5-million-ton pipeline from Hedri again to our Ghughus plant. This is in Chandrapur. The length of this pipeline is 185 kilometers. The survey of this pipeline has started, and we are applying for permission as we speak and that is a little bit further down the line, maybe by March '28-'29. I am getting confused. March '28 is when that pipeline will be ready, again linked with the pellet plant in that plant, in that location.

So, a total of 15 million tons will be transported by pipeline out of the 25 million tons sellable product that we will be doing, leaving 10 million tons to be transported by other means, which is equal to what we are doing right now. So, in the long run, we are very confident of achieving our logistic needs.

Ritwik Sheth: And what would be the approximate logistic cost savings when both these pipelines will be commissioned?

Rajesh Gupta: So, in the first plant, around Rs. 700 to Rs. 800. In the second plant, around Rs. 1,100 to Rs. 1,200 rupees.

Ritwik Sheth: And sir, my next question is regarding the CAPEX that we are undergoing. Can you tell us what is the pending CAPEX for all the expansion projects and when are these projects expected to be completed?

Rajesh Gupta: It's a very long, drawn out question. Long run out answer because the CAPEX plan is very, very extensive. Let me go location wise. The total CAPEX plan that we have is around Rs. 33,000 crore. The first location that I will talk about is Chandrapur, which is our first plant. There we are in the first phase, we are doing 2 DRI units, 2 into 500 DRI units and a 2 into 30-megawatt power plant. The power plant is mostly from waste product. This should be ready by March '25. In the same location, 1.5 years down the line, we will go in for a steel plant. A steel plant will envisage one blast furnace, two arc furnaces, casters, and

two rolling mills to produce 1.2 million

tons of wire rod product. The total plant expansion in this is around Rs. 6,300 crore with both these phases put together.

The third phase is to this plant which is the pellet plant that we just talked about earlier with the pipeline. That pellet plant is 4 million tons. That 4 million tons would be utilized 2 million tons for the steel plant in this location and 2 million tons to sell to other steel plants next door to us.

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Even the pellet plant and the pipeline, they will become more viable. And all this put together, Rs. 6,300 crore, Rs. 6,400 crore. And that is location number 1.

Location number 2 is Konsari, which is in the district of Gadchiroli. In that location, we have started a DRI unit, 2 into 100, 2 into 95-ton DRI unit in a period of around 13 months after we got the EC clearance for that. Subsequently, now we are constructing the first pellet plant. The long-term plan of this is 2x4 million-ton pellet plant.

The last one is BOF based flat product mill and downstream for making hot rolled galvanized coils and cold rolled galvanized coils. Out of the two pellet plants, we already have one pellet plant under construction along with the pipeline. That should be ready again by March '25, what I mentioned earlier, similar to the DRI unit.

And the second pellet plant should be ready one year after that by June '26. And the steel plant targeted by September '28 to March '29. The total investment in this location along with the slurry pipeline that I earlier mentioned is around Rs. 21,000 crore. The permission for this steel plant is yet to be applied. All of the permissions are with us.

The third location is our mine.

Ritwik Sheth: Sir, just to interrupt, the blast furnace flat product is the 3 million tons.

Rajesh Gupta: Yes. The third location is the mine, where we right now are mining 10 million tons. We will upgrade that to 55 million tons, like I mentioned earlier, at an investment cost of around Rs. 800 crore. This investment includes basically the basic infrastructure and like I said, roads, etc., everything. Apart from that, we have a plant next to this, which is already being constructed, as we speak, for the grinding unit of the pipeline. But apart from those grinding units of the pipeline, we will be putting up 3 beneficiation plants with a throughput of 15 million tons each and an

output of 5 million tons each. That is around Rs. 5,000 crore investment. The total investment all put together is around Rs. 33,000 crore. And again, what Mr. Riyaz said, we have spent Rs. 1,700 crore in the last two years. And right now, the expansion plans are very, very on and full swing.

Moderator: Thank you. The next question is from Abhas Punjani from InCred Equities . Please go ahead.

Abhas Punjani: I have a couple of questions regarding the ore. So, what will be the royalty rates for the low - grade ore?

Riyaz Shaikh: Royalty for low -grade.

Rajesh Gupta: So, when we are talking about low -grade ore, we are talking about the BHQ?

Abhas Punjani: Yes.

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Rajesh Gupta: Currently the BHQ, the Indian IBM rules give iron ore grade up to 45%. This is 35%. So, if I take the pro rate up from 45 to 35, the royalty will be around Rs. 45 a ton for that ore.

Abhas Punjani: So, what will be the approximately cost of mining?

Rajesh Gupta: The mining cost including this royalty, the mining cost itself and the beneficiation cost would be in the same range that we have right now, which is around Rs. 2,500.

Moderator: Thank you. The next question is from the line of Anand Kumar , who is an individual investor.

Anand Kumar: Very nice to see the presentation from you, sir . Having said that particular thing, I think I see a lot of dynamism in the organization

on. For example, in the last PPT, we saw only one pipeline of 89 kilometers. Now we see another pipeline that is coming up on that.

Rajesh Gupta: That pipeline will be under construction

Anand Kumar: So, that 's very good, sir. So, there is a lot of dynamism that is coming on that one and execution is going on very well. So , the first question related is that what would be the savings with the current DRI plant operation when this pipeline is complete?

Rajesh Gupta: So, like you said , we will be saving Rs. 1,300 a ton. We use 1.8 metric ton of iron ore. So, 1.8 into 1,100 is 3,500.

Anand Kumar: It's approximately 10% is what we are going to get more efficient with respect to...

Rajesh Gupta: Yes, logistics is always a very, very big cost in our business.

Anand Kumar: The second question is that when we recently completed one DRI plant I think few quarters back, are we getting any incentive from the Maharashtra government on that one or there is no incentive for that?

Rajesh Gupta: The incentives are due . We are not yet claiming it for some strategic reasons . The incentives are due, but we are not claiming it.

Anand Kumar: So, that is also covered under that one. Now, are we going to get incentives for this slurry pipe or we are not going to get incentives for this slurry pipe investment?

Riyaz Shaikh: Yes. All our capital ...

Anand Kumar: We are going to get.

Riyaz Shaikh: Yes, will be applicable for incentives.

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Anand Kumar: We are going to get that one. The second one question, sir, previously, you were talking about power plant expansion. If you really look at your previous presentation, you spoke about expanding the power generation to only 90 Megawatt more or something like that.

Rajesh Gupta: I am sorry, my feel on investment, I missed out on power. My apologies. All the plants the power plants will be captive in the first location , it will be around 150 Megawatts and the other location will be around 300 Megawatt. Hedry will not be captive. That will be buying power from outside.

Anand Kumar: But sir, is it right to go for the , it is going to be coal -based power generation, right , sir? It would be coal -based power generation, right , sir?

Rajesh Gupta: Yes, I was just coming to that . Out of 450 Megawatt , around 300 Megawatt we envisage to be waste heat recovery or waste coal recovery, waste products recovery basically, and around 150 Megawatt would be direct coal -based thermal power.

Anand Kumar: Sir, is there any thought about using solar power for generating and using locally? Just like Godavari power had done that particular thing substantially in the recent past and they saved a lot of money on that.

Rajesh Gupta: The plans are not yet frozen. We are looking at investing through the captive route that is available in the market. We are looking at investing for some solar power in that route. The plans are not yet frozen. We are looking at it very actively.

Anand Kumar: I think that would be important because otherwise you establish the whole plant and after that again we will have to go green. So, you get into solar, it would be unnecessarily a power plant , we will have to keep it idle on that one. So, that was the question that was there .

Rajesh Gupta: If the power is not there, there is no power plant. So, in the long run, we envisage that to be totally solar. We hope to get there very shortly.

Anand Kumar: Sir, it would be very helpful. What are the projects which are going to become on by the end of this year? If some kind of information is provided, that would be good. I know things are happening at a break-neck speed, but as an investor is not being aware about what is happening on that one, it would be helpful if you can actually put a slide saying that what is expected to happen by the end of the year and next

year. So, that we have some estimates what is happening further on that.

Rajesh Gupta: So, I have mentioned earlier, this year '24-'25, we should have the two DRI plants ready.

Anand Kumar: That is 0.36 MT.

Rajesh Gupta: 0.36 million tons ready. And we will have the associated power plant ready. And we will have one pellet plant ready and with that one pipeline for that. And the mine should be ready to produce 25 million tons.

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Anand Kumar: And out of this pellet plant, what are we going to produce 4 million tons one? That would also be supporting the DRI plant, sir, or is it going to be completely sold out differently?

Rajesh Gupta: So, that's a call that the market, because this first, we have been producing for the first 1.5 years, we have been producing around 800,000, 650,000 tons of DRI. We will have the option during this period because we will be selling the product out. So, depending on the market requirement, we can be flexible either DRI or pellet, I mean either iron ore DRI or pellet-based DRI.

Anand Kumar: So, that's going to depend upon that cost economics at that point of time. Is my understanding right, sir? It depends upon that market pricing at that point of time.

Rajesh Gupta: On the market pricing, because at that time, I am not consuming our own DRI. Then our results, our thought process will be much more crystal clear.

Anand Kumar: The other one that is another question that I have is that previously you were talking about increasing the mining capacity by 20%, that is 10 million to 12 million, because you need very little EC clearance of process for that.

Rajesh Gupta: I have talked about a year back or so, or around nine months back, I remember. When we went into the detailing of that process, we realized that we do save on the public hearing process, but the other processes of the approval are very, very same. So, we decided to go in for the big bang approach rather than small approach of 20%, 20% and then the beneficiation plan. And also we got very encouraging results from the beneficiation studies that we have carried out. We also produced, I have not produced, I have set up our pilot plant for the beneficiation in record time. So, with all that on the beneficiation, we decided to go the big bang way.

Anand Kumar: So, that means this year mining capacity is going to be 10 million is what we should be. That's what, yes.

Rajesh Gupta: Actually, it depends very much on when exactly we get it, because after that we will have to do it pro rata. So, let us see how it works out.

Anand Kumar: But anyway, even if you get it by March, I think it would be extraordinary speed for getting the EC clearance. I would definitely look forward to hearing the positive news on that.

Riyaz Shaikh: 10 million would be the minimum. Anything over and above that would be based on approvals

Moderator: Thank you very much. That was the last question in the queue. I would now like to hand the conference back to the management team for closing comments.

Rajesh Gupta: So, thank you everybody for all the very interesting questions and we hope we have been able to be lucid in the answers and our Investment Relations desk will always be open for any other questions. Thank you.

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Moderator: Thank you very much. On behalf of Equirus Securities, that concludes the conference. Thank you for joining us, ladies and gentlemen. You may now disconnect your lines.

Call: Aug 2024

Date: 05th August , 2024

To,
BSE Limited National Stock Exchange of India Limited
Corporate Services Department Corporate Communications Department
Phiroze Jeejeebhoy Towers, Exchange Plaza, Bandra Kurla Complex,
Dalal Street, Mumbai – 400001 Bandra (East), Mumbai - 400051
BSE Scrip Code: 512455 NSE Symbol: LLOYDSME

Sub: Transcripts of the Q 1 and F.Y. 2024 -25 Earnings Conference Call conducted after the Meeting of Board of Directors of the Company

Ref: Disclosure under Regulation 46(2) of the Securities Exchange Board of India (Listing Obligations and Disclosure Requirements) Regulations, 2015, ("Listing Regulations 2015")

Dear Sir / Madam,

Pursuant to Regulation 46(2) of the Securities Exchange Board of India (Listing Obligations and Disclosure Requirements) Regulations, 2015, we give below the link to the Transcripts of the Q 1 and F.Y. 2024 -25 Earnings Conference Call conducted after the Meeting of Board of Directors on 31st July, 2024, hosted on the Company's website: www.lloyds.in
The audio recordings of the Earnings Call are also made available on the Company's website at: www.lloyds.in

Kindly take note of the same.

Thanking you,
Yours faithfully,
For Lloyds Metals and Energy Limited

Trushali Shah
Company Secretary
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"Lloyds Metals and Energy Limited
Q1 FY'25 Earnings Conference Call"
July 31 , 2024

MANAGEMENT : MR. RAJESH GUPTA – MANAGING DIRECTOR – LLOYD
METAL AND ENERGY LIMITED
MR. RIYAZ SHAIKH – CHIEF FINANCIAL OFFICER –
LLOYD METAL AND ENERGY LIMITED

MODERATOR : MR. ASHUTOSH SOMANI – JM FINANCIAL

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July 31 , 2024
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Moderator: Ladies and gentlemen, good day and welcome to Lloyds Metal & Energy Limited Q1 FY25 Earnings Conference Call hosted by JM Financial. As a reminder, all participant lines will be in the listen -only mode and there will be an opportunity for you to ask questions after the presentation concludes. Should you need assistance during the conference call, please signal an

operator by pressing the star then zero on your touch-tone phone. Please note that this conference is being recorded.

I now hand the conference over to Mr. Ashutosh Somani. Thank you and over to you, sir.

Ashutosh Somani: Yes, thanks operator and welcome everyone to the call. I will first thank Lloyds Metals & Energy for giving JM Financial the opportunity to host today's call. Without much ado, I will hand the call over to Mr. Rajesh Gupta, MD, Lloyds Metals & Energy. Over to you, sir.

Rajesh Gupta: Good afternoon, everybody. Greetings to all the investors present on the conference call and a very special thanks to Ashutosh and the JM Financial team for hosting this call. The quarterly results of our company were very satisfying and robust and the growth story continues both in terms of operational and financial performance.

We reported our best ever quarterly iron ore production as well as best ever quarterly DRI production. This was matched by highest ever quarterly revenue as well as quarterly profit. This quarter, the highlight also was the fundraising where we raised nearly \$500 million over two issues, the QIP issue as well as the preference issue. The preference issue is still ongoing and should get completed very shortly. This fundraise will ensure that our capex program remains undisrupted through the cycle that we had planned over the next 3-4 years.

On the capex front, the projects are well executed and progressing as expected or maybe even better. The slurry pipeline is nearly over and testing is about to begin in the next 20-30 days as soon as the rains subside a little bit. The pellet plant is well on track and the DRI doubling capacity is also on schedule in Chandrapur.

Regarding the market scenario, the iron ore market demand in India remains buoyant, pricing being volatile seasonally. The structural demand of steel, therefore iron ore and therefore the metal space is very strong and we remain in a firm position as we speak. That's it from my side and I would now like to hand over to our CFO, Mr. Riyaz Shaikh, who will go into more details of the performance of the company. Over to you, Riyaz.

Riyaz Shaikh: Thank you, Rajeshji. Good afternoon, everyone. Thank you for joining us today. I am delighted to share with you our highest ever quarterly performance both operationally and financially for Q1 FY25. Our revenue of INR 2,423 crores for Q1 FY25 saw a remarkable 23% Y-o-Y increase driven by higher sponge iron and iron ore volumes. Notably, Q1 FY25 iron ore volumes were the highest ever recorded in the single quarter for the company.

On the realisation front, we witnessed encouraging Y-o-Y growth. Sponge iron too recorded significant volume increase, the highest ever, both Y-o-Y and QoQ. Our EBITDA performance mirrored our revenue growth with a substantial 32% year-over-year increase in Q1 FY25. This robust performance was primarily led by our iron ore and sponge iron segment, supported by Lloyd Metal and Energy Limited

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higher margins. During FY24, we incurred a capital expenditure of INR 1690 crores and in Q1 FY25 alone, we have invested INR 598 crores. These investments reflect our commitment to sustainable growth and operational efficiency.

Let me provide some key highlights. Iron ore production for Q1 FY25 stood at 4 million tons. Dispatches were at 3.6 million tons. Realisation for Q1 FY25 was INR 5710 on average, a 7% Y-o-Y growth

h. EBITDA per ton for Q1 FY25 was INR 1848, up 23% Y-o-Y.

DRI and Power. The DRI segment reported a Q1 FY25 production of 76,704 tons, a 16% Y-o-Y increase. Realisation for the DRI segment remained marginally muted Y-o-Y. The Power segment reported a steady performance with a 5% Y-o-Y increase in sales for Q1 FY25. I want to extend my gratitude to the entire Lloyds Metals team for their hard work and dedication, which has enabled us to achieve these exceptional results.

We remain focused on delivering sustained growth and value for our shareholders. Thank you for your continued support. We look forward to discussing our performance in more detail during this call.

Moderator: The first question is from the line of Parthiv from Anand Rat hi Please go ahead.

Parthiv: I just wanted to know the status of the increase in this mining capacity, which you are planning to take from the current 10 million tons. And what is the timeline when the new production would come on stream? And if you can throw some light on what kind of numbers are you looking at once these mines are up and running, as far as your EBITDA numbers are concerned?

Rajesh Gupta: The mining capacity enhancement has three steps. There are two steps to the approval process. One is the IBM approval for the mining plan, since it is a very major size expansion. And that process is over and we got the IBM plan approved by them. The EC clearance is the next step. We are under process for that and should be in line by, I would say by January or so.

Regarding the production process itself, as we speak, we are enhancing the screening grinding capacity as well as the mobile equipment, also electrifying most of the new equipment, so that as soon as we get the approvals, we should be up and running with the total capacity. Like you

saw, we have done 4 million tons in this quarter. So, if you extrapolate it, it comes to 16 million

tons.

By the time the approvals come, we should be up and running with the requisite monthly capacity. And then pro rata, we will be able to do as required for the year.

Parthiv: So, sir, is my understanding correct that if all the approvals come in, say, by mid to end of January, then it will only be two months of the new capacity on screen? So, last year, you have already done like 10 million tons. On a pro rata, it will be...

Rajesh Gupta: By that time, we should have achieved 10 million tons. So the next two months will be around 20% of another 5 -6 million tons is what we hope to do. But that's obviously not given, it depends on so many other factors, primarily being the final approval coming in. Okay.

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Parthiv: So, this new approval is between the iron ore and BHQ, right? So, what will be the mix of that going forward between iron ore and BHQ?

Rajesh Gupta: Mining approval is for , 55 million tons. And we will limit our mining to 25 million tons in the first year only for iron ore , dispatch of 25 million tons of iron ore in the first full year. And subsequently, as we speak, the beneficiation plan, putting up that process is going on, including environment approvals and land acquisition and all that. And of course , the engineering, the pilot plant, all that of beneficiation is also ready. So, every year we will add one -one module of the beneficiation plan of input of 15 million tons and output of 5 million tons, capping the total output at 25 million tons over the life of the mine.

Parthiv: Got it, sir. And what about the steel facility which you are planning to put in say by FY26-27, what is the progress on that, sir?

Rajesh Gupta: Like I clarified earlier, in 24 -25, we should be up and running with the first pellet plant and the slurry pipeline to go with it, as well as to double our DR I capacity to 700,000 tons and the pellet plant would be 4 million tons. That should be up and running by the

end of this financial year.

Next financial year 25-26, we hope to start the second pellet plant of another 4 million tons and the 1.2 million steel plant would be June to September of 2026.

Parthiv: Okay, sir. So, just one last question. So, just considering, your pellet plant will be coming up in phases in FY25 and FY 26, what is the kind of delta you are expecting from these plants, if it's possible to quantify the numbers?

Rajesh Gupta: Given the, quality of the iron ore as well as the pipeline that would be in place by that time, along with the pellet plant, we expect the minimum delta to be around INR 1200 to INR 1500 per ton.

Parthiv: Thank you so much for your answer, sir.

Moderator: Thank you. The next question is from the line of Siddharth Gadekar from Equirus Capital . Please go ahead.

Siddharth Gadekar Hi, sir. Good evening. So, my first question is on the realizations. If I look at the steel mint prices, our prices remain similar to the last quarter but we have seen a sharp drop in realizations of around INR 500 on the iron ore side. What explains the drop in realizations?

Rajesh Gupta: From last quarter to this quarter?

Siddharth Gadekar: Yes.

Rajesh Gupta: From Q4 to Q1, the realization difference would be primarily because our lump production was maximum last quarter. Being the end of the year, we were focusing on extracting the maximum lump, and this year it has been a normal mix of around 18%-20% lump and balance is fines. So, that is why the drop is there. The price has come down in the Q1 by INR 500-INR 600 in fine s, plus the factor of this lump lesser.

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Siddharth Gadekar: Okay. So, secondly, in terms of BHQ facility, we were supposed to do some trials in April to June. Have we got any results on that?

Rajesh Gupta: So, the pilot plant has been commissioned, and the results are as expected. It is around 65%-66% FE we are getting. On a consistent basis, 67% we have reached, and the yield of that material is around 38%-40%.

Siddharth Gadekar: So, our first beneficiation plan should come online by FY27. Is that understanding, correct?

Rajesh Gupta: Yes.

Siddharth Gadekar: So, thirdly, in terms of our capex for the next two, how should we look at the capex numbers?

Riyaz Shaikh: In this year, first quarter, we have done around INR 598 crores . What we have planned with all these projects to be completing, we should be doing INR 2,700 crores more in the next nine months. So, that should be taking it at around INR3,300 crores in this year and around INR6,500-INR7,000 crores in the next year for the capex .

Siddharth Gadekar: And lastly, on the CSR expenses, have we front loaded for the entire CSR expenses this quarter?

Rajesh Gupta: Last year, the CSR expenses for the whole year was around INR 65 crores . This year, the first quarter itself has seen a big jump because we have started a new school, completed one school, completed the garment factories and many other things. So, we have done around INR 68 crores in the very first quarter of CSR expenses.

The capital nature of the CSR has been completed, two schools, one hospital and one garment factory. These are the big- ticket items which have been completed, and this will help the community at large over the next 50 years, obviously.

Siddharth Gadekar: So, how should we look at the CSR expenses for the entire year then, going ahead?

Rajesh Gupta: It will be now going back to the INR7-INR 8 crores per quarter.

Siddharth Gadekar: Okay, got it. That's it from my side. Thank you.

Moderator: Thank you. The next question is from the line of Amui Gavre , an individual investor. Please go ahead.

Amui Gavre: Congratulations on a good set of numbers. I just have one question, sir. Can the company maintain the debt-free status even after doing the INR 33,000 crores capex ?

Rajesh Gupta: Yes. As you might

be aware, we have just done a fundraise also of a QIP of INR 1,200 crores , and we are also in the process of doing a preferential warrant issue, which is around INR 2,960 crores. So, that would be around INR 4,200 crores of fundraising via equity. This is what we had planned. The company intends to remain debt -free for all the projects. This fundraise will be used for any shortfalls, if any, it would be used for the projects.

Amui Gavre: Okay, Thank you, sir. That's from my side.

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Moderator: Thank you. The next question is from the line of Nikunj Lahoti, an individual investor. Please go ahead.

Nikunj Lahoti: Sir, the company has a mine in Surjagarh. Does the company have more mines or wish to plan to build more mines?

Rajesh Gupta: As of now, there have been no such opportunities where we have been very excited.

Nikunj Lahoti: And, sir, how much is the freight cost per ton for iron ore?

Rajesh Gupta: Freight cost up to our siding is around INR 11,00 per ton . Our total freight cost is INR 1,600 because much of our material we are transporting up to the gate of the customers. So the average freight cost has been around INR1,600 per ton .

Nikunj Lahoti: How much after starting of slurry pipeline, how much do you expect to get it lower?

Rajesh Gupta: On an average, I would say around INR 800-INR 900 per ton would be reduced.

Nikunj Lahoti: Thank you, sir.

Moderator: The next question is from the line of Rajesh Majumdar from B &K Securities. Please go ahead.

Rajesh Majumdar: Yes, sir. Thank you so much for the opportunity. This is my first time in this call. So I just want to know some broad answers from you. As to this new capacity that we have post expansion, what is the royalty on these new mines? And do you apprehend any increase in the royalty structure given the fact that, the court has recently allowed that states can charge extra royalty on mining? That was my first question.

Rajesh Gupta: So the royalty would continue to remain the same around 19.8% of the average sales price, which includes DMT and NMET. The current court case which is still being studied, it's a 300-page document. They're still studying it. But prima facie it's not that additional royalty will or can be charged. It's prima facie saying that royalty is not a tax and the state can charge taxes. So that's the broad basis of the case. The exact implication and effect of that on the total iron ore industry and the steel industry is yet to be understood and studied by everybody.

Rajesh Majumdar: Sir, I wanted to know who are our main customers in iron ore?

Rajesh Gupta: We have around a book of 25 to 35 customers quarterly. We have customers ranging from JSW, JSPL, all the Chandrapur customers which are smaller in each quantity, Gopani, Chaman, etc. but they buy all our lump product. We are selling to Bajrang. We are selling to Sunflag. So a very wide -ranging customer. I think the largest customer is around 15%-18%, 20% of our product range.

Rajesh Majumdar: Will that be JSW?

Rajesh Gupta: Yes, that is JSW.

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Rajesh Majumdar: Okay, I wanted to know your outlook on the domestic prices, the discount that prevails over the iron ore imported or landed cost. Do you foresee any change happening there given the fact that a large amount of mining capacity is coming in India?

Rajesh Gupta: So the international pricing even at this depressed state is around \$100 per ton of 62%. Indian prices are much lower, always have been, number one. Number two, so there is no link to that actually speaking. And in

terms of mining capacity being added, there is also steel capacity being added like we all know. The Prime Minister's program is to produce 300 million tons of steel by 2030. For that we require around 300 million tons more of iron ore which is near

by doubling the

capacity just like of steel. And that capacity we do not see on the anvil right now.

Rajesh Majumdar: Okay. And so my last question is that the beneficiation plant is going to be using the iron ore that we are mining. So the total capacity of our iron ore mines post expansion is 25 million tons and beneficiation is 45 million tons. So basically 20 million tons is the additional beneficiation capacity. Is that correct?

Rajesh Gupta: So the output of the beneficiation would be 15 million tons and 45 million tons would be the input and 15 million tons would be the output of the beneficiation plant. And 10 million tons would be direct sales ore. So 10 plus 15 would be 25 million tons ultimately over 3 to 4 years.

Rajesh Majumdar: Okay. So 10 million direct sales ore and 15 million via BHQ processed ore]

Rajesh Gupta: Yes. The beneficiated ore would be producing 66 %-67% which is much richer ore, very low in alumina and silica . So we use it internally it will be a good premium in production costs. If we sell it, it will be a good premium in selling price.

Rajesh Majumdar: Thank you so much, sir. Thank you.

Moderator: Thank you. The next question is from the line of Giriraj Daga from Visaria Family Trust. Please go ahead.

Giriraj Daga: Yes. Hello, so my first question is regarding the prices. So let's say last month NMDC has cut prices. Okay. So what is the average realisation for July compared to average of 1Q?

Rajesh Gupta: The price realisation in Q1 has been around INR 5700 partly delivered to the customer, partly delivered to the siding. And the average realisation this quarter, this month would be little lesser than that. We have reduced the prices once. So we don't know how exactly the quarter will play out given the scenario.

Giriraj Daga: Is it something like INR 300-INR 400 what NMDC also cut?

Rajesh Gupta: That would be similar.

Giriraj Daga: And assuming there is an expectation of another cut coming from the August 1 onwards. So are we also anticipating similar INR 300-INR 400?

Rajesh Gupta: At the moment we are well booked till nearly end of August. So we don't know , but nobody can predict the prices of commodities like you very well know, sir.

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Giriraj Daga: No. So understand, let's say we are booked on quantity. So we will not be, reducing the prices even if NMDC reduces borrow, the customer will ask us to reduce the prices for that ?

Rajesh Gupta: We are not under pressure to market the product right now because of the monsoons. Even NMDC has had problems in the monsoons. We are having problems in the monsoons of delivery. So with all of that the pressure of the sales is not there. So we would not be looking at a price cut immediately..

Giriraj Daga: Second, what is the specific beneficiation capex for the 45 million ton?

Rajesh Gupta: Around INR5,000 crores for all the 3 units. Okay.

Giriraj Daga: And lastly on a full year number, like last quarter you mentioned about 12 -13 million ton of number depending on the approval. So how confident are you for this number as of now?

Rajesh Gupta: There are many external factors. Primarily being the EC approval . Last time we got the EC approval after the IBM approval, we got it within 5-6 months. This time we got the IBM approval in the month of early July or maybe end June. So, from that angle January seems to be a possible thing.

Giriraj Daga: Sure. Thank you.

Moderator: The next question is from the line of Ajay L ahoti, an individual investor. Please go ahead.

Ajay Lahoti : Yes, sir. Jai Sriram . Sir, we read a report of Ventura that you have two more mines. What do you have to say about this?

Rajesh Gupta: We have no other mines other than the one that we are operating right now.

Ajay Lahoti : So is the report of Ventura report not correct then?

Rajesh Gupta: Let me correct that

if there is a mistake . But as of today we have only one mine operating.

Ajay Lahoti : Sir, my vision is to invest for 10 years. So what business will I have remaining after 10 years?

Rajesh Gupta: our mine is valid till 2057. Reserves are around 800-900 million tons . And we have to mine 25 million tons in a year. So our plan is until 2057 . Of course we will look at other opportunities.

Plus, we will make 4.2 million tons of steel, 12 million tons of pellet and we will take out iron ore and sell it in Indian market. That is the long-term vision. The mine validity is 2057 and we have the reserves until then as well

Ajay Lahoti : Thank you, sir.

Moderator: Thank you. The next question is from the line of Harshi I, an individual investor. Please go ahead.

Harsh il: Yes. Good afternoon, sir. What is the capex spend for the financial year 2025 and 2026? And are we doing through internal accruals or are we taking any debt to fund it?

Rajesh Gupta: No, we are not taking any debt. That is very clear what we have always been mentioning. The capex plans for the two years is in the year 2024- 25, we are looking at around INR 3300 crore s of capex . And in the year 2025-26, we are looking from INR 6,500 to INR 7,000 crore s of capex . As I have earlier also mentioned, we have just done a fund raise of QIP as well as a preferential warrant is under process. So, we plan to do all these projects through internal accruals. Any shortfall or any issues would be supported with this fund raise of QIP as well as the preferential issues.

Harsh il: Okay, sir. Thank you.

Moderator: Thank you. The next question is from the line of Prince Chaudhary from PINC Wealth. Please go ahead.

Prince Chaudhary: I have a question. Out of the total capacity of 25 million tons per annum for iron ore, how much do we use for the captive consumption and how much is sold to the customers?

Rajesh Gupta: Post-expansion, all the total expansion plan, we will be selling around 4.2 million tons of steel, 6 million tons of pellets and 9 million tons of iron ore. So, out of 25 million tons of iron ore that we mine, this would be the end product sale that we would be doing. 4.2 million tons of steel, 6 million tons of pellets and 9 million tons of iron ore.

Prince Chaudhary : So, that iron ore which we will mine, about 25 million tons , will it be used for the captive purpose ?

Rajesh Gupta: Yes, 4.2 will consume around 8 million tons. 9 million tons will be sold as iron ore. 6 million tons will be converted from iron ore to pellet and around 8 million tons will be converted from iron ore into steel. That gives the 25 million tons overall picture.

Prince Chaudhary How much is the freight cost using the slurry pipeline?

Rajesh Gupta: Around INR800 to INR 900 is what we will be saving on the slurry pipeline transport cost.

Prince Chaudhary : Okay. Thank you. That's it from my side.

Moderator: Thank you. The next question is from the line of Vansh Jain , an individual investor. Please go ahead.

Vansh Jain : Hi good e vening sir . Given that the company is moving towards forward integration and will be producing value -added steel products, what is the management's projection for EBITDA margins?

Rajesh Gupta: After steel production, I think it's too forward-looking for us to respond on this call , at this point in time

Vansh Jain: Okay. Thank you, sir.

Rajesh Gupta: Can I expand on that answer that the gentleman just asked me?

Moderator: Yes, sure, sir.

Rajesh Gupta: So, compared to my competitors in the steel business, we will be lower on the iron ore cost because we have no premiums royalty on ore . We will be lower on the iron ore cost because a good pipeline network would be set up. So, these two savings are around INR 4,000 a ton of iron

ore. And that translates to around INR 8,000 a ton of steel. So, this is definitely where our delta would be for the life of the mine.

Moderator: Thank you. The next question is from the line of Amui Gavre, an individual investor.

Amui Gavre: I just have this question, sir. What will be the timeline guidance regarding the 25 million ton iron ore approval?

Rajesh Gupta: I just answered that. I think January 2025, we should be up and running, subject to the EC approval being received.

Amui Gavre: Okay, and to add to that, is there any volume guidance that you would like to provide for iron ore for the next financial year?

Rajesh Gupta: We would be capping our iron ore production at 25 million tons .

Amui Gavre: Okay. Yeah, that's it from my side. Thank you, sir.

Moderator: Thank you. The next question is from the line of Shamal Kothari , from Shamal Traders. Please go ahead. Mr. S hamal, your line has been unmuted. Please go ahead with your question.

Shamal Kothari: Jai Shri Krishna. Sir, there is a project in Surjagadh, Gadchiroli , Surjagad Ispat Private Limited . Will it benefit our plant or our mine in any case?

Rajesh Gupta: We hope that they will be our customers of iron ore out of the 9 million tons that we have to sell. So, definitely that will be beneficial to the company.

Shamal Kothari: Sir, any plans of taking stake in that company, sir?

Rajesh Gupta: No, we have no such plans at the moment.

Shamal Kothari: Okay. And, sir, one more thing. There is a mine, Bande mine of Sunflag iron ore . In that mine,

the Supreme Court case is going on. So, any plans that we are going to take that mine in future from Sunflag and Triveni is going to operate it because Triveni is the best in mining?

Rajesh Gupta: Triveni is one of the finest mining MDO operators, definitely, and that is why they are doing our mining. However, regarding the Bande mines, I have no idea and no knowledge of what is Sunflag's plans or Triveni's plans for that matter.

Shamal Kothari: Okay. Thank you, sir.

Moderator: Thank you. The next question is from the line of Bhavin Chheda from Enam Holdings. Please go ahead.

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Bhavin Chheda: Sir, two, three questions. One, what was the mix of lumps and iron ore fines in this quarter versus quarter four? Second is, iron ore sales, what was the sales mix state-wise? Like entire sales happened in Maharashtra or you sent to other states and was there any exports and so? And the third question was, what was the average Fe content of the iron ore that we produced in the quarter?

Rajesh Gupta: Okay. Third question is very easy. It's our blended 63%-64% totally for lumps and for fines. And other than the exports, we have not done anything in this quarter. So, 63%-64% has been the Fe content in this quarter. Number two, the lump versus fine lump has been around 18%-19% in this quarter. Last quarter was around 25% was the lump versus 18% this quarter and what was your third question, sir?

Bhavin Chheda: Entire iron ore was sold in Maharashtra or you did sell out of Maharashtra?

Rajesh Gupta: We have a well-distributed policy. The lumps are sold mostly in Maharashtra to both blast furnaces and DRI units in Maharashtra. Fines are sold in Maharashtra, Raipur, Karnataka, sometimes to UP also, maybe not so much in this quarter. I think we did sell something to Jharkhand. So, it goes in many cities and of course we have sold to Goa as well.

Bhavin Chheda: And as you mentioned on the earlier part of the call that IBM approval is received and I think you are awaiting EC approval which is by January as you guided. Except for the EC, any other approval which you also require for incremental iron ore volumes?

Rajesh Gupta: So, when I say EC approval, it includes EC approval and then we have to add the CTO, Consent To Operate and then we are ready to go. So, that's a pro

cess, that's part of the same process.

Apart from the environmental clearance, there is no other clearances like forest or something is not required.

Bhavin Chheda: Forest is not required in this case?

Rajesh Gupta: Yes

Bhavin Chheda: And the trial production of the BHQ plant what you had started that's running fine and all that?

Rajesh Gupta: Yes, absolutely. I clarified earlier, 66% regularly, 67% in trials and around 30%-40% yield from BHQ to finished product.

Bhavin Chheda: Yeah, thanks a lot.

Moderator: Thank you. The next question is from the line of Rohan Koshi from New Horizons. Please go ahead.

Rohan Koshi: Hi, thanks for taking my question. Just wanted to expand a little bit on the comment you made on the benefit that you have about INR 8,000 a ton on steel and how does that kind of sustain over time and you said also INR 4,000 a ton on iron ore, right?

Rajesh Gupta: So, post the 2015 MMDR Act, all mines which were more than 50 years had to go in for a compulsory auction and most of the mines post 2030 will have gone for that. Last, from 2015 to

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2024, in 7-8 years, there have been around 140 millilitres of capacity which has gone in for auction at an average premium of 120%. So, I'm taking that as a premium of around INR 3,000 that those mines have to pay.

If we extrapolate that to the further auction that will happen including major steel queuers that are still operating the older mines, that 120% translates to around INR 3000 on a very, very conservative basis or premium that they are paying over and above the royalty that I am paying or that even they would need to pay. So, that INR 3,000 is one delta and then we add to that the pipeline saving. Most of the steel plants are not attached to the mine. The pipeline network is not there in many of the plants or the mines for that matter. So, the transport cost, if you add that further, that's around INR 1,000 on an average is what I've estimated for all these mine/plant combinations. And I'm talking about the big steel plants.

The smaller steel plants like the mini biopellets on a commercial basis, etc., I'm not even including that in this discussion. So, this INR 4,000 delta that I have, steel requires approximately 1.9 to 2 times of iron ore of the steel output. Iron is 1.6 to 1.65 and then iron to steel is around 1.1, 1.15. And then for the losses, I'm taking 2 times, 1.9 times. So, that INR 4000 translates to

INR8,000.

Rohan Koshi: And does that sustain over the life of the mine?

Rajesh Gupta: Contractually, yes. And when I talk about this beneficiation plant, the beneficiation plant produces like I said 66% Fe content that reduces the coke requirement to the blast furnaces or

coal requirement in the DRF furnaces or power requirement in the ARC furnaces, whatever way you make the iron. In the net steel making, around 15% to 18% energy requirement either of coke or coal or power comes down. And that's again a delta which I have not yet calculated.

Rohan Koshi: Thank you.

Moderator: Ladies and gentlemen, that was the last question for today's conference call. I would now like to hand the conference over to the management for their closing comments.

Rajesh Gupta : Thank you, everybody. It was a nice session. Hope I have clarified and replied to all your queries and questions. Thank you very much.

Moderator: On behalf of JM Financial, that concludes this conference. Thank you for joining us and you may now disconnect your lines. Thank you.

Call: Oct 2024

Date: 29th October , 2024

To,
BSE Limited National Stock Exchange of India Limited
Phiroze Jeejeebhoy Towers, Exchange Plaza, Bandra Kurla Complex,
Dalal Street, Mumbai – 400001 Bandra (East), Mumbai - 400 051
BSE Scrip Code: 512455 NSE Symbol: LLOYDSME

Sub: Transcript of the Conference Call for investors and analysts for Q2 & H1FY25

Dear Sir/Madam,

Pursuant to the Regulation 30 of the Securities and Exchange Board of India (Listing Obligations and Disclosure Requirements) Regulations, 2015 (" Listing Regulations "), and in furtherance to our intimation dated 21st October, 2024 regarding Conference call with Analyst(s) /Investor(s) held on Friday, 25th October, 2024 we would like to inform that the transcript of the aforesaid conference call is attached herewith and the same is also available on the website of the Company at [https://lloyds.in/earnings -call/](https://lloyds.in/earnings-call/) .

The same may please be taken on record and suitably disseminated to all concerned.

Thanking you,
Yours Sincerely,
For Lloyds Metals and Energy Limited

Trushali Shah
Company Secretary
Membership No.: ACS61489

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"Lloyds Metals and Energy Limited
Q2 FY '25 Earnings Conference Call "
October 25, 2024

MANAGEMENT : MR. RAJESH GUPTA – MANAGING DIRECTOR –
LLOYDS METALS AND ENERGY LIMITED
MR. RIYAZ SHAIKH – CHIEF FINANCIAL OFFICER –
LLOYDS METALS AND ENERGY

MODERATOR : MR. SIDDHARTH GADEKAR – EQUITUS SECURITIES
PRIVATE LIMITED

Lloyds Metals and Energy Limited
October 25, 2024
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Moderator: Ladies and gentlemen, good day and welcome to Lloyds Metals and Energy Limited Q2 FY'25 Earnings Call hosted by Equirus Securities. As a reminder, all participant lines will be in the listen -only mode and there will be an opportunity for you to ask questions after the presentation concludes. Should you need assistance during the conference call, please signal an operator by pressing star then zero on your touch tone phone.

Please note that this conference is being recorded. I now hand the conference over to Mr. Siddharth Gadekar . Thank you and over to you Mr. Gadekar.

Siddharth Gadekar: Good morning everyone and thank you for joining us today. We at Equirus are pleased to host

Lloyds Metals and Energy 's Q2 FY25 Results C onference Call. We have with us today Mr. Rajesh Gupta, Managing Director, Mr. Riyaz Shaikh , CFO. Now I would like to invite Mr. Rajesh Gupta to initiate the proceedings for the results call. Thank you.

Rajesh Gupta: Good morning to all the people, investors and analysts present on this call. We appreciate your continued support and interest in Lloyds Metals and a special thanks to Siddharth and the Equirus team for hosting this call today. We value the opportunity to share our progress and insights and the pro gress of the company with all of you. I am pleased to report that our Q2 and H1 FY25 results have been very satisfying and robust, reflecting strong performance on both operations and financial metrics and in continuation of our target to create a cyclical proof steel business. In terms of iron ore volume, we have achieved 5.37 million tons in the first half and in sponge iron production also we have done better in both the plants, since now two plants are operational than the previous year substantially. The iron ore market dome stically remains buoyant. There is some headwind, but the prices have remained stable at around \$100 for the 62% grade in the international market. And in the Indian market for the first time after many months we have seen a double price increase in the market itself.

In addition, there is a considerable demand for high quality ore which , very positively influences our outlook for our iron ore business. In terms of project updates, we are excited to announce the successful laying of the 85 kilometer slurry pipeline, complet ed in record breaking time and probably one of th e fastest durations of around 8 to 9 months since we started the project. This pipeline is now awaiting the completion of the first pellet plant which will be completed within this financial year in Konsari .

The DRI plant in Ghugus is progress ing well and future projects like 2nd pellet plant and the 1.2 wire rod mill in Konsari and Ghugus are also advancing well within schedule. Regarding the mine expansion, we have received permissions stage by stage and within this fiscal year, we hope to announce the mine expansion also as per our original projections. With these updates, I will n ow hand over the call to Riyaz , our CFO who will walk you through our quarte rly numbers. Over to you, Riyaz.

Riyaz Shaikh: Thank you, Raj esh ji . Good morning to all participants on this earning call. Thank you for joining us today. A brief overview on our H 1 FY 25 revenue performance. H1 FY25 revenue grew by 26% year -on-year driven by higher sponge iron and iron ore volumes. On the iron ore front, both volumes and realizations showed encouraging growth year on year. Sponge production also Lloyds Metals and Energy Limited

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recorded increased v olumes and realizations year -on-year. T he company received close to INR72 crores as IPS benefits from previous years contributing to overall performance and this forms part of our other income for reporting purpose s.

On EBITDA front, EBITDA mirrored revenue performance increasing by

37% year -on-year in

H1 FY25. The robust performance was supported by high margins from both iron ore and sponge. Speaking about capital expenditure, we incurred a capital expenditure of INR1 ,690 crores in FY 24 and INR1 ,714 crores in H1 FY25. We will now give you a brief snapshot on per ton matri ces as well. Iron ore realization, for quarter Q2 FY 25 the iron ore realization was INR5,516 per ton up 19% year -on-year and f or H1 FY25 it was INR 5,638 up 11% year -on-year. EBITDA per ton for quarter Q2 FY25 INR1 ,668 up 17% year -on-year and f or H1 FY25 INR1 ,782 up 21% year -on-year. DRI segment volumes were as follows. Q2 FY25 was 84,552 tons and H1 FY25 was 1,60,974 tons. Realiza tions remained stable both year -on-year and quarter -on-quarter. Power segment performance. The p ower reported a steady perform ance with 38% higher sales year -on-year for quarter 2 FY25. For H1 FY25 volu mes were also higher by 4% year -on-year. Capex a nd project updates.

As mentioned by Rajesh ji, all our projects are progressing at breathtaking speed. Several projects are ahead of schedule, but we will maintain our capex deadline as previously guided. The fundraising undertaken by the company has supported fast execution of all the projects. Taking queue from Rajesh ji, we foresee a much better H2 FY25. That's all from my side. Thank you all for taking the time to join this call. I look forward for your insights and questions during this call. Thank you. Over to you, Siddh arth.

Moderator: Thank you very much. We will now begin the question and answer session. The first question is from the line of Parthiv Shah from TS Builders P rivate Limited. Please go ahead.

Parthiv Shah: Thank you sir for allowing me with the question and firstly congratulations for a resilient set of numbers. Sir, I want to understa nd what has been the average iron ore prices during the quarter and also what have been the existing iron ore prices?

Riyaz Shaikh: The average for this quarter the iron ore p rices was INR5,516 per ton .

Parthiv Shah: And what is the exi sting ?

Riyaz Shaikh: And for the half year it is INR5,638.

Parthiv Shah: Sir, have you increased the ore prices for the October deliveries?

Parthiv Shah: Sorry, have you sir increased the ore prices for the October deliveries and also sir if you could quantify because NMDC has taken two price hikes in October?

Rajesh Gupta: Yes, so we go with the flow of the market and we have also taken price hikes. Our price hikes are more constant or price hikes or price falls are more constant. This year or rather this month as like I mentioned earlier after, many months the price increase of two times has been announced by NMDC and we have followed suit - little bit better than that.

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Parthiv Shah: Okay, and sir what is your production volume guidance for 24 estimates FY24?

Rajesh Gupta: FY24 -25, so we expect around 13 million to 14 million tons assuming that the EC for the expansion comes by mid-February or so.

Parthiv Shah: Okay and sir one last one in your prior calls you had mentioned that as and when your iron ore mining goes up you tend to get operating leverage and that would reduce your cost. Could you throw some light as to where your cost per ton looks at after this enhanced mining?

Rajesh Gupta: After enhanced mining, the MDO cost should come down once it stabilizes by around INR150 to INR 200 a ton and once the beneficiation starts by another INR150, INR200 then the volumes go up really high number one. Number two the slurry pipeline cost once it is started which will start along with the present plant that should reduce our transport cost by around INR600 a ton also.

Parthiv Shah: Thank you so much for taking my question. All the best.

Moderator: Thank you. The next question is from the line of Vikas Singh from Phillip Capital

. Please go ahead.

Vikas Singh: Good morning sir and thank you for the opportunity. Sir, just wanted to understand the way I see that the sponge iron EBIT has jumped on a sequential basis while we believe that the price was kind of lower for most of the players in the Chhattisgarh region. Is there anything additional in this sponge iron which we are missing out right now?

Rajesh Gupta: We have got previous year IPS, Industrial Promotion Scheme in this year which we have accounted for as other income of around INR72 crores. So that is the one time income that is added to the bottom line.

Vikas Singh: Understood sir. Sir, in terms of pellet trading which we started and had done other marginal losses this quarter. Just wanted to understand that why if we are able to sell iron ore then why this pellet trading is happening here right now?

Rajesh Gupta: Pellet trading we have started for three, four directional reasons. The primary reason is that it becomes our seed marketing effort for our higher grade pellets. That we will be coming into the market very shortly so that we can export with a better knowledge of the market when we are fully commercial. This quarter like many people know the pellets margin especially on the export front were very low. So we have not had much export or zero export rather. And the marginal loss that you see is basically a carry on for the previous quarters some figures that were balance and some administrative costs.

Vikas Singh: Understood. Sir, just one last question. How much capex we have already done for the first half and the pending capex for the second half which we are guiding and for FY26 as well?

Riyaz Shaikh: We have done around INR1,700 crores in the first half. And we should be doing an equal amount in the next half of this financial year also.

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Vikas Singh: Understood sir. And lastly if you would like to give us some idea about the beneficiation of low-grade iron ore project where it is right now by when we are thinking of starting and how is the cost differential in terms of additional cost which we had to incur for the beneficiation of iron ore?

Rajesh Gupta: The beneficiation plant we have started a pilot plant which was commissioned in end of March 2024. That pilot plant is giving us very good results. We are getting little better results than what was earlier thought to be. We are getting 68% FE output through the beneficiation. We have produced some quantities and we are now going to do this testing of these quantities up to pellet making as well as steel making so that we understand the full benefit of the ore and or any correction need to be doing from downstream production activities. Number one.

Number two, we have from the project angle, with the beneficiation pilot plant completed, the flow sheet of the project is now final and detailed engineering is going on along with our Chinese contractor Sinos teel. Simultaneously the permissions required for the forest land etc are being processed and we are in line as projected for the first plant to be ready by end of 27 -28. So we are well in line with in that.

Vikas Singh: Understood sir. Sir additional cost which you need to take up versus the premium of 67% Fe

grade? What is it right now the premium and what is the additional cost we expect to have ?

Rajesh Gupta: The cost of beneficiation would be around INR800 a ton , but that is more than offset by the fact that this material would be piped by slurry pipeline to our steel plant or pellet plant facility, number one as well as the royalty would come down because we are doing this beneficiation outside the mine area and the royalty would be paid on lower grade material. So we believe that the cost would be well under control compared to current in spite of a higher grade. Regarding the premium of the higher grade, if you look

at pelletization the market is giving a

premium of around USD40 to USD 50 dollars in the international market and if you look at steelmaking we expect around similar benefit. So overall it is a win-win situation.

Vikas Singh: Yeah, it is still way above the cost you are incurring.

Rajesh Gupta: Yes.

Vikas Singh: That's all from my side sir. Thank you for taking my question and all the best for future.

Moderator: Thank you. The next question is from the line of Nishant Bagrecha from Incred Finance. Please go ahead.

Nishant Bagrecha: Thank you for the opportunity sir. I hope I am audible and I have a couple of questions on the capex front and also on your iron ore. So my first question is like can you give some highlights on the capex front and share timelines on each plant commissioning over the next 2 years to 3 years?

Riyaz Shaikh: The capex as I mentioned during this first half we have done INR1,700 crores . It was well backed up with the fund raise also what we did. So the projects are all going much on time. We intend

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to do around INR34 00 crores to INR35 00 crores in this year of capex and followed in the next 2 years of almost close to double sort of a thing what we are doing here. So that's how the capex plans are. All our projects are running much in advance as of today as we mentioned, but we just continue sticking with the same dates what we have already mentioned. So on the capex front all projects are almost 1 year, 1.5 years ahead of schedule that is what we are going on. So we should be completing things very soon .

Rajesh Gupta: If I can give some update on the project wise. First is the 25 million ton dispatched from the mine either DSO or beneficiated. We hope to complete this by February 2025. The beneficiation like I mentioned earlier by end of financial year 27-28 was the original. We hope to do it around 6 months earlier than that for all the three phases. The iron ore grinding plant and the pipeline like I mentioned earlier the pipeline is already completed.

The grinding unit of 10 million tons will be completed by March 25. The pellet plant, the first one will be completed by the March 25 and the second one by March 26. Our original guidance was around 6 months to 1 year more than this. For the integrated steel plant the first phase of that is the DRI plant. We hope to complete this by March 25 again and part of the captive power plant in March 25, one small part in January 25 and the 1.2 million ton steel plant with BF, blast furnace, coke oven and wire rod mill by September 26.

Nishant Bagrecha: Okay. Thank you.

Rajesh Gupta: These are our internal projections. Our projections to our board are the original projections which were little bit more than this like Riyaz mentioned.

Nishant Bagrecha: And just wanted one more clarity on the capex front like we have spoken about almost INR32,000 crores capex over the next 5 to 6 years. So, post the fundraise can we assume the entire capex would be funded by internal accrual?

Riyaz Shaikh: Yes, as of today we have all decided it should be without debt that is what we have decided – we should be continuing. We had a fundraise through QIP as well as warrants. Warrants is still around 35% is what we got and we will be getting 65% more. So, this would be funding for the projects. It would be without, we still maintain it would be without debt.

Nishant Bagrecha: Okay. And one more like what would be our cost of benefiting this iron ore ? Can you give any sense on the all inclusive cost of iron ore including mining and beneficiation and royalty charges?

Rajesh Gupta: The all inclusive charge of beneficiation, royalty and transport to the consuming center that is either pellet or steel plant would remain more or less the same as of today. Okay around INR2,800 to INR3,000.

Nishant Bag

recha: Okay, sure. Thank you, sir.

Moderator: Thank you. The next question is from the line of Rajesh Ravi from HDFC Securities. Please go ahead.

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Rajesh Ravi: Hi, sir. Good afternoon. Part of the question giving the details of the timelines. Just wanted to cross check the INR3,500 crores, capex would be in FY '25 and INR7,000 crores each in FY '26 and '27?

Rajesh Gupta: Yes.

Rajesh Ravi: Okay. And as per your timeline, most of the project would get completed by FY '26 and the BHQ beneficiation line also you mentioned would be completed by FY '26 and or early FY '27?

Rajesh Gupta: BHQ, the last phase of that would be completed by September 2028.

Rajesh Ravi: Okay.

Rajesh Gupta: September 2027, sorry.

Rajesh Ravi: Okay. So, FY '28 it will get completed

Rajesh Gupta: It is a steel plant of 3 million tons which expenditure of this land has started and the full study of the project is on right now. That INR16,000 crores project would be apart from land would be invested post some of the major investments being completed.

Rajesh Ravi: Okay. So, this is the third leg, beyond this 14,000, to 17,000, which you would be spending in 3 years.

Rajesh Gupta: Yes.

Rajesh Ravi: And the remaining 16,000, is what you would be...

Rajesh Gupta: First, if you want to break it up, we have the DRI plant, the pellet plants at around and the pipeline and the beneficiation of around INR16,000 crores. 3 million tons steel plant at around INR16,000 crores. Roughly, I am giving broad figures. So, the INR16,000 crores figure investment would start apart from land and technology build up would start post most of these other projects being over.

Rajesh Ravi: Great, sir. I will come back in queue. Thank you.

Moderator: Thank you. The next question is from the line of Manish Shehgal, an Individual Investor. Please go ahead.

Manish Shehgal: Hi, sir. I just want a quick clarification on our relationship with Sunflag, given we are having about INR6 crores shares sitting there which could be potentially a supply overhang. And also, there was some oversupply agreement if you could clarify a bit on that with them.

Riyaz Shaikh: Sunflag, as you all know, it was an arbitration matter by which we had given them these OFCDs which got later converted into equity shares. That is around 6 crores of equity share which they have. And also, based on this same order, we entered into an over purchase agreement where we supply them almost –they have a requirement of around 1 million tons per annum. So, at a cost - Lloyds Metals and Energy Limited

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plus basis. So, we've been doing that as per the arbitration order what we have. And it's a completely -- the shares are in the, it forms the part of the public holding.

Manish Shehgal: Thank you. There was, at least in the initial list, the warrants were issued to them also. But, of course, finally, I think it didn't fructify.

Riyaz Shaikh: Yeah, they were not able to apply for it.

Manish Shehgal: Yes. So, I mean, is there some long-term thinking on the relationship with that company as well? Or it is just outside, setting outside?

Rajesh Gupta: In terms of long-term relationship, it is limited to the supply of iron ore for which we have a long-term supply agreement with them.

Manish Shehgal: Okay. So, the supply can come in the market effectively?

Rajesh Gupta: Supply of iron ore as such.

Manish Shehgal: No. I'm just saying the stock?

Rajesh Gupta: Supply of shares. We as a company not – it's a part of the public shareholding. And we are not in a position to comment on that.

Manish Shehgal: Okay, great. Thank you.

Moderator: Thank you. The next question is from the line of Siddharth Gaddekar from Equirus Securities Pvt Ltd. Please go ahead.

Siddharth Gaddekar: Sir, can you just quantify how much price hikes have

been taken in October month?

Rajesh Gupta: We have taken one price hike of 425 and the second one is around 380 or 400. in the fine sector. And in the lump sector, the first one was 425.

Riyaz Shaikh: Second one, I think, is INR500. I'm not able to remember the second one offhand right now.

Siddharth Gaddekar: So, broadly, excluding the royalty, incremental royalty that we might be paying on the higher legalization, broadly, everything should flow to our EBITDA in the third and the fourth quarter, assuming prices stay where they are, right?

Rajesh Gupta: Yeah, the royalty. Apart from the royalty, everything should flow to the bottom.

Siddharth Gaddekar: Okay. So, secondly on the IPS number, where you said you have received INR72 crores for this years, how should we look at these numbers going ahead over the next 2, or 3 years?

Rajesh Gupta: I think this number is more or less the final figure for the overhang that was there for the past

investment. For future, once the pellet plant is started, then we will start our new series of the IPS for Gadchiroli at 150%. That will start post the pellet plant, which will also be for the DRI plant in Gadchiroli. And similarly, for the DRI plant, the new plant, once we start, post that, the income would start accruing.

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Siddharth Gadekar: So, we can expect some benefits to start flowing in from FY '26 only?

Riyaz Shaikh: Yes. Because once we complete our projects in FY '25, we start operations in FY '25, '26, then we should be fine.

Siddharth Gadekar: So, secondly, in terms of the slurry pipeline, which you have got commissioned already, when do we expect to actually start utilizing the slurry pipeline?

Rajesh Gupta: The iron ore grinding unit is under preparation. And the pellet plant, even if the iron ore grinding unit is started, we can start sending ground material to the pellet plant area and try to dispatch some ground material to some customers. However, it is expected around the same time as the pellet plant, around March 25.

Siddharth Gadekar: So, the cost of transportation in the pellet plant would be around INR50? Is that a fair understanding?

Rajesh Gupta: To the pellet plant?

Siddharth Gadekar: Yes.

Rajesh Gupta: Yes, around INR50.

Siddharth Gadekar: Okay, that's it from my side, sir. Thank you.

Moderator: Thank you. The next question is from the line of Ashutosh Somani from JM Financial. Please go ahead.

Ashutosh Somani: Thanks for taking my question, sir. If you could spend some time on the domestic pricing outlook, both in the short -term and in the long -term. So, short -term perspective in terms of what are your customers saying and what kind of room you are seeing in terms of price increase further. And from a longer -term perspective of mines expiring in 2030 and how do you look at the pricing outlook?

Rajesh Gupta: Ashutosh, thank you very much for a very nice question. We have engaged with BigMint and for a detailed market study to address some of these questions. In the preliminary discussion, some surprises have been thrown up. For example, many of the steel authority mines also expire at the same time as some of the other mines in 2030. That I didn't know, for example. So, continuing with the long -term, the steel market is expected to grow to 300 million tons by 2030, '32, '33.

And there is a growth of around 7%, 8% per annum for the next 4 years or even more. Given the pace of the iron ore mining increase in the past few years, we do not see that keeping pace, so we see a mismatch. Some of this mismatch will be covered by other beneficiation projects which are being thought about. But we don't know the extent of that. That is the study that BigMint would try to cover for us in the next 2, 3 months. We will have that detailed report with us. Regarding the short -term, the steel plant capacity in the count

ry, has been added by around 8%

in the last quarter. The two mega blast furnaces have been commissioned apart from many other

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units being added. There have been no mine announcements coming up. So, that is probably part of the reason of this mismatch and rise increase. The Indian market continues to remain at a deep discount to the international prices. And so that does remain in the overall scenario that we factor in.

Ashutosh Somani: Sure. That answers my question, sir. Thank you.

Moderator: Thank you. The next question is from the line of Aryan Sharma from B&K Securities Limited. Please go ahead.

Aryan Sharma: Just one clarification. I know you have mentioned it already, but could you please give more details based upon the future cost? How much for beneficiation, pipeline, steel plant, etc.? Could you just share the specifics?

Rajesh Gupta: I think that would be quite detailed. Can we ask you to approach our investment relations cell and they would be glad to update you on that?

Aryan Sharma: Sure, sir. No problem.

Rajesh Gupta: Thank you.

Moderator: Does that answer your question, Mr. Aryan?

Aryan Sharma: Yes.

Moderator: Thank you. The next question is from the line of Deep Mehta from Bank of India Mutual Fund. Please go ahead.

Deep Mehta: Hi, sir. Thank you for the opportunity. Just one clarification. We will get our EC limits for increasing our mining capacity by the end of this year, correct?

Riyaz Shaikh: End of this financial year.

Deep Mehta: End of this financial year. And then how much time will it take to ramp up the production to the rated capacity?

Rajesh Gupta: So let me clarify on the EC. The mining plan has been approved. The TOR has been approved. Now the public hearing would happen post this Maharashtra Elections. And subsequent to that, the EC would be issued by the Central Government, MOEA. So that is the process that is in place

What has been completed, what is remaining . So we expect the timeline by February 15th, 20th, something like that. We have already have processed up to 2 million, 2.5 million tons also per month. So we hope that the 25 million ton DSO sales on a per annum basis could happen more or less immediately in line with the EC clearance. Our MDO Thriveni, has already started implementing machinery based on this.

Deep Mehta: So is it fair to assume that for FY '26 we may touch 20 million ton or something like that?

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Rajesh Gupta: 25 would be a more accurate figure.

Deep Mehta: Very clear, sir. And pellet plant will also start, right? So what will be the sales to the outside world?

Rajesh Gupta: For sure. Yes.

Deep Mehta: And pellet plant should start during the start of the next financial year, right?

Rajesh Gupta: First pellet plant and the DRI plant capacity enhancement, both should happen by the end of March 25.

Management: Operations should start from the next financial year.

Deep Mehta: Okay, sir. Very clear. That's all from me. Thank you.

Moderator: Thank you. The next question is from the line of Vikas Shah from RNM Capital Advisors. Please go ahead.

Vikas Shah: Yes, sir. Thank you for the opportunity and congratulations on the robust performance. So first question is with respect to -- so what is the yield that you've got in the pilot beneficiation plant and can we assume that the yield will improve when we do be neficiation on a larger scale?

Rajesh Gupta: The yield that we've got is around 38%. Originally we had anticipated 35%, so 38% is a little bit improvement on that. I would say that this 38% is an optimum figure. There are too many variables in a larger plant, so I would say 38% would remain our inter nal thinking.

Vikas Shah: Okay. And so when we talked about 45 million ton of beneficiation, which would give us around 15

million ton of saleable iron ore. So can the number be even higher also?

Rajesh Gupta: It will be a little bit higher, but again that's -- we have to appreciate that this is the first time that this plant is being done in India, so we have been very, very conservative in announcing our figures. But the pilot plant is showing 38%.

Vikas Shah: And then one last question. What is the mining that you have done in any month, just to understand how fast we can ramp up the mine?

Rajesh Gupta: Sorry, come again. I lost your question.

Vikas Shah: Sir, what I'm saying is that what is the peak mining that we have done in any month, just to understand how fast we can ramp up the mines?

Rajesh Gupta: Around 2.2 million tons were done, I think, in the beginning of this financial year.

Vikas Shah: Okay, sir. Thank you so much for answering.

Rajesh Gupta: And one more thing that we have to keep in mind is the logistics movement. So that becomes a bottleneck. With the pipeline of 10 million tons being commissioned simultaneously, that bottleneck stands reduced dramatically.

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Vikas Shah: Okay, sir. Thank you so much for answering. Thank you.

Moderator: Thank you. The next question is from the liner Shrey Gandhi from CR Kothari Stock Broking. Please go ahead.

Shrey Gandhi: Good afternoon, sir. Thank you for the opportunity. I just have a small question. When I was going through the quarterly results, I see the mining revenue has decreased quarter -on-quarter by almost INR800 crores. So, could you just show some light on this and what can we expect?

Riyaz Shaikh: we are not able to hear you properly.

Shrey Gandhi: The mining revenue has decreased by almost INR800 crores in the quarter 2 as compared to last quarter. So, can you throw some light on this and what can we expect in the coming future?

Rajesh Gupta: The quarter 2 are always going to be lower for any year because of the rains and monsoons and

the demand, etc. So, all put together, that's always going to be little lesser than quarter 1 or quarter 4. It's the nature of the mining

Riyaz Shaikh: Seasonally weak quarter. So, the second quarter always sees a similar type of trend.

Rajesh Gupta: But this quarter has been better than the year-on-year quarter. This half has been better than year-on-year half.

Shrey Gandhi: So, in the coming quarter we can expect something similar figure or maybe more than this, the quarter 1?

Rajesh Gupta: Like we mentioned earlier, we would be having our, if you talk about mining, the figures will continue on the same basis till we get the EC clearance and the overall guidance will be around 13 million tons 14 million tons for the year for mining. And our DRI plant of around 330,000 tons a year will be the overall guidance.

Shrey Gandhi: Thank you, sir. Congratulations for the great numbers.

Moderator: Thank you. The next question is from the line of Bharat Bajracha, an Individual Investor. Please go ahead.

Bharat Bajracha: Can we see any incremental volume if we get the EC clearance by year-end or 2025, as you said?

Rajesh Gupta: So, the incremental volume would be, right now it is 10 million tons, so 13 million tons, so that means 3 million tons would be the incremental volume in the last 1.5 months to 2 months.

Bharat Bajracha: How can we increase the profitability from current levels, given the higher number of prices are today?

Rajesh Gupta: Can you repeat that?

Bharat Bajracha: Can we increase the profitability at current levels, given the higher number of prices are today?

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Rajesh Gupta: we are losing the first part of the question. I think there is something wrong with the line.

Bharat Bajracha: Profitability at current levels, where iron ore prices are today?

Rajesh Gupta: I would leave that to the v

ery able analysts to analyse that. There are nearly 100 people in the group, so I am sure many of them would be doing a lot of that analysis.

Bharat Bajracha: Thank you.

Moderator: Thank you. The next question is from the line of Amit Agicha from H G Hawa & Company. Please go ahead.

Amit Agicha: Can you please elaborate on how the slurry pipeline contributes to reducing the carbon footprint and operational efficiency?

Rajesh Gupta: In terms of carbon efficiency, I do not have the figures with me.

Amit Agicha: Can you have the figures?

Rajesh Gupta: We don't the figure. The truck movement is with diesel and this is through pumped power and the slurry reduces this. I will work on this. It is a very interesting question. We have the figures in rupees but not in carbon footprint. We will evaluate that. Apart from that, what we are also doing in carbon footprint reduction in the pelletization. We are going to work with LNG, not with oil.

So that will reduce that carbon footprint in a very big way. The local transport to the siding to the nearby customers would be through LNG trucks. That is as far as the transport is concerned.

Within the mine, much of the equipment by the year 2025 would be through electrical equipment, again reducing the carbon footprint dramatically. So all of that put together, the footprint reduces. By the next quarter, I think we would be able to have a more precise, not precise but more elaborate answer to your question, my friend.

Amit Agicha: Thank you. It was very helpful. Last question is, are there any diversification plans or technology investments aimed at enhancing operational efficiency?

Rajesh Gupta: Within the plans that we are doing, there is a continuous effort to improve efficiencies, improve marketability, improve costs and things like that. So that is an ongoing process. Apart from this, there is no specific thing that we are addressing right now. The steel plant that we are talking about, the 3 million ton steel plant, we are looking at the latest technologies in the blast furnace route, etc., to ensure that the technologies are very well up to date. So whatever plans we are buying are state of the art, up to date plans.

Amit Agicha: Thank you. That was very helpful. Thank you and all the best.

Rajesh Gupta: Thank you, sir.

Moderator: Thank you. As there are no further questions, we would like to hand the conference over to the management of Lloyds Metals And Energy Limited for closing comments.

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Rajesh Gupta: I would like to thank everybody for the active participation and the very interesting questions.

And happy Diwali to one and all. And wish all a happy and prosperous investing new year.

Thank you.

Moderator: Thank you, sir. On behalf of Equirus Securities Private Limited, that concludes this conference.

Thank you for joining us and you may now disconnect your lines.

Call: Dec 2024

Date: 24th October , 2024

To,
BSE Limited National Stock Exchange of India Limited
Phiroze Jeejeebhoy Towers, Exchange Plaza, Bandra Kurla Complex,
Dalal Street, Mumbai – 400001 Bandra (East), Mumbai - 400 051
BSE Scrip Code: 512455 NSE Symbol: LLOYDSME

Sub: Transcript of the Conference Call for investors and analysts for Business Update

Dear Sir/Madam,
Pursuant to the Regulation 30 of the Securities and Exchange Board of India (Listing Obligations and Disclosure Requirements) Regulations, 2015 (" Listing Regulations "), and in furtherance to our intimation dated 16th December , 2024 regarding Conference call with Analyst(s) /Investor(s) held on Thursday, 19th December, 2024 we would like to inform that the transcript of the aforesaid conference call is attached herewith and the same is also available on the website of the Company at www.lloyds.in/ .

The same may please be taken on record and suitably disseminated to all concerned.

Thanking you,
Yours Sincerely,
For Lloyds Metals and Energy Limited

Akshay Vora
Company Secretary
Membership No.: ACS43122
Page 1 of 15

"Lloyds Metals and Energy Limited
Update Call"
December 19, 2024

MANAGEMENT : MR. RAJESH GUPTA – MANAGING DIRECTOR –
LLOYDS METALS AND ENERGY LIMITED
MR. RIYAZ SHAIKH – CHIEF FINANCIAL OFFICER –
LLOYDS METALS AND ENERGY LIMITED
MR. HEMANKUR – DEPUTY CHIEF FINANCIAL
OFFICER – LLOYDS METALS AND ENERGY LIMITED

MODERATOR : MR. SIDDHARTH GADEKAR – EQUITUS SECURITIES
PRIVATE LIMITED

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Moderator: Ladies and gentlemen, good morning and welcome to the Update Call for Lloyds Metals and Energy Limited. As a reminder, all participant lines will remain in the listen -only mode and there will be an opportunity for you to ask questions after the presentation concludes. Should you need assistance during the conference call , please signal the operator by pressing star, then zero on your touchtone telephone.
Please note that this conference is being recorded. I now hand the conference over to Mr.

Siddharth Gadekar from Equirus Securities Pvt. Ltd. Thank you and over to you, sir.

Siddharth Gadekar: Good morning, everyone, and thank you for joining us today. We, at Equirus are pleased to host Lloyds Metals and Energy's Business Update Call to discuss the acquisition of the Thriveni's mining business and the other initiatives taken up by the company. We have with us today Mr. Rajesh Gupta, Managing Director, Mr. Riyaz Shaikh, CFO. Now I would like to invite Mr. Rajesh Gupta to initiate the proceedings for the call. Over to you, sir.

Rajesh Gupta: Good morning, everyone. It is a pleasure to welcome all of you to today's call. I would like to begin by thanking Siddharth and the team at Equirus for organizing and hosting this session.

A warm welcome to all our investors. We greatly value your time and interest in our company, Lloyds Metals. The purpose of today's call is to share some key updates on the strategic initiatives that we have undertaken recently and decided on our board meeting yesterday. These steps are part of a larger vision to establish Lloyds Metals as a strong, low-cost and high-efficient player in the steel and mining sector. Emphasis is now on going to be on managing the growth that we have charted for the next five years. Being in the steel and mining business, our focus is crystal clear, keeping costs at a minimum which enables us to stay resilient during challenging times like the current steel cycle.

Keeping this in mind, we have acquired a majority stake in Thriveni Earth movers Infrastructure Pvt. Ltd., which holds the mining development and operations segment of Thriveni Earth movers Pvt. Ltd. This move significantly strengthens the bond between our two co-promoters, creating a very formidable and collaborative partnership.

It allows us to ramp up our mining output at the Surjagarh Iron ore mine from the current 10 million tons to ultimately 25 million tons of output at a very effective cost. Beyond volume growth, this initiative will reduce mining costs substantially, reinforcing our operational competitiveness. The acquisition brings an impressive order book of INR70,000 crores over the next 15-18 years and is expected to add robust revenue and profit to the company, with cumulative revenues of approximately INR27,000 crores and EBITDA of INR9,000 crores between the next three years FY26-28.

These initiatives make our company stronger than ever, positioning us with a robust foundation and immense potential to deliver consistent performance and shareholder value. Of course, in the longer run, Lloyd Metal's strength in the balance sheet will grow international avenues for Thriveni as well. We have also partnered with Lekcon -NCC Consortium and ultimately with APMDC Andhra Pradesh Mineral Development Corporation to ensure supply of key raw materials.

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material like coking coal, where we will be having an MDO contract at the Brahmadaha Coal Block in Jharkhand.

This partnership is a critical step towards securing the supply of coking coal for our upcoming steel plant in Chandrapur with a capacity of 1.2 million tons of steel. Ensuring a steady and cost-effective supply of this raw material enhances our operational efficiency and strengthens our resilience. It is a vital step in aligning with our

long-term growth plans and diversifying our raw

metal resources and will stabilize our net coal costs at the new steel plant.

Regarding our green efforts, in line with our commitments, we have been investing continuously in green energy and green usage. We are now investing in two renewable energy projects to secure 100 MW of green power for capital consumption. These projects, executed in collaboration with Hinduja and with Amplus, a part of the Petronas Group, will serve our grinding units, slurry pipeline and pellet plant operations.

This shift to renewable energy will not only deliver annual cost saving of approximately INR100 crores, but also significantly reduce our carbon footprint, underscoring our commitment to environmental responsibility. Along with this, we have also in the past signed a contract with GAIL using LNG. This is in addition to our already ongoing efforts to run the mine itself on electrification instead of fossil fuel, which will make the mine near zero carbon in the very near future.

Our ultimate aim is to transform this business into a rare, non-metals business, which is non-cyclical one, ensuring sustainable growth and consistent value creation. Revenue is vanity and profitability is sanity will be the mantra going forward. Thank you for your attention, everybody. The floor is now open to your questions.

Moderator: Thank you. Ladies and gentlemen, we will now begin the question-and-answer session. The first question is from the line of Parthiv Shah from TSBPL. Please go ahead.

Parthiv Shah: Good morning, sir. And congratulations on this deal. Sir, I would really appreciate if you could explain in detail how exactly this deal is structured. No doubt it is there on your PowerPoint, but would like to hear it from you. Also, sir, I would appreciate to understand that, you know, the projections that have been given for the Thriveni MDO business, which goes right up to FY29. So, taking those numbers, by then even Lloyd's mining capacity would have been enhanced to

55 million tons.

So, what sort of contribution does Lloyd bring in that particular business and what other businesses we are targeting?

Rajesh Gupta: Regarding structure, I will request Hemankur, our Deputy CFO, to respond.

Hemankur: Hello. Good morning, everyone. So, I think we had outlined the slides. So, primarily, how it is structured is that Thriveni Earthmovers, which is housing the MDO business and some other family investments of the other co-promoters of Lloyd's Metals, Mr. Prabhakaran and his family, that is currently in the process of a de-merger. So, that de-merger is currently being heard at NCLT Chennai and it is expected to complete in 6 to 8 months. So, the process of demerger will Lloyds Metals and Energy Limited

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ultimately result in the MDO business being transferred to a new entity, which was formed earlier this year, and the entity is called Thriveni Earthmovers and Infra Limited.

The process of demerger is that MDO business is received by this company and redeemable preference shares are issued by them as a consideration to the shareholders of the original entity, which is including Mr. Prabhakaran and family and some other investors. Now, going forward, basically, Lloyd's will be investing into this entity. So, by investing an amount of INR70 crores, they will be acquiring near about 79.82% or 80% of the shareholding of this new entity. And thus, it will become a majority shareholder of the MDO business.

As a part of the deal, basically, as the majority shareholder is changing, so Lloyds, when coming in as a major shareholder, they are guaranteeing the redemption of redeemable preference shares, the amount of which is INR2,157 crores, and that will be redeemed over a period of three years, near about three years. So, last tranche is to be paid out by 31st March 2028. So, it's near about three-year i

ntallments, equal installments of INR700 crores to INR750 crores each. So, that's how the structure is consummated. We'll wait for the NCLT approval for MDO business to come in and RPS to be issued.

Parthiv Shah: So, does this bring also the equipment fleet and everything? And also, I just wanted to understand that instead of this, what else remains in Thriveni Earthmovers Private Limited? And instead of this, why not -- we would have entirely merged that company into Lloyd's Metals?

Hemankur: So, very good question. I think what remains in Thriveni Earthmovers are family investments.

We are not perry to what all other investments they have, but this includes the entire business, which is the MDO business, including all assets, amenities, manpower, equipment, workshops, fixed assets, the rebuild business, everything all put together. So, only what is remaining is primarily family investments. A major part, of course, we all know that they are holding near about 32% of Lloyds Metals shares. So, it would have been non-prudent to acquire a parent company and merge it. I mean, that would have been very complicated and very difficult. So, definitely this demerger was required for the business to be transferred into a new entity.

Parthiv Shah: Does this require any non-compete clause to be signed? So, going ahead in future, can Thriveni Earthmovers Private Limited bid for other MDO rights in other locations?

Hemankur: Can you repeat that please?

Parthiv Shah: Does this come with a non-compete clause? Can, in future, Thriveni Earthmovers Private Limited bid separately for other MDO contracts? Or in future, all the MDO contracts will be housed under Lloyd's only after this deal?

Hemankur: All the contracts will be housed under this new entity. Basically, the main idea for this acquisition or bringing the business together is primarily to align the interest so that both the co-promoters increase their alignment of business, and they share a major part of their family wealth in the same business. So, that's how it is going to continue. So, all the MDO businesses will be under this new entity. That is an undertaking given by the Thriveni promoters.

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Parthiv Shah: And as mentioned in the Slide 8, this deal, if I have to understand the valuation, it is happening at an enterprise valuation of INR4,952 crores. Is that correct?

Hemankur: Yes, that's right.

Parthiv Shah: So, the debt which is brought on to Lloyds book from Thriveni's book is, I think, debt related to all the equipment that has been purchased. So, that's how the equipment is also coming into Lloyds book, right?

Hemankur: Yes, yes, correct. So, it includes working capital, it includes equipment finance loan, it includes term loans which are taken for the business of MDO.

Parthiv Shah: Okay. Last question...

Rajesh Gupta: Just to simplify, all the operating assets of the Thriveni Earthmovers Private Limited will be moving to Thriveni Earthmovers and Infra Private Limited.

Parthiv Shah: Okay. And sir, going ahead, what happens to the 20% stake which is in private capacity? Will Lloyd s be also acquiring that and making it a 100% subsidiary?

Rajesh Gupta: So, both the promoters will be controlling part of this, and part will be with some other shareholders of Thriveni Earthmovers Private Limited,

Parthiv Shah: Okay. And sir, last question. You mentioned that there will be around 10 % to 15% addition in the mining margins of Lloyds' existing mining operations. So, on a per ton basis, what does that percolate into?

Hemankur: So, see, basically for our mining business, there will be a 10 % to 15% addition because of the combination of the MDO business margins. Primarily, as has been outlined, I think, earlier by Mr. Rajesh, roughly 50% of the MDO cost is primarily margin for the MDO. That as a percentage of our revenues f

or mining, which is, le t's say, near about INR4,500 -odd. So, that INR500 on that is primarily the 10 % to 15% margin increase which is happening.

Parthiv Shah: So, around INR500 per ton is savings for Lloyd s with having this MDO operation?

Rajesh Gupta: Yes, all consolidated.

Parthiv Shah: Thank you very much. That answers all my questions. All the best for the future.

Moderator: Thank you. The next question comes from the line of Parthiv from Anand Rathi . Please go ahead.

Parthiv: Hi. Thank you for the opportunity. Congratulations on the new structure, sir. I just had a couple of quick questions. If you can just walk me through one of the slides, you have mentioned that the total guarantee is up to INR2,500 crores. So, what exactly -- am I reading it wrong or is it INR2,157 crores? I am not able to get that. I think Slide 5 you have mentioned somewhere.

Hemankur: See, basically the RPS being issued is INR2,157. But of course, if we see the RPS terms, because they will be redeemed over a period of time. So, there is a 9.5% coupon which is payable on Lloyds Metals and Energy Limited

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them. So, to account for that, we have kept that buffer. But the redemption amount is primarily going to the principal amounts. And this coupon will be payable in case the dividend is paid by the company. So, that is why that amount has been built in to keep a cushion for that buffer.

Parthiv: So, my second question is remaining to that another 3.08% which is with the other shareholders . Does Lloyds or have any info on that, that in future they will be acquiring at a certain valuation if it comes up? Anything on that front?

Hemankur: So, the 3.08% is actually with one of the clients which is there for the MDO business. And they have been 6.5% shareholders in the original Thriveni Holding Company. So, as a part of the negotiations and as a part of the agreement with them, this has been negotiated to have them the 3.08%. And that is one of the conditions that they have agreed to this transaction. And they will conti nue with us to be in the longer run.

Rajesh Gupta: This particular shareholder has been a partner with Thriveni since the beginning of the journey of Thriveni.

Parthiv : Okay. Got it. And sir my last question is what is the saving you mentioned when this business becomes a subsidiary? It's INR500 per ton for Lloyds?

Rajesh Gupta: Again, on a consolidated basis that's approximately the margin INR350 to INR500 depending on the month, the year, the type of iron ore coming out, etc. That's the approximate margin on the total contract that is currently with Thriveni. So, that will get consolidated into the books of Lloyds Metals consolidated . That's the figure that we are talking about.

Parthiv: Okay, thank you. That answers most of my questions. Thank you so much.

Moderator: Thank you. The next question comes from the line of Siddharth Gadekar from Equirus Securities Private Limited . Please go ahead.

Siddharth Gadekar: Hi, sir. Good morning. So, when we look at the slide number 6 or the kind of EB ITDA that Thriveni MDO operations would be doing, can you just outline what all projects are there in the MDO business besides the Lloyd Metal mining operations?

Rajesh Gupta: So, the kind of projects that are there is Pakri Barwadih is one project with NTPC , where we are mining around 16 million, 18 million tons of coal there. We are mining around 35 mil lion tons of iron ore in Odisha in around 5 or 7 mines. We are mining bar ytes for APMDC, around 3 million tons. And we are mining around 5 million tons of coal in Indonesia in Satui Coal Project. So, approximately 71 million tons including Lloyd Metal current is the EC or the total limit of the contracts today. And I would also like to refer all the participants to our website where we have uploaded a more detailed presentation which will give det ails of all thes

e contracts etc. on

that site in cluding a geographical map etc. showing the total business of Thriveni in a more detailed way.

Siddharth Gadekar: Okay, got it. And secondly, in terms of the new coking coal project in Andhra Pradesh, even there we will be participating as a MDO th rough this entity itself?

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Rajesh Gupta: No, that project for some reasons of stronger balance sheet etc., APMDC required Lloyd Metal to participate directly, but the subcontract will be given to this entity, yes.

Siddharth Gadekar: Okay, so lastly when we look at our growth projects now, given that we would be moving towards 55 million tons EC in the next by FY26, incrementally in the EBITDA assumptions, how should we think about Lloyd's contribution in that?

Rajesh Gupta: So, just to clarify one thing the 55 million tons is the raw material. The output would be constrained at 25 million tons of finished iron ore. After the BHQ is benefited. I couldn't understand the other part of your question.

Siddharth Gadekar: Basically, I wanted to understand that out of the INR3,000 crores EBITDA that Thriveni is forecasting for the next 2 years, 3 years per annum, what would be the contribution coming from Lloyd Metal in that?

Hemankur: So, I think basically the contribution will change as the production ramps up, but I think your question is more related to when we are mining the full capacity of 55 million tons because that will be a significant part of Thriveni's numbers. So, roughly one-third or 33% to 35% is the range that is there in those numbers coming from the Lloyd's contracts of 55 million tons.

Siddharth Gadekar: Okay, sir. Got it. Thank you so much.

Moderator: Thank you. The next question comes from the line of Nikunj Lahoti an Investor. Please go ahead.

Nikunj Lahoti: Hello, sir. My question is like you have manufactured two slurry pipelines. One of capacity of - you would be manufacturing, one 10 million ton and one 5 million ton slurry pipeline. So, how would you transport the last 10 million ton?

Rajesh Gupta: So, part of the materials whatever transportation we do will be through slurry pipelines. The 10 million tons that you are talking about would be transported as we are currently transporting by truck to the railway siding and to our customers as the case may be.

Nikunj Lahoti: Okay. So, you would transport the last 10 million ton by railway siding?

Hemankur: Yes.

Nikunj Lahoti: And 15 million ton through slurry pipelines?

Hemankur: Yes.

Management: And as we expand, actually a significant portion of that will be done by Thriveni's MDO business also. So, part of that contract, which was earlier under the transport contract, would also get consolidated into Lloyd's profitability.

Nikunj Lahoti: Thank you sir.

Moderator: Thank you. The next question comes from the line of Divy Agrawal from Ficom Family Office. Please go ahead.

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Divy Agrawal: Thanks for taking my questions. So, I have two questions. First, on this merger, I mean, Thriveni Earthmovers, I believe, have mines as well. They own mines. So, are we getting the mines as well as the MDO business or just the MDO business apart from those mines?

Management: The Earthmovers control no mines by itself.

Divy Agrawal: Okay. So, Thriveni Earthmovers don't own any mines?

Rajesh Gupta: It's a pure play MDO service business.

Divy Agrawal: Okay. Sure, sir. And secondly, regarding the guarantees given by Lloyd's Metal to Thriveni Earthmovers, just in case Thriveni Earthmovers redeems those guarantees in its funds, so will Thriveni Infra repay the amount to Lloyd's Metal or how will be the transaction then?

Hemankur: So, see basically as a part of the demerger. So, there are two parts to the overall transaction. One is that demerger

happens, and Thriveni Infra would have redeemed this RPS as per the shareholders which is the same shareholders for Thriveni Earthmovers and Thriveni Infra, which is Mr. Prabhakaran and family. Now, because that is changing and Lloyd's Metals is coming in as a majority shareholder, so, the two shareholders on the issuer and the receipt or holders of the RPS is different.

So, that's why this guarantee is being given. That Thriveni Infra will timely redeem this as per the agreed schedule and the guarantee is primarily given for that. Ideally, what we have seen from the cash flows, it should be able to self-service from the existing business as we ramp up and scale up.

Only in an event of eventuality that is not achieved for whatever purpose, in that case, the guarantee of Lloyd's Metals will come in, wherein they will have to either bridge the gap or take over on some of those obligations. And that can be done either way. It can be either through purchase of RPS or it can be through equity infusion in Thriveni Infra, which will then redeem. So, yes, ultimately, it will be paid by the business. Only thing that can happen is that Thriveni Infra, I mean, only thing that can happen is that if it is not in three years, Lloyd's Metals will get

back the money in four years. So, that's the only eventuality that can happen in a worst-case scenario. But yes, that will effectively be paid out of the profits of the MDO business which is being acquired.

Divy Agrawal : Okay, sure, sir. And last question. So, this INR70 crores valuation for Thriveni Infra, so how did you arrive at that INR70 crores?

Hemankur: Yes, so INR70 crores is just face value. So, actually, it's being acquired at nominal face value. So, that INR70 crores effectively will remain in the company. Because the company is a shell company without the MDO business. So, it's just INR70 crores infusion and INR70 crores sitting on the cash. So, cash is the value for that.

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Divy Agrawal: Okay, so basically, if we see, so Lloyd's Metals is paying INR70 crores and we are getting the end-to-end business plus the guarantees. And if the guarantees are non-traded, so Lloyd's Metals eventually will pay just INR70 crores getting the business.

Hemankur: No, INR70 crores is actually infused in this company and INR70 crores will be used by the company for developing the business of MDO. So, INR70 crores is not paid out to any of the promoters. It will remain with the company.

So, effectively, 80% of that, actually, total infusion is INR87.7 crores, which is INR70 crores is Lloyd's Metals and INR17 crores is roughly by other investors. And all put together, so effectively, Lloyd's Metals owns 80% of that INR87.7 crores. So, effectively, it owns INR70 crores of cash as a part of 80% shareholding. So, that's the, it's done at nominal value, face value only.

Moderator: Thank you. The next question comes from the line of Vikas h Singh from Phil lip Capital. Please go ahead.

Vikas Singh : Congratulations, sir, on the successful completion of this. Sir, I have two clarifications, basically. Firstly, you said that you would be saving, after this merger, roughly about INR500 per ton.

While we expect, you know, our previous call in Lloyd's Metals, , we were paying roughly about INR1000 plus per ton and this was expected to come INR800 per ton. So, why the net savings is less than what we are paying actually right now?

Rajesh Gupta: Thank you, Vikas h, for your question. We had said around INR300 -INR350 of saving once the total quantity comes up, from, including slurry pipeline. So, that's number one. We are mixing up two different issues of slurry pipeline saving and quantity of mining saving. Now, the third play is the consolidation of balance sheet. What we are saying is the INR500, the profitability of the contract of Lloyd's Metals with Thriveni

. If that profitability, that will get consolidated into Lloyd's Metals balance sheet. The other figures remain the same.

Vikas Singh : Understood, sir. Sir, my second question pertains to our guarantees of this, up to INR2500 crores. Is this guaranteed based on achieving the projected EBITDA milestone or it is irrespective of the EBITDA, and this is at the current, today's junction, we are ready to pay this much?

Rajesh Gupta: There is no EBITDA milestone. It is to be paid in three years .

Vikas Singh : Okay. So, basically there is no milestone for these things.

Rajesh Gupta: Yes.

Moderator: Thank you. The next question comes from the line of Ashutosh Somani from JM Financial. Please go ahead.

Ashutosh Somani : Thanks for taking my question. My question relates to the Karnataka mining business and just wanted to hear your thoughts on if Maharashtra can go the Karnataka way given how strategically important we have become as a resource miner in the country and with the increased

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EC more so and the fact that we are the lowest cost producer in the country. So, how do you see this developing situation?

Rajesh Gupta: Number one, the Karnataka mining tax doesn't affect LME L directly and as such we have no direct comments. Number two, other states have not levied other such taxes and such extent of taxes like Karnataka has including Chhattisgarh, Odisha, etc etera . They are still taking a call on what to do, what not to do. So, maybe Karnataka is the outlier and not the norm or would not become the norm.

Number three, does Maharashtra can they levy such taxes? As per the Supreme Court order, yes, they can levy such taxes. Currently, as we know, there are other movements happening in the Maharashtra Mantralaya and there is no such movement to levy any such taxes in Maharashtra at the moment.

Moderator: Thank you. The next question comes from the line of Prateek Singh from DAM Capital. Please go ahead.

Prateek Singh : Hi, sir, and thanks for this opportunity. First of all, congrats for this development to participate in the growing mining story of India. Just had the – most of the questions are answered but just had a query on top of Ashutosh 's questions. I understand that other states are still not following it, but this is a major development where the Centre can put their foot down. By your experience, how are contracts in the MDO business structured?

Are they like for 3 -4 years or long -term or is the pricing decided on an yearly basis? The basis for my question is in case, let's say, some miners get a duty hike, and their margins are kind of affected on the lower side. Have you seen a history where they come and say that, you know, we'll be paying you a bit lower on a per ton basis because our margins are getting squeezed? Or that's not something which usually happens?

Rajesh Gupta: Firstly, let me congratulate DAM on their IPO and best of luck for the same. Regarding this, the nature of the contracts, it's a mixed bag. For example, with NTPC, it's a long -term contract of 28 years, 27 years, which is still balance With Lloyd s Metal s, it's till the life of the mine which is till 2057. APMDC is a 5 -year contract. The other mines are for 5 years or some of them are 10 years, some of them are till the life of the mine.

So, it's a very mixed bag. Most of the times, once you get an MDO, you can take it that the contract is there for the life of the mine because it's difficult for both the contractor and the mine owner to change. When we say MDO, it's not only mining contract but also the outside boundaries including the CSR, the transport, the permissions required, etc etc .

So, these are definitely long -term contracts. One of the reasons that we like Thriveni Investment is that it gives us foreseeable revenue of INR70,000 crores on the existing contracts that are there

. The second part of your question is what happens if somebody wants to back out? Most commercial contracts have such clauses .

And always at the end of the day, any contractor, any client relationship was on a win -win basis, and we had to take the hit if it is required to be taken. Thriveni has taken such hits in much larger

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ways in Odisha when the Shah Commission had come in or when COVID had happened and that's part of the business of any such business.

In Lloyd's Group also we have businesses like Lloyd's Engineering where these are longer -term contracts or where we deal with such ifs and buts on a continuous basis.

Prateek Singh: And on the other side, does it also open up opportunities for us because some PSUs or some subsidiaries of Coal India who are not very efficient in case their costs go up because of royalty, that opens opportunities for us because we would be more efficient on a Per ton basis to mine so it opens up new areas for us also in terms of business .

Rajesh Gupta: All the projections that we are given are basis current contracts that are existing. Like I mentioned in my opening remarks, we believe that the experience of Thriveni along with the strength of the balance sheet will open up many more avenues for Thriveni . And therefore, ultimately for Lloyd Metal in the consolidated balance sheet including international contracts around the world .

Whether it is coal, whether it is iron ore, whether it is bauxite, whether it is chromite, copper, gold, anything. We are in that business now and definitely we will be able to compete we hope with the rest of the world in a very competitive way. In our detailed slide on the website, you will see that one of the very important parts of Thriveni's business is the rebuilding of equipment. Over the last 10 years, they have saved around INR3,000 crores in equipment cost. In some ways, the mining business is like a revenue generator based on it is a lease business also. If you save around 70%, 80% of the cost of the equipment, that 's a very big revenue over the life of the contract.

With all those features in the company and we hope that the partnership will become not only Thriveni stronger but even Lloyds stronger.

Hemankur: Just to add, on the contract , Thriveni has lost very few contracts in the past. Most of the contracts have run till the mine owner has been running. For example, Indrani Patnaik, D.R. Patnaik, they in fact are the 3.08% shareholders that we talked about. So, few mines are owned by them. And similarly, other large miners also, whosoever has been partnering with Thriveni, they have run till those miners continue to hold the contracts.

So, that's one of the key uniqueness of the business that they have generally not lost contracts, very few of them. That's one. And second is that they have not participated in contracts which are too competitive just for the purpose of order book. So, as I think Rajesh mentioned in his opening remarks that profit is sanity . And that's what Thriveni has been following, that's one of the key things which is aligning the business of Lloyd's and Thriveni's MDO business.

So, I think if the contracts are very competitive because there are a lot of MDO contracts, as you mentioned regarding Coal India and other companies, but if it requires a very large amount of investment with long paybacks, that's not something Thriveni has been doing. They have been

doing and taking opportunistic contracts wherein they can add value and wherein other people are not able to probably compete with their technical capability and skill.

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Rajesh Gupta: Also to add one more point, Thriveni at one point was mining around 65% of the iron ore in Odisha. When years back in 2002 when the China demand picked up, the mine capacity

was

around 35 -40 million tons and today Odisha is mining around 120 million tons, and I think Mr. Prabhakaran and Thriveni have been a very large instrument in picking up the mining capacity of that steel and therefore of the country.

Prateek Singh: Thanks sir and all the best and I hope that you are already very big, and I hope that you become bigger enabler of mining in India.

Moderator: The next question comes from the line of Mr. Siddharth Gadekar from Equirus Securities .

Siddharth Gadekar: Sir, we have also mentioned in the presentation that these forecasts do not include any future projects. Can you give us some sense on the future projects that we would be targeting in terms of mining in India and overseas? Secondly, when we had visited the mine, the kind of infrastructure that we had created, we could also leverage that for mining in Maharashtra as well. So, any sense on how do we see this business scaling up beyond the existing projects?

Rajesh Gupta: Sir, we would not like to give any forward -looking statements like you know. We would definitely be working very strongly in Maharashtra. Odisha has become more and more competitive with the advent of the 120 % regime in Odisha. So, it's a very competitive market. We are mining there in OMC. I forgot to mention that in our earlier statements. We are mining in the Guali mine in OMC company.

So, we will be bidding, again I repeat, for mineral assets in India and abroad as a mining contractor based on cost effectiveness, profitability, geographical sense. For example, the Jharkhand mine that we are doing with APMDC is very close to Pakri Barwadih . Sorry, I am a little bad in the pronunciation of that company. So, it is very close to that. And that 's one big advantage that we have there.

So, all those kind of things we will take not purely for revenue but for the bottom line more.

Siddharth Gadekar: Okay, so got it. Thank you so much.

Moderator: The next question comes from the line of Aman from Seven Rivers. Please go ahead.

Aman: Hi, sir. So, if you could help me understand, is there any difference in per ton cost for BHQ mining versus the ore that we are mining right now? Are we saying that we will save 50% of the respective amount?

Rajesh Gupta: No, the cost comes down because of the volumes getting added more than the grade of the ore. For example, the overburden in the coal mining is being built; including the overburden cost is being built to cost to the miner. So here if it is coming down - it is coming down because of the sheer quantity going up and therefore the fixed cost going down per ton basis.

Aman: And my second question is, are we looking at any change in active management of the mining operations or will it be status quo in terms of management at let's say mid ...

Rajesh Gupta: Sorry I couldn't understand the question ?

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Management: No, the MDO management is very well run and there would be no change in that at all.

Aman: Okay that's all. Thank you sir.

Moderator: The next question comes from Namit Arora from Ingrowth Capital . Please go ahead.

Namit Arora: Yes, thank you for the opportunity. Congratulations to the teams on the deal and all the best for the integration. So, my question was in terms of investments to further enhance value from your acquired assets, both in terms of capital and talent . Any thoughts on that which could help you take it to the next level post your acquisition? Thank you.

Management: Sorry, I couldn't understand the question, my friend .

Namit Arora: The question is that post to acquisition, what are the kind of investments that you may need to do, both in terms of capital and talent, to further realize the potential of this acquisition?

Management: In the new Thriveni company .

Namit Arora: Yes sir.

Rajesh Gupta: I think the capital allotment of that business

would grow as it acquires new businesses. We will

be looking at growth in capital as the opportunities come up over the next two, three, four years.

In terms of talent, with the confidence of the company in Lloyd Metal like you know many of the - not many - all the white -collar workers have ESOP so hope to introduce that process in Thriveni MDO also.

So that will get more talent to us as well. These kinds of things is an ongoing process and Thriveni is a INR8,000, INR9,000 crores top line company larger than Lloyd Metal at the moment or nearly as large as Lloyd Metal at the moment. So, they are very well in the ballgame to get the best talent in the country. One thing we have learnt from them as MDO, and client relationship is how to manage the people. I hope they can teach me more going forward on that. Namit Arora: Got it. Thank you for your detailed thoughts which are most helpful. All the best to the entire team. Thank you.

Moderator: The next question comes from the line of Nikunj Lahoti an Investor. Please go ahead.

Nikunj Lahoti: Sir, what is the current freight cost for if you are mining 10 million tons and what would be freight cost in future if you are mining 25 million tons and after starting off with both the slurry pipelines?

Rajesh Gupta: Nikunji, thank you very much. With our freight costs are to various places around INR4.5 to INR5 per kilometer. So, we take some of the metal up to the stock yard, we take up some of the metal up to the siding. We transport some of the materials to the end consumer directly by truck.

We have one of the few companies in India which - I would say few companies in the world which take up mineral right up to the customer's doorstep in many, many ways. In fact, right now we have done a contract for fitting the material up to Khandala from the mine.

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So, to give a very direct answer, freight cost per ton is not a straightforward answer, unfortunately. The costs going forward for the 10 million tons that is balanced, not going by pipeline would remain in the same mix. Most of this would be to outside customers, but would remain in the same mix of INR4.50-INR5. The pipeline transport cost is in the range of INR150, INR100 per ton.

Nikunj Lahoti: Thank you, sir.

Rajesh Gupta: Does that address your concern?

Nikunj Lahoti: Yes, thank you sir.

Moderator: The next question comes from the line of Parthiv Shah from TSBPL. Please go ahead.

Parthiv Shah: Thank you for taking my question Rajesh. Sir, just wanted to understand, you just mentioned that Thriveni Earthmovers Private Limited as an MDO there was a top line of INR8,000 to INR9,000 crores. But sir, why is it not getting reflected in the PPT projections? For FY'25, the revenue shows INR5,500 and then subsequently in FY '26 they showed INR8,000 and then it stays kind of flat between 27 to 29.

Rajesh Gupta: Yes, I meant to say INR8,000 going forward with the 55 million ton of evacuation that they'll do in Surjagarh, INR5,000 or INR 5,500 crores is the current top line.

Parthiv Shah: Okay and sir in Surjagarh, I think there were other players who had want some composite mining licenses so will like now you being an MDO as well will you be aggressively bidding for those projects also and by when can we expect that revenue picking, how many years it might take?

Rajesh Gupta: So those contracts for those mines are all on including exploration, etc. Those mines are now, we understand some of them have started some exploration activities. As and when people approach us, we'll be glad to interact with and work with them closely to get the mineral out and make Surjagarh and Maharashtra into the Prime Minister vision of the next Jamshedpur.

Parthiv Shah: So, you have not projected all that till your FY'25?

Rajesh Gupta: All the projections that have happened

in that slide number seven are of existing contracts that

are there, including the 55 million tons of Surjagarh mining of our own mine.

Parthiv Shah: And sir by when they are expected to get the EC of 55 million ton mining?

Rajesh Gupta: That is a very nice question. We state has been under because of the elections that cycle has slowed down a little bit than what we anticipated. We hope to have the public hearing of that mine in the next month and then going forward it will take 45 days hopefully to get the MDO done, again the EC done.

Rajesh Gupta: The process is fully on except for a pause due to the election where such issues are not legally allowed to take place.

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Parthiv Shah: Sir, I pardon my ignorance, but I was under the impression that we being a five-star rated mine, we don't need a public hearing.

Rajesh Gupta: The public hearing is not required if we increase by 20%. Here we are increasing by 250%.

Parthiv Shah: Okay, thank you. All the best.

Moderator: The next question comes from the line of Aman from Seven Rivers. Please go ahead.

Aman: Hi sir. So, can you tell us about the promoters pledge by Thriveni? Will that... anything outside of that will be released soon as an outcome of this.

Rajesh Gupta: Again, that would have to be discussed with Thriveni promoters at that point of time. But we understand that part of these funds would be able to dilute those pledges and once the RPS goes and that happens. So, over a period that pledges would be removed we hope.

Moderator: As there are no further questions, I would now hand the conference over to the management for their closing comments .

Management: Gentleman, thank you very much for all the interesting questions . We are in a very different growth phase right now compared to what we started around three years back . I call myself a 50-year-old start -up and I think some of the se moves that we have done in the last few weeks are a testament to that , and we hope to live up to all the targets that we have set to ourselves.

Thank you.

Moderator: Thank you. On behalf of Lloyds Metal s & Energy Limited that concludes this conference. Thank you for joining us and you may now disconnect your lines.

Call: Feb 2025

Date: 3rd February , 2025

To,
BSE Limited National Stock Exchange of India Limited
Phiroze Jeejeebhoy Towers, Exchange Plaza, Bandra Kurla Complex,
Dalal Street, Mumbai – 400001 Bandra (East), Mumbai - 400 051
BSE Scrip Code: 512455 NSE Symbol: LLOYDSME

Sub: Transcript of the Conference Call for investors and analysts for Q3 FY25

Dear Sir/Madam,
Pursuant to the Regulation 30 of the Securities and Exchange Board of India (Listing Obligations and Disclosure Requirements) Regulations, 2015 (" Listing Regulations "), and in furtherance to our intimation dated 23rd January , 2025 regarding Conference call with Analyst(s) /Investor(s) held on Wednesday , 29th January, 2025 we would like to inform that the transcript of the aforesaid conference call is attached herewith and the same is also available on the website of the Company at <https://lloyds.in/earnings-call/>.

The same may please be taken on record and suitably disseminated to all concerned.
Thanking you,
Yours Sincerely, For Lloyds Metals and Energy Limited

Akshay Vora Company Secretary
Membership No.: ACS 43122

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"Lloyds Metals and Energy Limited
Q3 FY '25 Earnings Conference Call "
January 29, 2025

MANAGEMENT : MR. RAJESH GUPTA – MANAGING DIRECTOR –
LLOYDS METALS AND ENERGY LIMITED
MR. RIYAZ SHAIKH – CHIEF FINANCIAL OFFICER –
LLOYDS METALS AND ENERGY LIMITED

MODERATOR : MR. PRATEEK SINGH – DAM CAPITAL

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Moderator: Ladies and gentlemen, good day, and welcome to Lloyds Metal and Energy Limited Q3 FY '25 Earnings Conference Call hosted by DAM Capital. As a reminder, all participant lines will be in the listen -only mode and there will be an opportunity for you to ask questions after the presentation concludes. Should you need assistance during the conference call, please signal an operator by pressing star then zero on your touchtone phone. Please note that this conference is being recorded.

I now hand the conference over to Mr. Prateek Singh from DAM Capital. Thank you, and over to you, sir.

Prateek Singh: Thanks, Manav. Good evening, everybody, and thank you for joining us today. We, at DAM Capital, are pleased to host Lloyds Metals and Energy's Third Quarter and 9-month FY '25 Results Conference Call. We have with us today from the management, Mr. Rajesh Gupta, Managing Director; Mr. Riyaz Shaikh, CFO.

Without further ado, now I would like to invite Mr. Rajesh Gupta to initiate the proceedings for the call. Thanks, and over to you, sir.

Rajesh Gupta: Good evening, everyone, and thanks, Prateek, for taking this call. Thank you all for taking the

time to join our conference call here. Connecting with the investor community and sharing updates on our business is always a great pleasure. I will first give a brief update on our operations and the status of our ongoing projects. After that, Riyaz, our CFO, will take you through the financials.

Let us begin with our 9 months FY '25 performance overview, which has been more than satisfactory, I would say. Our sponge iron division recorded highest ever production during the 9-month period at both the plants and are operating at optimum capacity utilization. In regard to our iron ore segment, the 9-month dispatches stood at 7.8 million tons and for Q3, it was 2.4 million tons. We are fully mobilized to mine and dispatch 25 million tons with the expectation that the EC shall be received in time by the end of this current quarter.

Now let me give you some other project updates. Execution has been one of our biggest strengths, having demonstrated this with the slurry pipeline, which is completed 85 kilometres, awaiting the pellet plant and the DRI plant completed last year in around 13, 14 months after the EC. The current ongoing projects are the DRI at Ghugus and the 4-million-ton pellet plant, both are nearing completion. Commissioning and testing has started and should be operational latest by this quarter end or maybe early next quarter.

On our 1.2-million-ton steel plant, at Chandrapur, the designing is complete. The layouts are ready. And the orders for the major equipment have been given. The EC has been applied for, and the land has been acquired. For The BHQ beneficiation plant, and the pilot plant has been ready for the last 8 months and has consistently delivered Fe content of 66% and beyond and a yield of 37% to 40%, which is better than our original expectation. Primary engineering is complete, and the equipment procurement is currently in progress. The land and other legal formalities required to take it fully forward is underway.

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In summary, our project execution is progressing smoothly, and we remain confident of completing it well in time of our original schedules. I would like to mention specifically that we believe in Lloyds Metals being cost competitive. This has come as an imperative in the current market scenario. We have implemented several measures to ensure that our cost of steelmaking remain under check and our profits stay sustainable in the long run.

Our investments in Thriveni MDO business is a strategic move in this direction and would yield significantly benefits over the years. On fully consolidated, it is expected to result in meaning

ful

earnings accretion

Now I would like to hand over to Riyaz who will explain the financials in more detail. Over to you, Riyaz.

Riyaz Shaikh: Thank you, Rajeshji. Good evening, everyone. It's a pleasure to be here today to share our financial and operational performance for 9 months FY '25 and quarter 3 FY '25. Despite a dynamic and challenging market environment, we are pleased to report that we have delivered strong growth across key segments, driven by higher volumes in iron ore and sponge iron. Our ability to navigate market fluctuations, optimize resources and maintain cost efficiency has helped us achieve a resilient performance this quarter. Let us delve into the financial performance for 9 months FY '25.

Our revenue grew by 11% year-on-year, supported by robust iron ore and sponge iron volume.

What's particularly encouraging is that our iron ore segment saw higher sales and improved realization. Sponge iron volumes also remained on an upward trajectory, further strengthening our revenue base.

On the EBITDA front, we witnessed a robust 31% year-on-year growth, mirroring our revenue performance. The strong momentum was primarily led by iron ore and sponge iron. While market conditions for sponge iron continue to be volatile, our operational efficiency and captive raw material source have provided a strong cushion against price fluctuations.

Now we will get into the specifics with segment-wise highlights. Iron ore. The iron ore business continued to be a key driver of our overall growth. Realizations per ton improved by 8% year-on-year in quarter 3 FY '25 to INR 5,894 and by 10% year-on-year for 9 months FY '25 to INR 5,718. Our EBITDA per ton for quarter 3 FY '25 was INR 2,021, marking a 21% year-on-year increase. While for 9 months, FY '25, it stood at INR 1,860, reflecting the same 21% growth.

Turning to DRI and Power. In the DRI segment, we recorded 78,000 tons in quarter 3 FY '25 and 239,000 tons in 9 months FY '25. While realizations were muted in quarter 3 FY '25, our captive iron ore supplies played a crucial role in protecting margins, ensuring stable profitability even in the fluctuating market. In the Power segment, volumes remained flat year-on-year and muted power prices in quarter 3 FY '25 had an impact on the EBITDA. However, we continue to optimize efficiencies in this space to counter market challenges.

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On the capex front, the company has spent INR 2,700 crores in the 9 months FY '25 and a total of INR4,400 crores till date. Looking ahead, despite some volatility in pricing, our integrated operations and strategic planning have ensured a stable and resilient performance. As we move forward, we will continue to focus on cost efficiencies, value maximization and strengthening our market positioning.

Prateek, now we can open the floor for the question-and-answer session.

Moderator: We have our first question from the line of Parthiv Jhonsa from Anand Rathi.

Parthiv Jhonsa: So, I have got actually a couple of questions. Sir, the first question pertains to the mine's EC. I believe there was a public hearing which was there yesterday on 28th. Is it possible to know the status? And what is the progress on it? And by when can we expect the EC to come in? And once the EC comes in, how long it takes for the expansion to actually kick in? That's my first question, sir.

Rajesh Gupta: The public hearing was held yesterday in Gadchiroli under the aegis of the Government of Maharashtra, the collector, et c. And it went off well. The usual questions were asked, some queries were there relating to environment and employment, which were expected, and they have been addressed and now we await the outcome from the district administration. It will go to the Centre from there, and then there will be a final EC committee meeting. The whole process, should take 60 to 70 days.

s, to complete.

Parthiv Jhonsa: So, in 60 to 70 days, you mean the EC should come in? Or it is another couple of months after that?

Rajesh Gupta: Yes, our worst case expectation.

Parthiv Jhonsa: Okay. Sir, my second question was that you have done, I think, about 7.8 million, 7.9 million ton kind of sales of iron ore in the first 9 months, right? So, can you give the guidance for remaining part? Like it will be completely 10 million ton, so about 2.2 million ton in the fourth quarter. Is my reading correct?

Rajesh Gupta: Yes, that's pretty correct.

Parthiv Jhonsa: Okay. And sir, one place in the presentation you had mentioned that once the MDO business integration is completed, there'll be almost about, INR400 to INR 500 of cost saving in the iron ore side of the business. So, can you throw some light on it that when can this come and when can these savings play out? What is the timeline for the same?

Riyaz Shaikh: See, the NCLT process is going on. The company has to first go on through the NCLT for the demerger. So, the business, as we have already mentioned that the MDO business will be coming in from 1st of April. So, all the effect would be coming in from 1st of April 2025 post the NCLT order is received. So, the entire business comes into this company from 1st April 2025. So, it will be for the next financial year.

Parthiv Jhonsa: Okay. So basically, my question was will this benefit kick in from the day one itself?

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Riyaz Shaikh: Yes. Since it will be under the same umbrella, it was a consolidated figure. So, it will be kicking in from the immediate basis, with the increased EC limits.

Rajesh Gupta: With the effective date being 1st of April 2025.

Moderator: We have our next question from the line of Vikash Singh from PhillipCapital.

Vikash Singh: Sir, just wanted to understand, once the EC is in place, how long will it take to ramp it up to the previously desired guidance levels of that 15 million, 20 million or even 25 million tons? So, if you could give us some timeline over there.

Rajesh Gupta: So, there are two aspects to the physical execution. One is the physical mining and excavation, and one is the evacuation. As far as the mining is concerned, we have machinery in place through Thriveni to do the mining. And at peak times, we have done 1.8 million tons also in a month.

So, 2.2 million tons roughly, in the first 1.5, 2 years, we would be not going in for any beneficiation. It will be a current process of direct sales zone. So that 2 million tons of excavation and loading onto trucks doesn't seem very difficult.

Regarding the evacuation, like I mentioned earlier, our pipeline of 10 million tons is in place.

By the time the grinding plant and the pellet plant is ready, the 5 million tons will be transported through that and pro rata 15 million, 20 million tons would be dispatched through the normal route. So, we would have, therefore, a big support of the pipeline in helping us in evacuation. And therefore, we see that there will be not major worries in achieving the evacuation either.

The day the EC happens, and the other legal formalities happen, we hope to be ready with the mining from day 1 within the first 30 days.

Vikash Singh: Understood. And sir, just one clarification. Until the beneficiation project comes in, we can actually go up to 25 million ton in the high-grade ore or we will cap our high-grade ore at a certain capacity and that 25 million ton, like you previously said, is a mix of 15 million-ton of low-grade beneficiated and 10 million ton of high grade, but then until that comes which is 27...

Rajesh Gupta: Yes. In the year FY '28, the mix would be 10 million tons of DSO and 15 million tons of

beneficiated ore. Prior to that, step -by-step, we will be achieving 25 million tons total. So, in the first year, it will be 25 milli

on tons of DSO directly.

Vikash Singh: Understood. But then my second question comes that DSO reserves seems to be pretty limited. So once if we utilize that 15 million and 25 million tons, if I'm not correct, we will be left with only with 45 million, 50 million ton of DSO, which is not sufficient, more than 4 to 5 years of high-grade ore. So just wanted to understand about the -- how we should look at the mine life of DSO versus the low grade going forward?

Rajesh Gupta: The reserves of DSO are 157 million, 160 million tons as per the Tata report, which has been certified by JORC. So, I don't know where you have observed the figure of 70 million tons , it's 157 million tons of DSO and around 700 million tons of BHQ. So, by the third year, we'll go down to 10 million tons of DSO to preserve the ratio for the next 35 years.

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Vikash Singh: Understood, sir. And sir, just one last question, basically, on this environmental clearance. Once we get the clearance, from state, we need only the consent to operate, right? There is not much formalities on the state level left?

Rajesh Gupta: Yes, I believe that's the only formality that's left . There are other formalities, obviously. Like I mentioned, the public hearings is under the aegis of the state. The state has always been very supportive and continues to be supportive. And so all those regular formalities will be completed well in time.

Vikash Singh: Understood. And sir, just sorry to squeeze in one more question. In terms of parity, how do we stand versus Karnataka or Odisha material and imported material -wise? How the prices are ranging in Maharashtra or rather in Karnataka because recently, there's ordinance, Karnataka government is trying to pass a new mining bill. So, in case if Karnataka mining goes a little bit low, and we could supply there also since we are going to have a very large capacity, how does it sits including the logistic cost? Is that opportunity is also available with us?

Rajesh Gupta: So currently, some of our material is already going to Karnataka to various customers and we'll continue doing so irrespective of the fact of the taxation announced by the Karnataka government. And that taxation is actually a cost, not related to the selling price. So, the cost might go up, but the selling price would be ruled by the market. And since we are already competitive in that market, , we hope to be competitive later also. As such, today, we are supplying our materials in literally a ll four corners of the country. And we hope to continue doing so through various logistics, means like rake, truck and now pipeline as well.

Vikash Singh: So, on the rate parity, Karnataka versus M aharashtra, the gap would be, if you could give me this tax figure?

Rajesh Gupta: I could not understand your figure.

Vikash Singh: So basically, Karnataka material price versus M aharashtra material price ex of logistics, so what would be the gap?

Rajesh Gupta: So, there are some price differentiation between various destination ex the mine, there will be some differentiation. And those are commercial information, which I cannot easily pass on, but let me put it this way that, that's why we are doing a door -to-door delivery, which you might have seen in our presentation, and many places we are giving ex our siding where the custo mer takes care of the transport.

And I mean, it's a logistic -oriented business. And that is part of the reason why we have tried to have an understanding of equity with Thriveni. So that all that income also remains in-house. But having said that, rate parity changes from time to time, l ocation to location and product to product. Very difficult to define it as a precise figure.

Moderator: We have our next question from the line of Rahul Agarwal from Aventus Capital.

Rahul Agarwal: So, I just had a couple of question

s. So, I wanted to firstly understand we acquired the MDO

business of Thriveni Earthmovers, but they are also into in the pellet trading business, which Lloyds Metals and Energy Limited

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Lloyds is also going to continue going forward. So, I just wanted to understand if there's any plans to acquire the pellet trading side of it as well? Or are we just going to stick to the MDO business?

Rajesh Gupta: what we have taken over is the MDO business. The other businesses like equity in BRPL and in MRP L –remains with them and does not come to us at all .. We are supplying raw materials, and we have an understanding with Mandovi for supplying iron ore to them and off taking some pellets from them.

Rahul Agarwal: Okay, sir. So that partnership is going to continue...

Riyaz Shaikh: We would be starting off with our own pellet plant. So, there is no question of trading does not allow that.

Rahul Agarwal: So, sir, the partnership with Mandovi is then going to end once that pellet plant starts?

Rajesh Gupta: No, it's a 10-year agreement.

Rahul Agarwal: Okay, sir. And then, sir, I just wanted to ask, so Thriveni Earthmovers and Infra Limited, the new entity that is being formed, is projected to have around INR 5,500 crores of revenue in FY

'25. Could you just tell us -- could you just aggregate that in terms of what Lloyds will be contributing? And what will be coming from all the other mining projects that you will be able

to acquire which has, I think, other companies whose mines are also controlled by Thriveni?

Riyaz Shaikh: Currently, they're doing around 71 million tons of capacity. They're operating 71 million tons, which should increase to 125 million tons with Lloyds Metals' EC increase. The revenue is around INR 5,500 crores. It should increase to around INR 8,000 crores in the next financial year with the increase in the EC, so from Lloyds Metals, it should be around INR 2,500-odd crores.

Rahul Agarwal: All right, sir. And finally, just one more thing. So, sir, we were actually trying to look for the financials of Thriveni Earthmovers for the financial year '24, but we were unable to find that. If you could just give me any guidance on how we could go about doing that?

Riyaz Shaikh: Available with the ROC sites. And if you need it, you get in touch with us, we will be able to provide it.

Rahul Agarwal: All right. So, anybody I can contact in particular?

Rajesh Gupta: Yes, Mr. Chintan Mehta in our office.

Moderator: The next question is from the line of Divya Agarwal from Ficom Family Office.

Divya Agarwal: It's Ficom Family Office. So, sir, my first question is one of our customers recently signed an MoU with the Maharashtra government of investing around INR 3 lakh crores in Gadchiroli district. So, I wanted to understand, will there be an impact on Lloyds Metals on this investment?

Rajesh Gupta: If you're talking about the JSW MoU?

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Divya Agarwal: Yes, sir.

Rajesh Gupta: So, we're not fully privy to what the MoU is about. We know that in the past, they have signed a composite mining license with the Indian Government for one of the mines in Surjagarh. The exact details of what the MoU they have signed, we are not aware. Not only one, I think other MoUs have also been signed by Viraj Steel, so 3 or 4 MoUs are there now envisaged for 3 or 4 steel plants in Gadchiroli.

Like the Prime Minister and the CM has said that it is the next steel city, and we are proud to have laid the foundation to that city. And with the iron ore reserves being very huge, I'm sure that a lot of steel companies will come, and the infrastructure overall would be developed in a better way once more companies come in. More taxes and royalties are received by the government, so they would invest more money in the district. So, we feel positive about all this.

Divya Agarwal: And just a follow-up on that, do we have better cost structure in those mines...

Rajesh Gupta: I'm sorry.

Divya Agarwal: Just a follow-up on that. Do you have a better cost structure as compared to those mines which these guys are having?

Rajesh Gupta: We would not be aware of their physical cost structure. But as far as I'm aware that the 6 mines have been auctioned at a premium of around 110% of the revenue. So, if I'm selling at around INR 4,000 average, their cost would be around INR 4,000 into 1.1x extra over and above mine, which I do not have to pay.

Divya Agarwal: Right. Right. Fair enough. Got it, sir. And secondly, on the gross margin front, sir, our overall sales volume if we've seen quarter 3 FY '25 is like slightly higher and the raw material cost as a percentage of sales was 21% in Q3 FY '24 versus it is 8% in Q3 FY '25. So, can you throw some light on that? Why is it so low in Q3 FY '25?

Riyaz Shaikh: In the second quarter, there were 2, 3 factors because of which the cost structure was on a higher side. It was on the sponge iron front where production in this quarter has been lower. There was a physical verification of these stocks. So, there was some mismatch in that, so we had to provide for that, as well as there was a change in the consumption norms of coal, what we have done in this year to reduce the imported coal consumption. All these things have resulted in this mismatch in the numbers.

Divya Agarwal: Okay. So, can we expect the similar range going forward?

Riyaz Shaikh: Yes.

Rajesh Gupta: As I have mentioned earlier, we are always cognizant of the market. Once the market of the sponge iron and the steel industry gets a little softer, we instead of focusing on volume alone in the DRI sector, focus on cost as well. And by using local coal, cost has come down, and little production has come down because of that. And that's the advantage that we are seeing.

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Divya Agarwal: Right. Got it. And the next question is on the DRI segment. So, if we see the sales is very little in this quarter as compared to the last quarter, while the volume has fallen by 8%, but the sales, if you see in absolute terms, it's down by like 48% quarter-on-quarter. So, what is the reason for that?

Rajesh Gupta: Sales in terms of quantity?

Divya Agarwal: No, the volume is down by 8%, but if you see the total DRI sales, it's down by 48%. And you said in the investor presentation, the...

Riyaz Shaikh: In the last quarter, there was an industrial promotion subsidy, which we received. because of that, the -- if you see that the volumes -- the difference in the volume is coming in. Around INR70 crores is what we received in the form of IPS last quarter .

Divya Agarwal: Yes. Got it. And on the IPS front, did we receive anything in this quarter?

Rajesh Gupta: That will continue now. sorry, this was a onetime. The IPS was one time for the prior period. Now once the pellet plant starts, we will apply and get for the new projects, that is both the DRI and the new pellet plant, we will start getting after some time . That income is not recognized in this quarter.

Divya Agarwal: Sure, sir. And just last question. I n the last con call, you said we'll be selling around 3 million tons of BHQ, but are you planning to sell it in this financial or will it be in the next financial year?

Rajesh Gupta: No, we won't sell 3 million tons of BHQ. S

Riyaz Shaikh: Maximum BHQ what we will be doing is 15 million tons of output. And that will be on a stepped-up manner. We start with DSO, and then we keep on reducing the DSO as and when the BHQ capacities get added.

Rajesh Gupta: BHQ is not a tradable product.

Moderator: The next question is from the line of Prince Choudhary from PINC Wealth.

Prince Choudhary: Yes. Can you provide with the timeline for the beneficiation plant,

when the phase 1 will be

operational then phase 2 and phase 3?

Rajesh Gupta: For the beneficiation plant, before we come into the physical phases, we have the technical phases and the approval phases. The technical phase of clearing the process route is final and our pilot plant is up and running. And we are now in the phase of testing tha t output, number one. Number two, the permissions required, including getting the land, etcetera, are already in place -- I mean, are already applied for and in place. And physically, we feel '27 the first phase would be completed.

Prince Choudhary: By '27, only first phase will be operational, right?

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Riyaz Shaikh: We're doing it in 3 modules, it will be 15 million tons per module. So, the first module of 15 million tons will be done in that time.

Prince Choudhary: Okay. And other 2 phases?

Riyaz Shaikh: Other 2 would be in the next each financial year.

Rajesh Gupta: every financial year after that.

Prince Choudhary: Okay. And what will be the royalty for that BHQ one?

Rajesh Gupta: So, the royalty currently is less than INR 55 as it is not recognized as iron ore by the country.

The royalty is around INR 65 for Maharashtra for this product, which is what we would be paying in the worst case scenario .

Prince Choudhary: Okay, like INR 65 per ton, right?

Rajesh Gupta: INR65 per ton of BHQ.

Prince Choudhary: Okay. And if we sell it for other third party, if I'm doing beneficiation of the iron ore and selling it to third party, is there any other charges on that? Or is it only the royalty which we have to pay?

Riyaz Shaikh: Royalty is the cost.

Rajesh Gupta: No. Like I mentioned earlier, there is no buyer for BHQ, and we have no plan to sell any BHQ. There are no other costs except the mining cost, obviously, and the royalty.

Prince Choudhary: Okay. And the mining cost would be more than what we do for the DSO, iron ore, if I'm not wrong around then? Or it will be the same?

Rajesh Gupta: It will be lesser per ton of BHQ, but when we beneficiated, we have to use 2.5x -3x of the material So, from that angle, the ratio will be a little higher, but the grade is also higher.

Prince Choudhary: Yes, from that concept only, like I have to mine, for example, 2.9 or 3 tons is required for 1 ton of DSO. So, for that, in percentage terms, our cost would be more right, if I'm correct?

Rajesh Gupta: Mr. Prince, you asked me question of if I sell BHQ. So, for BHQ, the mining cost is lower. After beneficiat ing the BHQ, the finished iron ore cost would be around 2.5x of the BHQ mining,

which is much lower than iron ore mining and 2.5x of the royalty. So, if that answers your question.

Prince Choudhary: Yes, sir. Yes, sir. Understood.

Rajesh Gupta: Assuming around 40% yield.

Moderator: We have our next question from the line of Parthiv Jhonsa from Anand Rathi.

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Parthiv Jhonsa: Sir, in the opening remarks, you mentioned the capex number. I actually missed that. Is it possible to repeat the same for Q3 and 9 months?

Riyaz Shaikh: I didn't get you. Can you just repeat?

Parthiv Jhonsa: Yes, the capex for Q3 and 9 months, sir. Is it possible to get the number, you had said in the opening remarks?

Rajesh Gupta: In the 9 months, it is INR 2,700 crores, and we've done totally around INR 4,400 crores till now.

Parthiv Jhonsa: Okay. Okay. Sir, also just one question to harp on the ex -mine cost when compared to, say, someone who is a merchant miner, right? Considering we have allotted mine. And what will be the cost differential there? For example, if someone is mining, considering the MDO cost and everything, what would be the cost differential with us compared to a merchant miner as on date?

Rajesh Gupta: I'm not privy to other miners in Gadchiroli. A, there are no mi

ning going on right now. I'm not

privy to the physical costs. On the premium cost, I already mentioned that, and I think it's in the range of 110%, so that is around INR4,400 higher approximately.

Parthiv Jhonsa: No, I believe, sir, there are no other merchant miners mine. I just wanted to understand with miners, say, from Karnataka or Odisha if they are doing on MDO, what would be the cost differential just to get a comparison?

Rajesh Gupta: I think I don't track my competitors so closely. I think the easiest way to track it would be NMDC was a pure mining play or maybe Tata Steel. I'll have to have a look at that. We believe we are quite competitive in the overall mining cost. And with the advent of Thriveni coming into our fold, it will be much lower because the profit of the MDO would be consolidated in our books as well.

Parthiv Jhonsa: Okay, sir. Sir, and just on the...

Rajesh Gupta: And one more point is that being newly established in Gadchiroli 2 years compared to NMDC being 20 years or 30 years and Tata Steel being 100 years plus, their cost may be different. I would have to ask, and I'll ask my IR people to work out the costing and give me a better understanding as well. Thank you for the question.

Parthiv Jhonsa: No problem, sir, I'll get in touch with Chintan on this, absolutely fine. Sir, the last question is, is it possible to give a heads -up on what will be the kind of a conversion cost there? Or it's too preliminary right now?

Rajesh Gupta: We have the cost with us. We believe that the overall cost ex mine or ex beneficiated plant would not be very different from the current DSO cost given the lower royalty at INR 65. We are trying to understand the laws a little bit more of whether INR 65 can be reduced or not. And so it would be in the same range, maybe a little bit plus/minus but the grade is better, the silica, alumina is much, much lesser. So, for the end user, there's a much, much bigger benefit. Whether we make

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pellets or we sell steel or my consumers makes steel, it will be a much better benefit. Beneficiated ore based pallet are around \$45 to \$50 premium for that grade.

Moderator: We have our next question from the line of Siddharth Gadekar from Equirus.

Siddharth Gadekar: So first, just on the EC approval, broadly that we are expected to get the EC approval in the next 60 to 90 days. FY '26 should be a year where we have the full EC, and we should be mining 25 million tons?

Rajesh Gupta: Yes, Siddharth.

Siddharth Gadekar: Okay. Sir, secondly, on our BHQ, have we started ordering the equipment? Or what is the status on that?

Rajesh Gupta: The engineering is all in full swing. Some of the very long-lead items, I think we have just ordered or about to order. Our teams have gone to Australia and to China to inspect new and better technologies also. I think we'll be in the position to order those equipment in the next 10 days or so, we'll be placing the biggest orders. We have got the big grinder in place, with the gyratory crusher, which would be getting installed shortly.

Siddharth Gadekar: Sir, secondly, then broadly, we should be on our original timeline in terms of commissioning the BHQ plant -- the first BHQ plant. Is that fair understanding?

Rajesh Gupta: Yes. We continue to maintain. That would be maintained.

Siddharth Gadekar: Okay. Sir, secondly, on the second slurry pipeline, when do we expect that to commission?

Rajesh Gupta: So, the way we have done our scheduling, which I mentioned to you earlier, is we are asking the cash flows to take care of that. And so, once the two pellet plants are ready and the first BHQ plant is ready, then we'll work on the second BHQ plant and this pipeline and the pellet plant.

Siddharth Gadekar: Okay. Got it. But...

Rajesh Gupta: The first pellet plant in Chandrapur.

Siddharth Gadekar: So br

oadly by FY '28 end, we should have 2 beneficiation plants and at least 8 million tons of pellet which would be online, right?

Rajesh Gupta: And 1.2 million tons of steel at Chandrapur.

Moderator: We have our next question from the line of Abhishek Mehra from DAM Capital Advisors.

Abhishek Mehra: I just had one question. I just wanted to ask what is the closing iron ore inventory volume figure as on Q3?

Rajesh Gupta: We'll come back. We will just come back in a minute for that. Any other questions?

Riyaz Shaikh: The closing inventory is 0.4 million tons .

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Moderator: I think the line got disconnected.

Rajesh Gupta: The answer is 0.4 million tons .

Moderator: We'll move on to the next question from the line of Dhananjai Bagrodia from ASK Investor.

Dhananjai Bagrodia: Congratulation on a good set of numbers. Just wanted to understand what capex are we looking for this entity over the next 3 years or so? And how are we looking at this entity on a longer - term basis in terms of a business plan or how are we seeing that?

Riyaz Shaikh: Can you just repeat?

Dhananjai Bagrodia: So just a question is, how are we looking at capex over the next 3 years on a consolidated level across divisions? And how are we looking at this company over the next 3 to 5 years in terms business plan because we have now got the clearances, we are trying new opportunities, so how should one look at it?

Riyaz Shaikh: Yes. See, as we've informed you that we should be getting into this 25 million tons of EC, and so we should be doing that much of production in the next financial year. So going forward, it should be 25 million tons of iron ore. In the next 2 years, as I just mentioned, we should be done with the 4 million ton of pellet plant, we should be around 7 lakh tons of DRI production and 1.2 million tons of wire rod plant, that is steel plant and an equivalent of 125 megawatts of power along with it.

In terms of capex , we should be doing around INR 5,000 crores by this year's end. That has to be done around INR 4,400 crores, so we should be reaching around INR 5,000 crores by this year end. And going forward in the next 2 years, yes, we should be doing more than that at around INR6,000 crores to INR 6,500 crores every year of capex to achieve all these projects of ours.

Dhananjai Bagrodia: Okay. And just to understand, is our vision to focus on which part of the chain going ahead? Obviously, the first leg, what you mentioned, but over longer term, this company wants to be known as a mining company, processing company. What about that? How are we looking at that?

Rajesh Gupta: So, our long -term vision is to be a cyclical -free steel industry. At the same -- how we will achieve that is, , by very, very low debt, if any, number one. Number two, we'll have a part of the iron ore that we mine will be sold as either iron ore or as pellets and part will be sold as steel. So out of 25 million, around 10 million will be sold . Balance will be converted into steel and selling around 4.5 million tons of steel and rest will be semi -products, and around 15 million tons will be so ld as pellets or iron ore, mostly pellets.

Dhananjai Bagrodia: Okay. Okay. Fantastic. Congratulations, sir. And any other funds raise we're going to do after this? Or is it just going to be no more funds required?

Rajesh Gupta: All these plants that we mentioned are for Lloyds Metals. We have yet to sit with management of Thriveni to understand their capex plans and their requirements and overall things. There would be some fundraises in both the companies.

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Moderator: We have our next question from the line of Kartik Khandelwal from Hem Securities.

Kartik Khandelwal: A few quarters back in the con call, we showcased the desire to achieve a revenue of around IN

R40,000 crores by '28 to '29. So, the recent acquisition of MDO business we did and the revenue we'll be earning from this, is it considered in that target? Or will it be over and above our desired revenue target of INR40,000 crores by FY '28 or '29?

Rajesh Gupta: I think your question got lost. Your voice was a little echoing. Can you repeat the whole question?

Kartik Khandelwal: Sir, a few quarters back, we showcased a desire to achieve a revenue of around INR 40,000 crores by FY '28 or '29. So, the recent acquisition of MDO business and the revenue will be earning from this, is it considered in the target itself? Or will it be over and above the desired revenue target of INR 40,000 crores by FY '28 or '29?

Rajesh Gupta: It'll be over and above.

Moderator: We have our next question from the line of Aman from Seven Rivers.

Aman: So, any price cuts that we have taken in December and January? And how do you see it moving in February?

Rajesh Gupta: Price cut. We haven't taken any price cut. Most of our material is sold for this year of 10 million tons. So, we don't see any price cut on the anvil.

Aman: And sir, the realization for DRI has come off. What would be the reason for that? And can you explain what's the linkage with, let's say, iron ore realization in terms of what's the flow-through or linkage with iron ore?

Rajesh Gupta: The DRI realization has come down. You're talking about in January or in...

Aman: For the quarter, sir?

Rajesh Gupta: So, our realization has come down for the quarter, not up. The DRI is more linked to the secondary steel market and the scrap market, lesser to the iron ore market. And also, as far as our raw material is concerned, we've got two raw materials, iron ore and coal. So, both of those are part of the equation that people have. And ultimately, the supply and demand and the steel sector has been a little soft on the demand side. I think oversupply is there. The demand is still 7%, 8%, 9% growth.

Moderator: We have our next question from the line of Kishor Udasi, an Individual Investor.

Kishor Udasi: I just wanted to ask how much will be the total iron ore mining for this financial year?

Riyaz Shaikh: We are expecting the EC by this financial year -- total mining or mining cost?

Kishor Udasi: No, no, only mining. Iron ore mining. How much million tons?

Rajesh Gupta: 10 million tons.

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Kishor Udasi: So, it won't be above that, sir, if we get environmental clearance before March?

Riyaz Shaikh: If we get it before March, on a pro rata basis, we can but that looks difficult. But yes, we can drive a little bit more than 10 million tons.

Kishor Udasi: Okay. But right now, we are calculating only 10 million for this financial year?

Riyaz Shaikh: Yes.

Moderator: We have our next question from the line of Vimogh Shah from GoyamLabdhee Fintec.

Vimogh Shah: Actually, I joined a little bit late, so if my question is already answered, then please ignore it. I will read the transcript. So, my question is like what is the company's plan for achieving the 100-megawatt of renewable energies for captive consumption?

Rajesh Gupta: We have tied up with 2 companies, Hinduja and Amplus. We are about to sign the final contracts with them. We've been buying power from them and also becoming an equity holder of 26% in those two special subsidies for that power.

Vimogh Shah: Okay. And my second question is like, could you provide a detailed projection on how this cost reduction will translate into the pricing competitiveness in the market and enable a company to maintain its profitability?

Rajesh Gupta: So, the landed cost of this power is around INR 4.50- INR 4.75 per unit. And the landing cost of MSEDCL cost is around INR 8.50, number one. Number two, and of course, this is green power, so that is also very important for us in our business strategy.

y. So, with those two benefits, I think it's very easy to calculate the cost benefit to the product.

Moderator: Ladies and gentlemen, as there are no further questions from the participants, I now hand the conference over to the management for closing comments. Over to you, sir.

Rajesh Gupta: Thank you, sir. As usual, it has been a very informative and helpful discussion. And these questions always help us to think of our management strategy also going forward. Thank you, everybody, for the interest in our company.

Moderator: Thank you. On behalf of DAM Capital Advisors, that concludes this conference. Thank you for joining us, and you may now disconnect your lines.

Rajesh Gupta: Thank you.

Riyaz Shaikh: Thank you very much.

Call: May 2025

Date: 03rd May, 2025

To,
BSE Limited National Stock Exchange of India Limited
Phiroze Jeejeebhoy Towers, Exchange Plaza, Bandra Kurla Complex,
Dalal Street, Mumbai – 400001 Bandra (East), Mumbai - 400 051
BSE Scrip Code: 512455 NSE Symbol: LLOYDSME

Sub: Transcript of the Conference Call for investors and analysts for Q4 & FY25

Dear Sir/Madam,

Pursuant to the Regulation 30 of the Securities and Exchange Board of India (Listing Obligations and Disclosure Requirements) Regulations, 2015 ("Listing Regulations "), and in furtherance to our intimation dated 21st April, 2025 regarding Conference call with Analyst(s) /Investor(s) held on Wednesday , 30th April, 2025 we would like to inform that the transcript of the aforesaid conference call is attached herewith and the same is also available on the website of the Company at <https://lloyds.in/investors/analyst-and-investor-meets-and-presentations/>

The same may please be taken on record and suitably disseminated to all concerned.

Thanking you,
Yours Sincerely,
For Lloyds Metals and Energy Limited

Akshay Vora
Company Secretary
Membership No.: ACS43122

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"Lloyds Metals and Energy Limited
Q4 & FY '25 Earnings Conference Call "
April 30, 2025

MANAGEMENT : M R. RAJESH GUPTA – MANAGING DIRECTOR –
LLOYDS METALS AND ENERGY LIMITED
MR. RIYAZ SHAIKH – CHIEF FINANCIAL OFFICER –
LLOYD S METALS AND ENERGY LIMITED
MR. CHINTAN MEHTA – CHIEF INVESTMENT OFFICER
– LLOYD S METALS AND ENERGY LIMITED

MODERATOR : M R. PARTHIV JHONSA -- ANAND RATHI SHARES AND
STOCK BROKERS .

Lloyds Metals and Energy Limited
April 30, 2025
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Moderator: Ladies and gentlemen, good day, and welcome to the Lloyds Metal s Earnings Call, hosted by Anand Rathi Shares and Stock Brokers Limited. As a reminder, all pa rticipant lines will be in the listen-only mode, and there will be an opportunity for you to ask questions after the presentation concludes. Should you need assistance during the confere nce call, please signal an operator by pressing star then zero on your touchtone phone. Please note that this conference is

being recorded.

I now hand the conference over to Mr. Parthiv Jhonsa from Anand Rathie Shares and Stock Brokers. Thank you and over to you, sir.

Parthiv Jhonsa: Thanks, Hardik. Good evening, everyone, and thank you for joining us today. We at Anand Rathie are pleased to host Lloyds Metals and Energy Q4 and FY '25 Earnings Conference Call. We have with us today from the management, Mr. Rajesh Gupta, Managing Director; Mr. Riyaz Shaikh, CFO; and Mr. Chintan Mehta, CIO.

Without further ado, I would now like to invite Mr. Rajesh Gupta to initiate the proceedings for the call. Thanks, and over to you, sir.

Rajesh Gupta: Thank you, Parthiv. Good afternoon, everyone. A warm welcome to all our investors joining us today. A special thanks to the team at Anand Rathie for hosting this call. FY '25 has been a remarkable year for Lloyds Metals and Energy.

We have achieved the highest ever profit before tax. We have achieved the highest ever sponge iron production for a financial year, and maintain the annual run for iron ore as well. For the second year, we have completed 100% of our capacity of 10 million tons. We were in the consolidation phase. And we have also strengthened our CSR commitments in the likes of education initiatives like 2 schools, Lloyds Raj Vidya Niketan and GD Goenka Lloyds Public School in the 2 towns of Gadchiroli and Hedri.

Health and water initiatives, including 1 30-bedded hospital and various medical checkups, eye camps, etc., have been carried out. And also sports initiatives like the Gadchiroli Premier League for fostering youth empowerment has been done in that area.

I'd like to give an update on the Thriveni MDO business acquisition. NCLT approval is in process and is underway and is expected to be done by Q1 FY '26. The 2 entities have started integrating culturally. Our teams are bonding well and are aligned with the company's growth objectives. We believe this is a major milestone, which will unleash a huge opportunity going ahead.

Moving forward on our capex progress. The slurry pipeline project is commissioned and complete. And right now, today only the material has started moving from Hedri to Konsari. Other projects like the 4 million ton pellet plant, the 360,000 ton DRI plant and the 60-megawatt power plant are nearing completion. These projects are progressing at a breath-taking speed and are significantly ahead of typical industry timelines. We received EC for the pellet plant in November '23 and is under pre-commissioning. This is close to around 18 months. This is for a Lloyds Metals and Energy Limited

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greenfield plant, which includes getting water and power infrastructure to 2 greenfield locations in difficult areas in Gadchiroli.

Similarly, for DRI 360,000 ton plant and the 60-megawatt power plant, we received the EC only in February '24, and 1 plant should be commissioned in June '25 and the other by July '25 as well, within a gap of 1 month of each other. This affirms our commitment towards timely execution of our projects.

Coming specifically to Q4 FY '25, our iron ore volumes were subdued in Q4. It is within 10 million tons for the year. The reduction in volume partially was because of the -- we front-ended the production, anticipating the EC clearance for the expansion a little earlier. That did not happen. But we had dispatched in the first

3 quarters more quantities. And therefore, only lesser quantities were left for the quarter ended. Lower volumes in this quarter naturally led to lower absorption of fixed costs and therefore, margins seem subdued.

Regarding the mining EC update, which many would like to hear of. This will become one of the largest mines in the country, irrespective of any mineral, except coal. The time taken for approvals is therefore a bit longer than our expectations. We appreciate the authorities' cooperation in this regard. All major formalities have been completed, and we await the final outcome from MOEF very shortly. Given the scenario, we foresee some minor loss of iron ore volumes from 25 million to maybe 1 million ton or lesser than that.

Industry outlook. The Indian iron ore market continues to be buoyant, defying the international market. The prices are very steady, and the demand on steel is running consistently at 8% year-on-year and therefore, also on iron ore. The government's focus on steel capacity expansion has remained strong and multiple government initiatives have initiated the urgent need of scaling up of greenfield iron ore mining as well as beneficiation.

Most importantly, the saga of high-price auction continues with an average of 20 million tons is now further scheduled every year for the next 5 years to exit the allotted route and go into auction route. We once again reaffirm our commitment to creating long-term value for all our stakeholders. Thank you for your continued support and for being part of our exciting growth journey.

I now hand over the call to Riyaz, who is our CFO, to walk you through the detailed financial

performance.

Riyaz Shaikh: Thank you, Mr. Rajesh, for the detailed insights and setting the context for today's discussion. Good afternoon, everyone. Let me take you through the key financial highlights for FY '25 and quarter 4 FY '25.

FY '25 revenue grew by 3% year- on-year. Growth was primarily led by better realizations for iron ore and record sponge iron production. Iron ore volumes remained flat year- on-year at 10 million tons. Iron ore sales volume for quarter 4 FY '25 stood at 1.66 million tons. In regards to EBITDA performance, FY '25 EBITDA grew by 13% year- on-year to INR 2,005 crores. Growth was driven by higher realizations in iron ore. However, realization for sponge iron and power remained muted, which slightly moderated overall EBITDA growth despite record volumes.

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Speaking about realizations and per ton. Iron ore realization for quarter 4 FY '25 stood at INR5,994 per ton, down 6% year- on-year. FY '25 realization was INR 5,766 per ton, up 6% year- on-year. Iron ore EBITDA per ton for FY '25 was INR1,801, up 5% year- on-year. DRI and Power segment. DRI volumes for FY '25 stood at 3,08,000 tons per annum. Power volumes grew 5% year- on-year for FY '25. However, realizations for sponge iron and power are muted, impacting segment margins.

A few additional points to be taken note, our ESOP cost for the quarter was around INR13 crores, which is non-cash. There were some community development expenses of around INR17 crores to INR18 crores in this quarter. As to the capex, the company incurred a capex of INR1,690 crores in FY '24, which increased to INR 3,695 crores in FY '25. We are guiding a capex of INR6,000 crores to INR6,500 crores for FY '26 focused on mining, pellet and steel capacities. With this, we would like to open the floor for question-and-answers . Thank you.

Moderator: The first question comes from the line of Siddharth Mehrotra from Kotak Securities .

Siddharth Mehrotra: I just had a small query on the volumes, which we plan to do. So sir, now we are almost on the verge of monsoons, while we have guided that we will get our EC soon, that will perhaps significantly impact our volume ramp-up. So I mean, can you just lay out

the steps you have

taken to ensure that the materiality of lower volumes is not there when the final volumes for this year come out?

Rajesh Gupta: So last year also, the volumes in the monsoon were not as bad as compared to the average, number one. Number two, this year, our pipeline is getting commissioned, and that will help in moving the volumes out of the mine. The mine itself is not majorly affected by the monsoons. So last year, we did around 2 million tons in the monsoon, which is equal to an average of the year, and we assume that the similar percentage would be achieved during the year. We have already started producing in a larger quantity. And the first quarter itself will give better results, better quantity than earlier.

Siddharth Mehrotra: Okay, sir. So approximately 20% of full-year volumes in monsoons, right? That is the base case assumption?

Rajesh Gupta: Yes.

Siddharth Mehrotra: Okay. And when we are considering monsoons, approximately that is 4 months of the year, 3 months of the year, 5 months of the year?

Rajesh Gupta: It was not in that manner.

Moderator: The next question comes from the line of Amit Dixit from ICICI Securities.

Amit Dixit: Just a couple of questions from my side. The first one is again on iron ore volumes. So you mentioned in your prepared remarks that the EC is still pending, and we may fall short by 1 million ton or something thereabout. So what would be your guidance at this point in time for FY '26?

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And the related question is that where we see this EC approval getting stuck because 1 month has already passed in Q1 FY '26. So just wanted to give a little bit more color on this aspect.

Rajesh Gupta: As far as the EC aspects are concerned, the process is on. The committee has, in fact, made a visit to the mine, which is normally not a requirement because it's a big mine. We welcomed them to our mine. And post that, the processes are over, and we hope to be getting it very, very shortly. We have given timing earlier also. But at this moment, I think May end should be the date that we anticipated the worst case.

And in terms of the volume guidance, like I said, around 1 million tons, 1.2 million tons maximum would be reduced based on 25 million tons.

Amit Dixit: Okay. So that means the second half could be a bit more heavy in terms of volumes compared to the first half of the year?

Rajesh Gupta: Yes, yes.

Amit Dixit: Okay. Great. The second question is on the capex. So in the prepared remarks, it was mentioned that INR6,000 crores to INR6,500 crores capex in FY '26. Now, first of all, does it include maintenance capex as well? And if you could divide it into broad buckets, where it would be invested in what all equipment?

Riyaz Shaikh: See, when we say, INR6,500 crores is including the mining assets, that is for the beneficiation plant, the steel plant that is 1.2 million tons wire rod plant, the pellet plants. These are all included in this, plus some normal capex. Normal capex is it's not to a larger term, but it should be around INR50-odd crores for a particular year as going to the average is what we have been doing.

Amit Dixit: Okay. The third one, if I can, is an update on BHQ. So in the presentation, you did mention that there has been some progress, etc. Just wanted to understand where we are on that and if the commissioning time line that we have anticipated is on track?

Rajesh Gupta: So on BHQ, the pilot plant is performing extremely well. We have updated our technology inputs to reduce processing costs a little bit on that and fine-tuning that. That's number one. In the meantime, the engineering of the overall project is going on at large pace in China with our partners there. Number two.

Number three, on the permission level, we are anticipating to get the permissions to start the ground progress by around Diwali 2025. So with that

, the case and then by June, July '27, we

should be in a position to start the beneficiation plant of the first train and 6 months thereon for every train. So there will be 3 trains of 15 million tons input and 5 million tons output. So July '27, March '28 and July -- March '28, we will finish off, sorry.

Moderator: The next question comes from the line of Vikash Singh from Phillip Capital.

Vikash Singh: Sir, my first question is regarding the annual dispatch. While we still had the EC of 10 million tons, so any specific reason we fell short by 0.5 million tons in terms of dispatches?

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Rajesh Gupta: There is some captive consumption that is not iron ore sold. So that comes in the captive consumption side. The production of the mine of full 10 million tons.

Vikash Singh: Sir, my second question pertains to the iron ore realization seems to be slightly up on a sequential basis. But if you look at the EBITDA per ton, it was down sharply. Any specific reason for the same?

Riyaz Shaikh: If you see for the overall -- full financial year, we are almost, in fact, better than what we did, what we have been achieving over the last previous years. Yes, in this quarter, yes, it has been. There were some lumpy expenses for community development that was incurred. There were some ESOP expenses, as I mentioned in my opening remarks also.

Plus, what we have done is, we have done some front-loading of expenses in this quarter to ramp up our capacities to achieve the 25 million tons. So that is some major cost what has been taken in this quarter. And that's the reason why the cost is on the higher side.

Vikash Singh: So effectively, the other operating expenses, which are higher...

Riyaz Shaikh: Updating us on the higher production.

Vikash Singh: Understood, sir. Sir, in terms of the iron ore market, on one hand, you say that the Thriveni might get a huge business with the iron ore mines they would need to commission in India. And at the same time, if more mines get commissioned, our existing business will get a little bit impacted. So just wanted to understand your views on the incremental iron ore availability and how do you see the prices in the domestic market?

Rajesh Gupta: Question that you raised about Thriveni. But on the additional market, let me just throw some light. Indian steel market is growing at the rate of around 8% production and similar on demand. So that is a very positive sign.

The iron ore market is growing a little lesser than that around 5% to 6%. Therefore, the exports are reducing, International market is still very, very high compared to any Indian pricing. So that is still not a threat at all. I don't see that happening any threat in the near future on the pricing front.

In terms of -- we did a detailed research through SteelMint for our potential market, and we feel that around 70%, 75% of our material would be sold within 400 kilometers to 600 kilometers range of the mine or the pellet plant. So that is the status.

We are seeing a lot of our customers are increasing their requirements and increasing their capacities. And all that is helping us to increase to look at a very much better picture in terms of realizations going forward.

Vikash Singh: Understood, sir.

Rajesh Gupta: Could you repeat your question about Thriveni or does my answer?

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Vikash Singh: It largely answers, sir. Sir, just one last question, if I may. What is the spot iron ore realization versus 4Q average?

Rajesh Gupta: So again, this INR6,000 that we have achieved last year. In the last quarter, we were around INR6,200, INR6,100. I mean, depending on the commodity and the location, it is going to be very similar. There has been no major movement.

We have kept the prices constant. OMC has inched up the prices. NMDC has not. These are the major

merchant competitors, and we are keeping the prices in the right track. The steel market is not at its best with the 12% safeguard duty, I think it will become better, but we have taken care not to increase the prices even though there was some scope, we have not done that.

Moderator: The next question comes from the line of Jatin Damania from Sivan Investments.

Jatin Damania: Sir, just on the follow-up questions in terms of the beneficiation plant where our pilot plant is already ready. So as you indicated that definitely we'll be moving ahead with the capex. So what sort of capex are we envisaging on that pilot plant?

Rajesh Gupta: We have started giving equipment order for the equipment. And for all the 3 trains, we anticipate around INR5,000-odd crores as a total beneficiation project.

Jatin Damania: And by when do we expect the plant to be ready?

Rajesh Gupta: So the first train would be ready, like I said, by June 2027.

Jatin Damania: And sir, in terms of the cost saving initiatives, now one of our slurry pipeline is being ready and probably likely to be ready in the second half and pellet plant 1 will be ready. So overall cost saving initiatives, what will be the cost savings initiatives that we'll be getting in the second half based on the slurry pipeline?

Rajesh Gupta: The slurry pipeline is actually being commissioned today on trial run basis. And the pellet plant will be commissioned by end of June. The slurry pipeline initiates a cost saving of around INR500, INR600 per ton of pellet, the pipeline is for 10 million tons, we are commissioning the first phase by 5 million tons right now. The grinding will be commissioned, the grinding for the second 5 million tons will be commissioned along with the second pellet plant.

Jatin Damania: Last question on the pellet plant. Now we are doing a pellet in the 3 phases, Phase 1, Phase 2 and Phase 3. So how comfortable and confident we are in terms of scaling our pellet capacity to almost 8 million tons that we'll be able to sell it or consume it?

Rajesh Gupta: So in terms of selling pellet, I think the market is very vibrant. There's a very shortage, but a huge demand for lumpy ore or pellets. So given our costing, we are confident of achieving a good marketing of that. Like I said earlier, we identified the markets and with the help of SteelMint, and one of that has been that we have -- in our seed marketing campaign, we have been able to get -- be successful in a tender which happened day before yesterday with RINL, which is the first time that RINL actually bought pellets in the open market like this by auction.

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So we have been successful in that. So yes, we are confident of achieving a profitable or EBITDA accretive, PAT accretive margins in our pellet plant.

Moderator: The next question comes from the line of Siddharth Gadekar from Equirus.

Siddharth Gadekar: Sir, first thing on the iron ore volumes. So for FY '26, when we are guiding for 23 million, 24 million tons of volume, have we started engaging with customers in terms of offtake and their demands? And how should we look at pricing going ahead given that, in the second half, there will be a significant surplus that would be coming from us in the open market?

Rajesh Gupta: So we are aware of the fact that a 15 million ton increase, including the part of the quantity would be fed into the pellet plant. So out of the 15 million tons extra 4 million tons will be consumed in the pellet plant. So around 10 million tons goes in the iron ore market. Out of that 10 million tons, around 0.5 million tons is consumed extra in our DRI plant. We're talking about 9.5 million tons extra marketing to be done. We feel that our quality and the markets are such that it can easily be absorbed without any impact on the pricing.

That's why I did mention in my opening remarks that around 100 million tons of

material will

be going out of the allotment route into the auction route over the next 5 years as an average of 20 million tons every year goes away from a low-cost regime to a higher cost regime. The auctions in the last 3 rounds have not been less than 125% with a peak of 200%. These indicate that the demand is very, very strong going forward as well. Stalwarts in the industry are paying those premiums.

International stalwarts are paying 125%, 135% premium. The last mine, one of them very small mines went at a premium of 200% of the sales value. So obviously, those people who are buying that are perceiving a shortage going time forward, and we are there to service them during that period with our enhanced capacity.

Siddharth Gadekar: But we have started negotiations with our customers for that volume?

Rajesh Gupta: Yes, sir.

Siddharth Gadekar: Sir, secondly, on the pellet volume, how should we think about the production for this year?

Rajesh Gupta: Around 2.5 million tons.

Moderator: The next question comes from the line of Prakhar Khajanchi from Anand Rathi Financial Services.

Prakhar Khajanchi: My first question is, on last call, you have guided for cost saving on a consolidated basis once MDO merger is completed. Will this start from day 1 itself or it will take time to flow?

Riyaz Shaikh: As soon as we are just waiting for the NCLT order in this merger. So once the NCLT order is received, the consolidation will start happening because the date is 1, April '25. So it will start from 1, April '25 immediately.

Prakhar Khajanchi: Okay. When will be the second pellet plant commission?

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Rajesh Gupta: Second pellet plant will be a year behind the first pellet plant. Construction for that has also started. So we are confident of that next year.

Moderator: The next question comes from the line of Divy Agrawal from Ficom Family Office.

Divy Agrawal: So I just wanted to know about the rationale behind raising the INR5,000 crores that you have announced. And also, I just wanted to know about the capex that you have announced of around INR6,000 crores, INR6,500 crores. So how much from it would be internal accruals?

Riyaz Shaikh: Can you repeat your question?

Divy Agrawal: So I just wanted to know the rationale behind the INR5,000 crores. And secondly, I wanted to know the fund is INR5,000 crores and the INR6,000 crores to INR6,500 crores of capex that you have announced, how much will be from internal accruals?

Riyaz Shaikh: See, the INR5,000 crores resolution what we have taken, it's an enabling resolution. There is no concrete thing on it. What we are going to be going forward for any fund raise or any such thing to the equity route or any other route is not yet decided on. As of today, the INR6,000 crores what we are anticipating on the project for this next financial year is all through internal accruals and the balance of the preferential warrants what is pending to be called for.

Divy Agrawal: Got it. Secondly, on the IPS benefit, sir, how much did you receive in FY '25 versus how much were you expecting to be received in FY '25? And how much can we expect in FY '26 as well?

Riyaz Shaikh: We have not received any IPS for the new projects. Only for the old project, we had received some INR72 crores of IPS in the last year. This year, we will be around...

Rajesh Gupta: This year, the accrual of the IPS starts as soon as we start the operations.

Divy Agrawal: So how much can you quantify?

Riyaz Shaikh: It will be on accrual basis. We'll be getting that funds will be coming only in the next year, next financial year.

Divy Agrawal: So in FY '26, you don't expect anything?

Rajesh Gupta: As a cash flow, no. The past inflows, the past inflows would start coming in will come in majorly around INR35 crores, INR40-odd crores.

Divy Agrawal: In FY '26, right?

Rajesh Gupta: Yes.

Divy Agrawal: Ok

ay, sir. Got it. And just wanted to know about the INR40,000 crore revenue that you had guided in some of the previous communications by FY '28, FY '29. So how much would the IPS benefit would be the contribution in that?

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Rajesh Gupta: That's a difficult question. I don't think we have the answer to that ready. In principle, let me explain to you that the IPS is capped by 150% of the investment that we do in Gadchiroli and 115% of whatever investment we do in Chandrapur. In Gadchiroli, the investment in both the places, this cap would be reimbursed with a maximum of 12 years, as well as a minimum of value.

So basically will be divided by 12. And every year, it will be accruing towards local sales GST, that is the SGST of that year as well as the royalty as Gadchiroli is concerned for the captive consumption that we do of iron ore.

So based on that, we feel that every year, any project that we invest in, we will be getting the IPS over the next 12 years, 150% or 115% as the case may be. This is accrual, plus 1 year to 1.5 years for disbursement by the government of Maharashtra.

Divy Agrawal: Okay. So it takes around 1 year, 1.5 years for disbursement, right, after the commissioning of the project?

Rajesh Gupta: No, no, no. After it is accrued.

Moderator: The next question comes from the line of Kartik Khandelwal from HEM Securities Limited.

Kartik Khandelwal: My question was regarding the sponge iron Q4 FY '25 margins. Earlier Q2 and Q3, we were able to achieve margins for profit before finance cost and taxes. The margins were around 27% in Q2 and 18% in Q3. But it has drastically brought down to 0.84 % in Q4. So any reason for that?

Riyaz Shaikh: Sponge iron, yes, we have in this quarter, as I had mentioned earlier also, we have done some large expenses on community development, which were required. And that's the reason, and that has been -- that's the reason why it is on a higher side of those expenses are one-time expenses, which have occurred. It's a lumpy expense, and that has taken up most of the profitability.

Rajesh Gupta: The division of the quantity in the last quarter is lesser, I mean the year is very high. The division of the last quarter is similar.

Riyaz Shaikh: Lesser than the last quarter.

Moderator: The next question comes from the line of Rahul Agarwal from Aventus Capital.

Rahul Agarwal: So I had a couple of questions. So the first one was related to the cost savings questions that a couple of people have asked you previously. Would be that the reason is -- you mentioned in the presentation that there will be a high amount of cost savings through Thriveni business, the slurry pipelines, etc.

But I was having some trouble with the per ton cost savings that were related to mining and freight. Given the numbers in the presentation, it seems as if the per ton costs are already quite low. And what we are expecting further, is it because of volumes, like the INR500 to INR600 per one pipeline and INR800 to INR1,000 per ton for the other pipeline. Will that be incorporated in terms of volumes?

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Rajesh Gupta: One of the major volume savings would be because of the consolidation of Thriveni into the company, and number two, the slurry pipeline. So these 2 reduce our cost of sales to a large extent. I think vis-a-vis the other figures, I suggest that Chintan could get in touch with you and resolve that matter. But basically, those are the 2 big ticket items on a per ton basis.

Rahul Agarwal: Sure, sir. I actually tried to reach out to Chintan for last quarter, I was unable to do that, but I will try to reach out to them again. So sir, the next question was about BHQ realizations and volumes. So I know that, obviously, the project is still some ways away from getting into full flow. But could you just give me an idea

of what the realization might be like and what the volumes will be like once you start the plant?

Rajesh Gupta: BHQ is a byproduct of the mine. We have reserves of around 700 million tons, which is normally thrown aside by most mines. The Fe content is only 35%, 38%. BHQ, Banded Hematite Quartzite. We will be beneficiating this material into a 66% iron ore, which is one of the highest grade iron ore available in the country.

So as such, BHQ itself is not sellable. And neither we plan to sell -- we will sell some of the concentrate that we produce out of this, which would be comparable to the iron ore market on that day adjusted for the Fe content.

Rahul Agarwal: Okay, sir. So similar to the Hematite that we already sell, right?

Rajesh Gupta: Yes. The yield of BHQ is around 35% for 3 tons of BHQ, we get 1 ton of concentrate.

Rahul Agarwal: Okay. Then sir, just you spoke about the reserves. And I just wanted to know, given that we have a total reserve of about 850 million tons, now that we are expanding into iron ore into '25 and we'll be doing BHQ, do we have enough reserves for the next decade or so because the math was a bit weird. So do we have enough reserves to continue? Or are we going to say maybe move towards BHQ completely in the next few years?

Rajesh Gupta: BHQ completely in 2034, '33, something like that as per the mining plan. Till that time, we have reserves for direct sales ore as well. Over a period once the BHQ plants are fully commissioned, the DSO will come down gradually. And ultimately, it will be after '33, '34, something like that, it becomes 100% BHQ.

Rahul Agarwal: And just one last thing. What are the pellet realizations? I just wanted to know the number if that's possible?

Rajesh Gupta: So we are not selling pellets right now other than through our seed marketing program. The pellet realizations internationally are very poor. We are able to get a much better realizations in India. So in Goa, we are selling our pellets for around INR11,000, INR10,500. That's not us, but the manufacturer of the pellets with our iron ore. We are exporting some pellets. I think in this year, we should get around \$128 to \$130.

Moderator: The next question comes from the line of Vinit Thakur from Plus91.

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Vinit Thakur: I saw the presentation and there was a question I wanted to get an answer on. What are the future capex time line we're looking at? When are they coming on stream?

Riyaz Shaikh: The next year, as I've been already telling you this, this is around INR6,000 crores to INR6,500 crores is what we have to do. Till date, as we have announced around INR32,000 crores, INR33,000 crores of capex over the next 5 to 7 years. Of that, INR 5,000 crores has been done until 31, March '25.

Next year is what we do is INR6,000 crores, INR6,500 crores, similar thing we should be done in the next to next year and then a higher figure of around INR8,000 crores to INR9,000 crores in the next years. So by that, we should be completing it over the next 5 years.

Vinit Thakur: And when are the projects going to be live, like the pellet plant and the 1.2 million steel plant, the BHQ throughput, when are they going to be live? Like is there a time line of each of these plants?

Rajesh Gupta: Sequentially, I think there in the presentation, but let me repeat it. The first DRI plant would be live in June 2025. The first pellet plant and pipeline would be live in June 2025. The second pellet plant would be live approximately June 2026. The steel plant of 1.2 million tons would be live September '26. The first BHQ plant would be live June '27. Rest of the BHQ would be live March '28. And the final steel plant of 3 million tons would be live in March '29 to September '29.

Moderator: The next question comes from the line of Manu Kumar an individual investor. Since there's no response, we'll move on to

the next participant. The next question comes from the line of Abhishek Kamdar from Value Plus Advisors LLP.

Abhishek Kamdar: Given the scale of investment planned in the steel vertical and the long-term value creation potential, is it a possibility to eventually list the steel business through an IPO or demerger once the operations stabilize?

Rajesh Gupta: No, Abhishek, there's no such plans or thought process at the moment. We believe integration may be the best way forward, but that's too forward thinking for us right now.

Moderator: The next question comes from the line of Vivek Patel from Le Luxe.

Vivek Patel: I just wanted to know regarding a bookkeeping question. I just wanted to know the non-current assets have increased from INR169 crores to INR795 crores. So can you help me with that? What would be the breakup of that?

Riyaz Shaikh: This is more on the advanced tax position, the non-current assets because -- and mostly that is receivable with the government authorities.

Vivek Patel: And even on the other current liabilities, so it has increased from INR30 crores to INR1,335 crores in...

Riyaz Shaikh: That is the advances from customers.

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Moderator: The next question comes from the line of Siddharth Gadekar from Equirus.

Siddharth Gadekar: Sir, just one thing on the pellet plant. Given that there will be an annual maintenance at peak, we would be operating the plant at 90% or we can go up to 100% over the full-year beyond FY '26?

Rajesh Gupta: I think the capacity would be 100%, not in '27, but we will be able to achieve 4 million tons in each of these plants by '28 or so.

Siddharth Gadekar: Even adjusted for the annual maintenance that we will take a shutdown.

Riyaz Shaikh: Yes. The plants are designed for a higher capacity. So this would be what we can achieve for the whole year, including the annual shutdowns.

Siddharth Gadekar: Sir, and secondly, in terms of when we spoke about 100 million tons of iron ore moving from allocation to the auction route. So, given that the market will likely become tighter, is there scope for us to increase prices further from these levels going ahead?

Rajesh Gupta: Steel is a commodity. Iron ore is a bigger part of the same commodity. And I would not even think of predicting the future pricing of any commodity.

Moderator: The next question comes from the line of Kartik Khandelwal from HEM Securities Limited. The participant seemed to have dropped. Ladies and gentlemen, that brings us to the end of the question-and-answer session. I would now like to hand the conference over to the management for the closing comments.

Riyaz Shaikh: Thank you, everybody, for an engaging question-and-answer session. I hope we have answered reply to all your queries. If anything is pending, you can always get in touch with anyone of us so that we'll be happy to give you all the replies in that case. Thank you very much. And thank you, Anand Rathi team for hosting this call.

Moderator: Thank you, sir. Ladies and gentlemen, on behalf of Anand Rathi Shares and Stock Brokers Limited, that concludes this conference. You may now disconnect your lines.

Call: Aug 2025

18th August, 2025

To,
BSE Limited National Stock Exchange of India Limited
Phiroze Jeejeebhoy Towers, Exchange Plaza, Bandra Kurla Complex,
Dalal Street, Mumbai – 400001 Bandra (East), Mumbai - 400 051
BSE Scrip Code: 512455 NSE Symbol: LLOYDSME

Sub: Transcript of the Conference Call for investors and analysts for Q1FY 26
Dear Sir/Madam,

Pursuant to the Regulation 30 of the Securities and Exchange Board of India (Listing Obligations and Disclosure Requirements) Regulations, 2015 ("Listing Regulations"), and in furtherance to our intimation dated 08

th August, 2025 regarding Conference call with Analyst(s) /Investor(s) held on Wednesday, 13th August 2025 we would like to inform that the transcript of the aforesaid conference call is attached herewith and the same is also available on the website of the Company at <https://lloyds.in/investors/analyst-and-investor-meets-and-presentations/>.

The same may please be taken on record and suitably disseminated to all concerned.

Thanking you, Yours Sincerely,
For Lloyds Metals and Energy Limited

Akshay Vora
Company Secretary
Membership No.: ACS 43122

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"Lloyd Metal and Energy Limited
Q1 FY '26 Earnings Conference Call"
August 13, 2025

MANAGEMENT : MR. RAJESH GUPTA – MANAGING DIRECTOR – LLOYD
METAL AND ENERGY LIMITED
MR. RIYAZ SHAIKH – CHIEF FINANCIAL OFFICER –
LLOYD METAL AND ENERGY LIMITED
MR. CHINTAN MEHTA – CHIEF INVESTMENT OFFICER
– LLOYD METAL AND ENERGY LIMITED

MODERATOR : MR. PRATEEK SINGH – DAM CAPITAL ADVISORS

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Moderator: Ladies and gentlemen, good day, and welcome to the Lloyds Metals and Energy Q1 FY '26 Earnings Conference Call hosted by DAM Capital Advisors. As a reminder, all participant lines will be in the listen-only mode and there will be an opportunity for you to ask questions after the presentation concludes. Should you need assistance during this conference call, please signal an operator by pressing star then zero on your touch-tone phone. Please note that this conference is being recorded.

I now hand the conference over to Mr. Prateek Singh from DAM Capital Advisors. Thank you.
And over to you, sir.

Prateek Singh: Thanks, Shruti. Good morning, everybody, and thank you for joining us today. We at DAM Capital are pleased to host Lloyds Metals and Energy's First Quarter FY '26 numbers. We have with us today from the management, Mr. Rajesh Gupta, Managing Director; Mr. Riyaz Shaikh,

CFO; and Mr. Chintan Mehta, CIO.

Without further ado, now I would like to invite Mr. Rajesh Gupta to initiate the proceedings for the call. Thanks. And over to you, sir.

Rajesh Gupta: Thank you, Prateek. Good morning, everyone, and a warm welcome to the Q1 FY '26 earnings call of Lloyds Metals. I would like to express our gratitude to DAM Capital and Dharmesh bhai for graciously hosting this call.

To begin with, let's say this, Q1 has been a fantastic quarter of milestones for us. We have successfully commissioned the pipeline and the 4 million ton pellet plant in Konsari, both are among the fastest execution in India. We have received the environmental clearance to expand the mining to 26 million to 55 million tons per annum, up from 10 million tons. We completed the acquisition of the remaining MDO operations, integrating cost efficiency and boosting long-term profitability and further strengthening our mining business performance and margins. Our construction of the steel plant in Ghugus is well underway, with the pre-commissioning of the DRI cables already started. To briefly touch upon the market scenario for iron ore and pellets, the domestic iron ore pellet market remains strong, supported by strong steel demand and capacity expansions across the country. Steel demand continues to remain at 8%, 9% growth. India steel trajectory is driving sustained iron ore uptake. And therefore, the pellet demand continues to grow and especially in the environmental advantages in steel making that pellet making offers. The domestic demand remains the primary focus. Internationally, the iron ore -- in the international market, iron ore market has passed the worst, I believe, with index now poised to run between \$102 to \$110 for the rest of the year.

Coming to a few of the highlights for this quarter. We need to highlight the strategic investments in pellet plants. We have invested in two pellet plants. One is Mandovi River Pellets Private Limited, which is on the West Coast near Goa and one is Brahmani River Pellets Limited, which is on the East Coast in Orissa. This strengthens our pellet -- our access to pellet markets across the country, East, West and Central, positioning us as one of the most formidable players in the Indian pellet industry.

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Last year, we were 0. Right now, we are 9.5 million. And next year, we'll be at 13.5 million tons capacity. We are now well geared to cater to both domestic and export markets for pellets. While the domestic environment is highly conducive, we are actively evaluating export opportunities.

Our capex program is promising at full swing, well planned, meticulously executed and running simultaneously across three locations. As mentioned earlier, at Konsari, the pellet plant Phase 1 has started and Phase 2 is on track, with operations expected by the end of this FY.

At Ghugus, the wire rod mill project

is in advanced stages. All steel plant have been executed. Construction has started. The DRI WHRB plants will start getting commissioned in this quarter. Having said this, we are still looking at growth, maybe even beyond iron ore. We are looking at studying opportunities in other minerals and resources in various geographies to shape the next phase of growth.

We would do it in a very phased and systematic way, the way we have developed our iron ore business with a society-inclusive model and minimal leveraging, giving us the confidence. This will give us the confidence to replicate similar success in new resources.

With these strategic developments, we are confident of delivering growth ahead, which will be similar, if not exceeding our growth in last 4 years. I thank all our investors for being part of our journey and for their continued trust and support.

Now, I'll hand over to our CFO, Riyaz, who will walk you through the financial performance for the quarter.

Riyaz Shaikh: Thank you, Rajeshji, for the brisk and insightful strategic update. I will now take you through our quarter 1 FY '26 financial and operational performance, along with key highlights on execution and capital expenditure. Starting with overall financial performance. The first quarter of FY '26 has been marked by strong operational execution, translating into robust financial delivery. Our total income stood at INR 24,084 million, broadly flat year-on-year, but registering a sharp 99% increase sequentially.

On the profitability front, EBITDA came in at INR 8,087 million, up 12% year-on-year and an impressive 188% quarter-on-quarter. EBITDA margins expanded to 33.6%, reflecting both better iron ore realization and operational efficiencies. Profit after tax stood at INR 6,346 million, up 14% year-on-year and over 3x higher quarter-on-quarter, with PAT margins of 26.35%. These numbers underscore the resilience of our integrated business model even in the face of commodity price variation.

Now speaking on per ton matrices to give a more closer look at performance. For iron ore, sales volume for the quarter was 3.45 million tons, up 2% year-on-year and 107% quarter-on-quarter. Average realization stood at INR 6,061 per ton, up 6% year-on-year and stable sequentially. EBITDA per ton for iron ore improved to INR 2,223, an increase of 20% year-on-year and 46%

Speaking about DRI. Volume was 78,900 tons, higher by 3% year -on-year and 13% quarter -on-quarter. Realizations were muted, down 10% year -on-year and 2% quarter -on-quarter given market price softness. On power front, it was quite muted. Volume remained stable year -on-year and quarter -on-quarter, though realizations were down 27% year -on-year due to lower merchant power prices.

I would also like to spend some time on mentioning about capital expenditure and execution. This quarter has been remarkable in terms of execution. Our capex program is progressing exactly as per schedule, with work happening simultaneously across all major sites. In quarter 1 FY '26, we incurred INR 13,270 million of capex, following the INR 36,947 million invested in financial year '25.

Key projects include BHQ beneficiation. The pilot plant results are consistently showing results of over 63% Fe content. Pellet Plant 2 at Konsari is expected to be ahead of schedule. Wire rod mill and steel plant at Ghugus progressing well, with civil and structural work underway. Then we have the slurry pipelines, which in infrastructure, which improves logistics efficiency. The discipline and simultaneous execution across locations, mines, pellet plants and downstream steel facilities positions us strongly for volumes and margin expansion. The update on the Thriveni MDO, that is TEIL, Thriveni Earthmovers India Private Limited acquisition

ion. The acquisition of Thriveni's MDO operation through Thriveni Earthmovers India Private Limited has been completed. This integration gives us direct control over a critical cost driver in mining and is expected to improve mining EBITDA margin on a consolidated basis. The TEIL acquisition will start getting consolidated into our financials from quarter 2 FY '26 onwards, further enhancing earnings visibility.

Speaking about the balance sheet and financial strength, which remains core to our strategy. We continue to maintain a robust balance sheet with strong operating cash flows and prudent capital allocation. This financial strength ensures that our growth ambitions, both in core iron ore and pellet capacities and in new mineral opportunities are fully funded without overleverage. We have consistently delivered industry -leading shareholder returns over the last 1 year. LMEL shares have delivered a 117% return versus 24% for the NSE Metals Index. And over the last 3 years, shareholder returns stand at over multiple, reflecting strong operational delivery and market confidence in our growth strategy.

For my closing remarks, in summary, quarter 1 FY '26 has delivered on both operational and financial fronts, underpinned by disciplined execution, cost control and strategic investment. With the projects under implementation and the benefit from TEIL consolidation from next quarter, we remain confident of sustaining momentum through the rest of FY '26. Now the floor is open for questions. And I look forward to having a good interactive session with all of you.

Moderator: The first question is from the line of Amit Dixit from Goldman Sachs.
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Amit Dixit: Congratulations for a good set of numbers. Just a couple of questions from my side. The first one is regarding your recent strategic investment. So, while Brahmani River pellet makes sense around 50%, but just wanted to understand the rationale for acquisition of 19.4% stake in MRPPL.

What is the rationale behind it? It doesn't give us any control over material or a meaningful stake as well. So if you could explain the rationale behind it? And whether the recent pellet strategic investments signify that we are going to be a meaningful player in the pellet market or later on as our steel capacities develop, these can be back -ended to supply our steel plants?

Rajesh Gupta: Could you repeat the second part of the question? I couldn't understand it.

Amit Dixit: Yes. The second part of the question is that what is the final -- what you're looking at basically after the acquisition, whether you want to be a meaningful player in the external pellet market or this pellet investment, essentially these pellet plant will feed into your own steel plant?

Rajesh Gupta: So let me answer the first question -- the second question first. With 25 million tons of regular mining and sellable -- 26 million tons of regular mining and around 5 million tons of steel production, we'll always have a 16 million ton roughly excess pellet/iron ore. And that if it is marketed in a blended way, it will always be the right strategy, number one.

Number two, so we would always be having pellet output as a long-term strategy. Number two is also that the BRPL asset would mostly be using iron ore from that area itself and marketing the iron ore also -- the pellet also in that area itself. So, there are also talks with the long -term

consumers utilizing the pipeline and the pellet asset there.

Number three, regarding the Goa, like you are aware, we had a foot in the door earlier by having a conversion contract. We are selling them iron ore, and that continues there. So the asset purchase, if you might have noticed, is at a very, very low valuation, mostly at a book value, basically because it's a long-term thought process to have a foot in the door in the Western Coast as we

Il, especially when we look at the export market from there.

Right now, export is unviable with \$6, \$7 premium over iron ore. Once that will change over a period, then that asset will be more viable. And answering your last -- first question, why only 19.5% or whatever is what was available for us.

Amit Dixit: Okay. Got it. Got it. The second one is essentially in your prepared remarks, you mentioned that the company might be looking for some other mining investments maybe overseas. So if it is not too early, is it possible to give -- drop a head that what could be -- whether we would be...

Rajesh Gupta: It is too early. Even internally, it is too early. We have been scouting, like I said, across metals and across geographies. It is too early to commit anything on that.

Amit Dixit: Okay. So if I just squeeze in one more, and that is an offshoot from the last question. What kind of profitability we are looking at pellet considering that our iron ore is of higher grade with low silica alumina content? So, what kind of profitability you are working with? I mean, preferably there will be some good buyers for it in export market as well?

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Rajesh Gupta: Right now, our sales is totally in the Indian market. We have produced around 2.5 lakh tons, 3 lakh tons till now in the last 40 days. And we are sold out till mid-September or so, mostly in the Indian market. The profitability is around -- extra from iron ore of around INR 1,500 to INR 1,800 per ton on an EBITDA basis. The advantage to that pellet plant is also the pipeline. So, we save on the iron ore transportation as well.

Moderator: Our next question is from the line of Vikas Singh from ICICI Securities.

Vikas Singh: Sir, my first question pertains to our guidance of 22 million tons of iron ore mining. We did 3.5 million and currently monsoon is going. So, our asking rate for the second half could be anywhere between 7 million to 8 million tons per quarter, assuming some impact for the monsoon in 2Q. So, just wanted to understand how confident we are on this? And what is the evacuation plan on -- because evacuating 8 million to 9 million tons in the last quarter would be difficult, right?

Rajesh Gupta: Right. So having completed the 2 quarters, let's say, around 8 million tons -- 7.5 million to 8 million tons, we'll be left with around 14 million tons in the 2 quarters. Out of the 2 million tons will be evacuated -- 2.5 million tons will be evacuated by pipeline to the Konsari plant. We hope to sell some concentrate from there as well. And balance is around 12 million tons, 11.5 million to 12 million tons, which leaves around 45,000 to 50,000 tons a day of transportation by truck to customers as well as by truck to the railway sidings.

We have got 3 railway sidings fully operational with full-fledged stockyards near the railway siding. We have the truck and the full network available to be able to do that. We have been doing on good weather days up to 60,000 tons per day on a stretch of 3, 4 days. So right now, it's possible. We haven't achieved that quarterly figure, but daily, weekly figures have been achieved beyond this limit.

Vikas Singh: Noted, sir. Sir, my second question again pertains to your 2 strategic investments. Just wanted to understand, is there any clause already there, which allows us to buy the remaining stake or for the time being, it is just the minority stake which we are picking up?

Rajesh Gupta: I couldn't understand the question.

Vikas Singh: So in this 2 strategic investments basically, the MRPL and BRPL, is there any clause which allows us to take further stake in these companies at a later stage achieving certain milestone?

Or this is the only transaction, which we are doing and there is no plans for further increasing the stake in this company?

Riyaz Shaikh: Yes. See, currently, we weren't looking --

we were trying to get in more and more whatever we could achieve, but we could achieve only 49%. The balance 50% remains with our partner, that is TEMPL only. So it's more or less in the same group. Yes, if there is a requirement of taking over that, we will be able to do that.

Vikas Singh: And just, sir, what about Mandovi?

Riyaz Shaikh: Yes, you were saying something?

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Vikas Singh: Regarding Mandovi because 19.4%, that too in Goa where there is a low grade availability and you are predominantly dependent on export market to be good, while there's a lot of news coming that the Chinese capacity might get cut. So the low versus high- grade premiums might also shrink going forward.

So, I still didn't get the rationale why you gone to that geography? Because you are already creating a good pellet capacity by yourselves, sir. There was no basically exact reason for us to go for a small plant like that.

Rajesh Gupta: The Mandovi asset have been purchased at book value, at their procurement value. And so that is a very low price asset. We are supplying them iron ore. And it's a strategic investment. I mean, it's an investment not -- you will not get involved in the operations apart from what we are right now doing.

The pellets if exported will be through us, like we have been doing earlier. So that would continue. It's an additional partnership with the promoters there. They would not be interested in selling more, like I mentioned earlier. And at the moment, we are very, very going to continue on the same basis.

Vikas Singh: Yes, sir. So exactly, that is why my concern was since we don't have control and we are -- ourselves is a very dominant player in that space, what was the need to just go and buy minority stake? Because I don't think that this would contribute significantly into our financials as well.

Rajesh Gupta: It does not contribute to our financials. It's a INR 16.5 crores investment by a company, which is worth INR85,000 crores. And we believe that it's an investment which will pay in the long run, which strategically, we have now a foot in all the 2 -- both the coasts and the central part of the country. That is a very strategic decision. We have -- I mean, there's nothing else I can really say on this. INR 16.5 crores is the investment. There's no management stake.

Riyaz Shaikh: The marketing contract continues, what we are still doing. The export is through us only. We'll be doing that. We'll continue doing that.

Moderator: Our next question is from the line of Parthiv Jhonsa from Anand Rathi.

Parthiv Jhonsa: Sir, my first question pertains to the entire cost optimization. Considering our per ton EBITDA has been better compared to the hike in ASP or realization, is it fair to assume that we have started getting some benefit from Thriveni already and this will continue going forward?

Further, you have mentioned on one of the slides, if I'm not mistaken, Slide 19, that once 85-kilometer completely wraps up the slurry pipeline, you would have about INR 500 to INR 600 per ton kind of a cost saving and captive logistics would be about INR100 to INR150 per ton. So is it fair to assume that this about INR 2,200 EBITDA per ton can easily be close to about INR2,700, INR2,800 in next 2 quarters?

Rajesh Gupta: The benefit of Thriveni would come in automatically with the consolidated figures. The slurry pipeline advantage for 10 million tons out of 26 million tons will be there. So therefore, the Lloyd Metal and Energy Limited

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advantage would be INR500 into 10 by '26. So, that will be a little lesser. I hope that answers the question.

Parthiv Jhonsa: Yes, no. So just wanted to understand, does this INR 2,200 EBITDA per ton include anything or does it -- has it started including anything from the Thriveni benefit or it will completely accrue

in Q2?

Riyaz Shaikh: See, the Thriveni benefit will start coming in only in the next quarter, the running quarter because consolidation, it will be -- the consolidated numbers will show you that. Till now, it wasn't there.

It was just an effect of the slurry pipeline, which we just commissioned for almost an end part of the last month of the quarter and the realization as well as the work what we have been doing on the cost front. So, all these things have helped us in improving our EBITDA.

Rajesh Gupta: Let me add one item on this logistics question. We have started in this quarter our logistics company, which would also be more in the Thriveni group of companies -- under Thriveni rather than directly under Lloyds. That will also...

Riyaz Shaikh: It will be a step down subsidiary.

Rajesh Gupta: Step down subsidiary. And that will also add 2 things to the cost saving exercise. One is reduction of costs by having internal control. Number two, the profitability of that company would remain within the group -- within the company. And number three, the early gentlemen, Vikash mentioned about the evacuation that is also supported by that company.

And number four, of course, is also the greening of the whole exercise. So, logistics is a very, very serious aspect of us, and we are looking at all aspects to make sure that logistics are green, are saving money and are efficiently evacuating the product.

Parthiv Jhonsa: Sure. That is quite helpful, sir. Sir, my second question is pertaining to the MRPL 19.4% strategic stake.

Right now, I believe it's about 2 million ton kind of a capacity. Just because you are supplying a high- quality ore to them apparently, is there a possibility for them to hike this 2% to, say, 4%, 5% if the export opportunity or the domestic opportunity in that belt increases? Is there a good opportunity to increase the capacity there? Any idea on that?

Rajesh Gupta: I believe that the company would be looking at beneficiation assets in that Goa because there are a lot of dumps that are being auctioned. And there is a beneficiation plant available with the Chowgule's, erstwhile owner of this company. So the strategy is to use that more, beneficiate it in the Chowgule plant and bring it to this pellet plant and mix it with our -- blend it with our ore and get a very acceptable quality of pellet for the domestic market.

Parthiv Jhonsa: And sir, if I may just squeeze in a quick one. You have given guidance till '27. Just wanted to understand by '28, your BHQ 15 million tons would come on stream, that would give about close to about 5 million tons of equivalent ore, right? So is that fair to understand that your iron ore production would drop down from '25, '26 guidance to, say, 20 number and your BHQ would be 15 million? Is that understanding correct?

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Rajesh Gupta: We are accelerating our BHQ program from input of 15 million tons in the first phase to -- 30 million tons in the first phase. So, that will give us 10 million tons output and the DSO sales would come down by same amount. So, we'll be able to execute the 26 million tons that is allowed under the EC for the life of the mine.

Parthiv Jhonsa: Got it. So 16 plus 10, correct?

Riyaz Shaikh: 16 plus 10. Yes.

Moderator: Our next question is from the line of Siddharth Gadekar from Equirus.

Siddharth Gadekar: Sir, first on the operational performance, can you give a split between the fines and the lumps this quarter in terms of volume and the realization?

Riyaz Shaikh: It was around 11% of lumps and balance was fines.

Siddharth Gadekar: And realization for both?

Riyaz Shaikh: The realization was INR 6,500 for the lumps and around INR 5,900 for the fines.

Siddharth Gadekar: Sir, secondly, for this quarter, how are we looking at the realization?

Rajesh Gupta: The markets have -- I think if I look at the average pr

ice, it will be a little INR 200 more at the

moment, our current market price, and we see that it will continue. Nobody can really predict the iron ore pricing. But given the fact that steel demand growth is 8%, 9%, production is similar 9% and iron ore is up by 8%.

We see the continuous gap increasing and also seeing it in the market by seeing that there is lesser exports, a little more imports of iron ore and some pellets coming. So with all that, we think that the market would be quite strong for iron ore.

Siddharth Gadekar: Okay. Sir, secondly, in terms of our volumes for 2x, where we are guiding for around 14 million tons in the second half, sir, have we already started negotiations with the customers to actually supply the entire volume?

Rajesh Gupta: Yes, we have. Our largest two customers have been getting 31%, 35% from us that would continue on the same ratio, and that has been negotiated on some index basis. The other products are internally, like you said, pellet. Pellet is going to a brand- new geography because earlier, we didn't have enough lumps. So the pellets is going to the southern geography where there's a good demand.

So, that is actually taking away 2 million tons going forward, 2.5 million tons of our pellet of our iron ore away from the market, away from our sales liability and going to a brand- new market. I see pellet and lump as competing with each other. So, that's why we are very careful of that. The rest of the market basically grows in the same ratio, and we are very, very confident of able to evacuate the material and sell the material at similar margins, if not better than the last quarter.

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Siddharth Gadekar: Lastly, on our wire rod capacity also, we have started any discussions with customers? Any primary market that we would be targeting for wire rod?

Rajesh Gupta: We are -- this is the first plant in our area in the Western region in the Maharashtra region. We have a very clear cut marketing strategy tied up. Number one is that we are doing 3 service centers in 3 different areas. One is very near the plant.

One would be near Hyderabad again and one would be near Bombay, Pune. So with these 3 service centers, we'll be able to sell a large quantity of TMT, even though it is wire rod, we would sell it in coil form and the service centers would be able to sell TMT.

The wire rod itself, we are talking to some wire rod manufacturers as well as to LRPC manufacturers to be able to get into that field, especially LRPC is growing at the rate of around 25% -- 20%, 25%, and we want to partake in that. It will be very, very partnership -oriented marketing for that product.

Thirdly is that we have 3 products that we'll be selling from our mill. One is wire rod, which is

around 700,000 to 800,000 ton s. TMT, both in wire rod form and in straight form, around 300,000 tons. And alloy steel bars, carbon steel bars, which will be around 200,000, 300,000 tons. So, we have a whole range, very, very flexible thought process in our marketing and in our product mix as well as the mill configuration.

Siddharth Gadekar: Got it. Sir, lastly, on the capex for this year, how should we think about the capex , including the acquisitions that we are doing?

Riyaz Shaikh: See, for the acquisition, we have that cash flows are built in within the company internal approvals, plus some shares is what we have to be doing. So it will be an issue of new shares.

And the balance capex , what we are already there in our pipeline, that is all the thing we've done around INR1,300 crores to INR 1,400 crores in the first quarter. And going ahead, we should be on an average doing over the next 3 years at around INR 7,500 crores to INR 8,000 crores. And plus, we have the 65% of the warrants, which is pending. So, around INR 1,770 crores is pending on that. We should be getting that.

Moderator: Our n

ext question is from the line of Bhavin Chheda from ENAM Holdings.

Bhavin Chheda: Sir, congratulations on overall good set of numbers and getting EC raised to 26 million ton s.

Overall, good...

Moderator: Sorry to interrupt. Bhavin sir, your voice is a bit low.

Bhavin Chheda: Can you hear me now?

Rajesh Gupta: Yes.

Bhavin Chheda: Yes. Sir, congrats on overall numbers and getting a EC limit to 26 million ton s. So just a few questions. I think just a follow -up on the earlier one. Annual capex , you said INR 7,500 crores to INR8,000 crores for next 3 years, next 2 years?

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Riyaz Shaikh: Per year.

Bhavin Chheda: For the projects, which are already going on?

Riyaz Shaikh: Per year, yes. That would be per year.

Bhavin Chheda: Okay. So for the projects, which are already going on for expansion of steel and pellets, so we are pending -- it would get over in INR 24,000 -odd crores.

Riyaz Shaikh: Correct.

Bhavin Chheda: Right. And this includes a greenfield 4 million pellet capex also to Ghugus, which is there in the presentation right now?

Riyaz Shaikh: Yes.

Bhavin Chheda: And the new slurry pipeline.

Riyaz Shaikh: Yes, sir. Yes.

Bhavin Chheda: Okay. Second question, I just missed out on the 14 million evacuation plan for second half you had mentioned. I just missed out 2, 3 points there. Can you repeat that, sir?

Rajesh Gupta: Okay. Around 2.5 million ton s would be evacuated by the pipeline, leaving around 11.5 million tons. If you divide that by 180 days, it leaves around 50,000 ton s per day. We have been doing 60,000 tons regularly on dry days in the rainy season as well after the EC. And we are very confident that we can complete the 22 million ton s that is the capacity allowed by the EC in this financial year.

Bhavin Chheda: Right. And the last question on BHQ grade, the capex , what we are doing, as you said. Now, Phase 1, you are doing 30 million tons at one go. And how would it be commissioned in phases?

Rajesh Gupta: So the 30 million tons would be 6 trains.

Bhavin Chheda: 6 trains?

Rajesh Gupta: There were 3 modules of 3 trains each, so 9 modules. The 3 modules are 3 trains each. So, there are 9 trains. We'll be commissioning -- we are doing -- going ahead with 6 trains in the first phase.

Bhavin Chheda: Will give you a total of?

Rajesh Gupta: Each train would be commissioned, say, let's say, every month, every 15 days or 1 month, 2 months. But the overall infrastructure will be ready for the 30 million ton s input and 10 million tons output.

Bhavin Chheda: Okay. And the first train should be next year?

Rajesh Gupta: No, I would -- next -- by the end of the financial year.

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Bhavin Chheda: Okay. By March '27 or so, or Jan '27 basically.

Rajesh Gupta: Yes. December '27.

Riyaz Shaikh: FY '26 -- FY' 27.

Rajesh Gupta: FY' 27, yes. Sorry.

Moderator: Our next question is from the line of Vinit Thakur from Plus91 AMC.

Vinit Thakur : I had a couple of questions. Could you tell me about what our IPS benefit will come on stream? Is it from this year or next year?

Rajesh Gupta: The IPS paperwork has started. We will be able to credit the IPs for the pellets in this year itself.

Vinit Thakur: And sir, how much are we expecting?

Rajesh Gupta: I don't have the figures on hand. But essentially, the pellet plant divided by 12, and also the DRI plant when it gets commissioned.

Vinit Thakur: Okay, sir. And sir, I had one operational question. Sir, we completed our pellet plant in 18 months, whereas industry size is around 3 to 4 years. What gives us the moat to complete the plant in such a fast pace?

Rajesh Gupta: One of the reasons is focus, focus, focus. Number two is we have got our own internal company. When I say internal meaning Lloyds Engineering and their associate, LICL, which

has hired all

the equipment, not -- which owns all the equipment for the pipeline as well as the erection. Many of the employees, the workers are employed by this company.

So it's essentially like a full-fledged construction company itself. We are depending on ourselves rather than anywhere else in the outside. And number three is the total support from the local authorities as well as equipment suppliers because all that is very important. Number four is continuous cash flow is going without any hiccups. So, all these things add to this execution strategy, which will continue in all our projects.

Moderator: Our next question is from the line of Divy Agrawal from Ficom Family Office.

Divy Agrawal : Congratulations on the great set of numbers. Sir, firstly, in Q1, our total production was around 4 million tons. And in Q2 due to monsoon, it is expected to be around 2 million tons. So, we are left with around about 16 million tons, which translates to around 2.7 million tons per month.

So, my question is, do we have the capability and the resources or the machineries to produce 2.7 million tons per month?

Rajesh Gupta: Actually, it is 4 million tons in this quarter as well. And this question has been answered earlier, including the pipeline and the fact that we have done 50,000 to 60,000 tons on a single week -- on a daily basis on a single week, we are very, very confident that we can evacuate the full 22 million tons that is required under the EC in this financial year.

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Divy Agrawal : Sure, sir. That was helpful. And second, sir, I just wanted to know about the price hike. So, were there any price hikes in this quarter? Or do we expect any price hikes in coming quarters as well?

Rajesh Gupta: There has been a price hike around 15 days back when the quarter started. And like I said earlier, I cannot predict what the price hike would be like. The market has a supply- demand issue for iron ore. And so we are hoping to succeed in that way.

Divy Agrawal: Just if I can squeeze in one. So what are the margins for Thriveni Pellets and MRPL? And what kind of synergies do we expect from these acquisitions that Lloyds would incur?

Rajesh Gupta: Thriveni Pellets, like I mentioned earlier, is looking at -- not Thriveni, BRPL is looking at a long-term agreement where at one end, the mine is available with one company. And at the other end, there is a steel plant. So, we are looking at that conversion type of agreement.

We can make it consistently INR 600 to INR800 margin well within the investment area that we have. And MRPL is a little more troublesome, and that's why we have only 18% to 19% stake in that -- 19%, 20% stake in that.

Moderator: Our next question is from the line of Harsh Shah from Seven Rivers Holding.

Harsh Shah: Sir, first question is that we are envisaging investment of around INR 600 crores in Dubai. So if you can elaborate about the time line and what kind of opportunities are we foreseeing there?

Riyaz Shaikh: We were just -- as Rajesh ji has also mentioned, we are looking into other geographies and other minerals and all those stuff, what we are looking in for expanding. So, this is just a preparation for that. We can -- we incorporate a company. And if any opportunity is available, then we can go through it on a quicker note. That's why this company is happening.

Harsh Shah: Okay. And sir, we have raised...

Riyaz Shaikh: Nothing specific at the moment. Yes.

Harsh Shah: Sorry. Can you come again?

Riyaz Shaikh: Nothing specific at the moment.

Harsh Shah: Okay. Okay. And sir, we have raised -- we are raising INR 2,500 crores through debentures. And last year, we had taken enabling resolution. We expect the remaining part of INR 2,500 crores also to come in sometime in the current year?

Riyaz Shaikh: See, we're not looking in for any further dilution as such. This

is the NCD what we felt should

be more than enough for taking care of all our projects, any -- the volatility associated with the industry. So, we're just going in for INR 2,500 crores. So as of today, it is only this much. If anything comes up, we'll be letting you all know.

Moderator: Our next question is from the line of Aditya Agrawal from Finavenue.
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Aditya Agrawal : Yes. So sir, I have two questions. First is like we are projecting our top line to be somewhere around INR40,000 crores in a matter of 4, 5 years down the line. So coming on to our backward integration, that is slurry pipelines and the acquisition of Thriveni. And today, as of now, our EBITDA margins were like somewhere around 33% in the quarter. So, do we expect the operating margins to be somewhere north of around 40 percentage in next 4, 5 years?

Rajesh Gupta: No, I think the steel margins would normally be much lesser. I don't have the figures off-hand.

Riyaz Shaikh: The cost saving -- with all the cost saving steps what we are taking, we are trying to achieve, if not beyond 40%, we'd like to close to 40%.

Aditya Agrawal: Close to 40%.

Rajesh Gupta: And we will compound these figures more properly as the industry is progressing as our macro improves.

Aditya Agrawal: Yes, sir. And sir, second is like this -- on the pellet pricing, so are we planning to supply pellets towards Raipur market as well? I mean from the industry sources, there is a lot of DRI capacity that is coming over there. So, do we have any plans to supply pellets over there? Or we will be looking for a different location for supplying pellets in the market?

Rajesh Gupta: We have already started our pellet output, mostly in the south part of the country because there was a bigger supply-demand gaps there and a lot of DRI units are there also. We do not exclude Raipur from our thought process. At the moment, that margin is a little more crowded, and we look at geographies which give us the best realization without disrupting the overall market.

Aditya Agrawal: Yes, sir. And sir, like coming on to our -- the overall production and the pipeline that we are having, so are we optimistic on the steel pricing like overall market outlook? I mean, iron ore is pretty stable. So coming on to pellet, like do we expect pellet to be stable somewhere around INR9,000 to INR 10,000 per ton?

Rajesh Gupta: Right now ex-factory are around INR 8,700, INR8,500. And we see that moving with the iron ore market going forward. I think the worst of the pellet industry -- the pellet industry as well as the smaller steel players suffer a lot in the rainy season. So, I think in the next 9 months, we foresee a very steady demand for pellets and pricing should reflect based on iron ore and iron ore pricing, like I mentioned earlier, cannot be predicted by anybody.

Aditya Agrawal: And sir, our top line guidance of INR 40,000 crores remains intact for next 4 years?

Rajesh Gupta: We have given such a guidance? I don't think so.

Aditya Agrawal: In the May '24, 1, in the last call.

Rajesh Gupta: 4.2 million tons steel plant itself gives you INR 25,000 crores and 10 million tons of iron ore gives you the balance. So, that's where that INR 40,000 crores top line comes from. Yes, it does -- if the projects are all online.

Moderator: Our next question is from the line of Tanmay Choudhary from Ventura Securities.

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Tanmay Chaudhary : I just have a follow-up question on the iron ore production. Like we are guiding for 22 million tons in FY '26. So correct me if I'm wrong. Like 4 million tons is going for pellet plant, 0.5 million tons will be going for DRI. So, we are left with around 17.5 million tons over the -- for the open market side, right?

Rajesh Gupta: A little more because it's not 4 million tons

on s, it's annualized 4 million tons. It's around 2.5 million tons for the pellet and around 800,000 tons for the DRI.

Tanmay Chaudhary : For the DRI?

Rajesh Gupta: 800,000 tons. So, we are left with 3.3 million tons, which is around 18 million tons.

Tanmay Chaudhary : And we are not seeing any issue on the demand side like absorption side over there?

Rajesh Gupta: No, I'm not seeing that at all.

Tanmay Chaudhary : Okay. Okay. And sir, one more question, like over the DRI part, just wanted to know like how do we see going forward because we have seen realization have come down despite of volume going up. So, can you just comment over like how do you see it?

Rajesh Gupta: So, DRI and the steel sector is undergoing its annual problem of the rainy season. Unfortunately, it started a little before that because of the international problems of China. Now, I'm seeing the DRI is still under pressure and margins are still under pressure, still positive over and above iron ore price or pellet price for that matter, but under pressure. Margins will remain under pressure for the next 6 to 8 months, I see. And yes, pellet is more stable and demands are better.

The demand of steel has gone up by 8% over the last 2 years, 3 years. It was a little more in the 2 years back, and now this year is around 8%, 9%, which is still a very, very strong demand.

The problem is that the supplies are even stronger. The supply growth is even stronger, and it

will take some time to stabilize till the steel market stabilizes. DRI is a factor of the steel market.

Moderator: Our next follow-up question is from the line of Vinit Thakur from Plus91 AMC.

Vinit Thakur : One more question I had is since we have moved towards 100% green mining, are there any plans to venture into green steel as well?

Rajesh Gupta: Definition of green steel is not fully understood by me. The taxonomy revised by the government of India, our steel plant would be in the 5-star rating.

Moderator: Our next follow-up question is from the line of Parthiv Jhonsa from Anand Rathi.

Parthiv Jhonsa: Sir, my first question is pertaining to the couple of coal blocks, which were auctioned in the nearby vicinity. I believe those blocks are not yet operational. So, any chances those would come out for re-auction and you would be able to participate in that because they're in very close vicinity to the existing mine?

Rajesh Gupta: Ore or coal?

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Parthiv Jhonsa: Ore. Iron ore.

Rajesh Gupta: Iron ore. There were six blocks, which were auctioned in the past. I have no exact status of what is the exact status of that. Those were exploratory consolidated blocks. I have no idea what is the status of those blocks.

Parthiv Jhonsa: Okay, sir. Sir, my last question is pertaining to the capex. I believe you said that your yearly capex for next 3 years is about INR 7,500 crores to INR 8,000 crores. Just wanted to know, in the near term, you're going to see some amount from the warrants. And I just wanted to check like would we be open to take debt just to fund these capex or it will completely be from internal accruals?

Rajesh Gupta: So, we have taken some debt.

Riyaz Shaikh: We have taken some debt in the last year also, this year also. Wherever we feel there is a shortage or wherever we feel there would be a stress is when we are planning and going ahead with that. Now, we've taken an NCD approval of INR 2,500 crores.

This is something, which we are looking at over the next 3 years, which should give me a buffer. It could be a long-term type of a thing is what we are targeting at. And it should be a buffer, which should be taking care of all our debt requirements till the time of capex what we have announced.

Moderator: Our next question is from the line of Amay Sharda from Purnartha Investment Advisors.

Amay Sharda: So, I just had a question on Thrive

ni Earthmovers Limited. So, I just wanted to understand whether we'll be using this company for our captive purposes? Or will it also have its own outside business?

Rajesh Gupta: It already has outside contracts. They are operating in -- we are operating in Odisha for iron ore around 14 mines, in Jharkhand with the NTPC mines, in Indonesia, in Andhra in 2 mines, 1 mine in Barite. So, we are already doing that.

We continue to do that, and we'll also continue to look at other MDO opportunities and any international assets as well. If we go into that, the asset will be owned by Lloyds Metal and the MDO would be done by Thriveni. So, we have the double engine growth for future projects is what we are planning.

Amay Sharda: So sir, like what kind of margins does the company earn on these contracts? And what kind of revenue expectations do we have from this company for the rest of the year?

Rajesh Gupta: Roughly, the revenue currently is around -- last quarter was around INR 7,500 crores.

Amay Sharda: Okay. And the margin, sir?

Rajesh Gupta: One minute, sorry. INR 750 crores. The difference between millions and crores, I got confused.

Sorry. EBITDA is around 33% of that. Going forward, the tonnage of Lloyds Metals would be

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added in this year for sure, which would take it up from INR 750 crores per quarter to around INR 1,100 crores per quarter going forward.

Amay Sharda: Okay. So before this, we were not a client of Thriveni Earthmovers?

Rajesh Gupta: We were the clients of Thriveni Earthmovers. We were also the -- yes, we were the -- not this particular company. This is a break-off from the original company. That structure is explained in our previous presentations as well.

Moderator: Our next question is from the line of Prateek Singh from DAM Capital Advisors.

Prateek Singh: Just a last bookkeeping question and following up from the earlier question. So, earlier when we had announced acquiring 80% in Thriveni, so we had given projections for the next few years basis, existing business operations. So, are we at a point where we can give a new estimate if we have won any new order wins? Or should we still assume the same numbers given earlier?

Rajesh Gupta: Since the last quarter, they have not won any new contracts. They are all busy in consolidating these 2

companies and getting the right mix of people. And the integration of 2 big companies is always not an easy job. So, we are all busy there. That integration process is well underway, and we are very happy with the way the integration is going and...

Riyaz Shaikh: We are looking for new opportunities.

Rajesh Gupta: And new opportunities are being looked at.

Moderator: Ladies and gentlemen, that was the last question for today. I now hand the conference over to the management for closing comments. Over to you, sir.

Riyaz Shaikh: Thank you, everybody. Hope we have replied to all your questions, all your queries. If anything else remains pending, you can always get in touch with us. Mr. Chintan Mehta, he is the Investor Relations Officer. You can always get in touch with them, and he'll be providing with you all the replies. Thank you.

Moderator: Thank you. On behalf of DAM Capital Advisors, that concludes this conference. Thank you for joining us, and you may now disconnect your lines.

Call: Nov 2025

18th November, 2025

To,
BSE Limited National Stock Exchange of India Limited
Phiroze Jeejeebhoy Towers, Exchange Plaza, Bandra Kurla Complex,
Dalal Street, Mumbai – 400001 Bandra (East), Mumbai - 400 051
BSE Scrip Code: 512455 NSE Symbol: LLOYDSME

Sub: Transcript of the Conference Call for investors and analysts for Q2 & H1 FY26
Dear Sir/Madam,

Pursuant to the Regulation 30 of the Securities and Exchange Board of India (Listing Obligations and Disclosure Requirements) Regulations, 2015 (" Listing Regulations "), and in furtherance to our intimation dated 7th November, 2025 regarding Conference call with Analyst(s) /Investor(s) held on Thursday, 13th November, 2025 we would like to inform that the transcript of the aforesaid conference call is attached herewith and the same is also available on the website of the Company at <https://lloyds.in/investors/analyst-and-investor-meets-and-presentations/> .
The same may please be taken on record and suitably disseminated to all concerned.
Thanking you, Yours Sincerely,
For Lloyds Metals and Energy Limited

Akshay Vora
Company Secretary
Membership No.: ACS 43122
Encl.: as above.

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2Q & FY '26 Earnings Conference Call "
November 13, 2025

MANAGEMENT : MR. RAJESH GUPTA – MANAGING DIRECTOR –
LLOYDS METALS AND ENERGY LIMITED
MR. RIYAZ SHAIKH – CHIEF FINANCIAL OFFICER –
LLOYDS METALS AND ENERGY LIMITED
MR. S.K. NAREDI – DIRECTOR FINANCE – THRIVENI
EARTHMOVERS AND INFRA PRIVATE LIMITED

MODERATOR : MR. SIDDHARTH GADEKAR – EQUIRUS SECURITIES
PRIVATE LIMITED

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Moderator: Ladies and gentlemen, good day, and welcome to the Lloyds Metals and Energy Limited 2Q FY '26 Earnings Conference Call. As a reminder, all participants' lines will be in listen -only mode and there will be an opportunity for you to ask questions after the presentation concludes. Should you need assistance during the conference call, please signal an operator by pressing star then zero on your touchtone phone. Please note that this conference is being recorded.
I now hand the conference over to Mr. Siddharth Gadekar. Thank you, and over to you, sir.
Siddharth Gadekar: Good evening, everyone, and thank you for joining us today. We at Equirus are pleased to host Lloyds Metals and Energy's Q 2 FY '26 Earnings Call. We have with us today Mr. Rajesh Gupta, Managing Director; Mr. Riyaz Shaikh, CFO; and S.K. Naredi, Director Finance of Thriveni.
Now I would like to invite Mr. Rajesh Gupta to initiate the proceedings for the results call.

Rajesh Gupta: Good afternoon, everyone. A warm welcome to all of you, and I sincerely thank Siddharth ji and the Equirus team for hosting this call and for their continued support. Let me begin with the big picture headline before we go deeper. This has been a half year where operational commissioning of the pellet plant has taken center stage.

DRI plant has started. The value -added products have further strengthened their profile, and our project pipeline has moved forward as predicted with the planning. Across the board, the business continues to demonstrate resilience and direction.

Let's begin with the projects. The slurry pipeline of 85 kilometers has been one of our biggest enablers this year. And I want to emphasize what the slurry pipeline means. Seamless and reliable evacuation, and we've already seen the advantages in this monsoon, structural cost reduction, lower carbon footprint and most importantly, efficient movement that safeguards our margins even in volatile pricing environment.

This truly market turning point on how to operate and scale. The pellet plant has been ramped up, the first pellet plant of 4 million tons, which began commercial production just at the end of Q1. And in the fourth month of full operation. In October, we have crossed 100% of capacity with a production of 350,000 tons, a little bit more than that.

The pellet plant -- pellet business is already contributing robust EBITDA per metric ton driven by captive ores, slurry pipeline efficiency and industry-leading costing -- conversion costing and conversion and strong realizations due to the strong quality parameters. This value -added mix has now become a core driver of our profitability.

The next project that we have just commissioned is one of the DRI, which has expanded our DRI operations this quarter, just towards the end of this quarter. This strengthens the integrated pathway we are building from mines to pellet to DRI and eventually steel. With regards to other projects, we continue to move forward with all our other major projects with a very disciplined approach.

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Pellet plant number two is already in advanced stages, 1.2 million tons of wire rod plant. The groundwork is progressing extremely systematically. The BHQ beneficiation planning and procurement has started. And while land acquisition final state is still going on.

Our overall capex plan remains well -structured and each project is aligned to long-term value creation, not short -term capacity addition. Let me touch base on Thriveni as well. This was the first quarter where the accounts have been consolidated. The EC of our clients in iron ore products has gone up by 35% to 40%. NTPC mines, the EC has gone up by around 20%. Surjagarh mine is also gearing up for full capacity from 10 to 26 million tons .

Operational

and capex gearing up is done for these plants. Given our large -scale mining footprint, rain -related interruptions do have an effect on quarterly numbers. However, I want to highlight that lost revenue will be made up in the coming months, and mining operations are now normalized post monsoon. This confidence comes from the capability and depth our teams have built over years of operating in challenging area.

Our Thriveni underlying operations remained very strong and on track. These -- there are multiple positives worth highlighting. The 5 -star rating at all the key mines, continuous conversion and induction of electric and LNG hybrid mining equipment. All of this enforces our reason of acquisition of this integrated value proposition of the Lloyds Thriveni platform.

Our policy and our philosophy for all these projects remains the same, plan meticulously, execute swiftly, execute efficiently and build for the next 30 years, not for the 3 quarters. I want to appreciate all our teams at the mines, pellet plants, logistic s unit and corporate officers who manage our large -scale operations with nearly 32,000 people now under our hat.

The ability to maintain momentum, innovate on site and push forward despite external challenges, one of our biggest strength. As we look forward to H2, the drivers are firmly in place, full benefit of the slurry pipeline, higher and stabilized pellet output, DRI ramp -up, post

monsoon mining stabilization and systematic execution of all the projects already in motion. We remain committed to creating a business at a structurally low cost, fully integrated, environmentally responsible and built to deliver sustainable shareholder value.

With that, let me hand it over to both my colleagues, Riyazji and Naredi ji, who will take you through the financials and detailed numbers of both the companies. Thank you once again to everyone for joining and special to Siddharth again. Thank you.

Riyaz Shaikh: Thank you, Rajeshji, for the strategic overview. Good evening, everyone. Let me take you through our consolidated financial and operational performance for the second quarter and first half of FY '26, followed by updates on key projects and strategic developments. This quarter has been another strong step forward for Lloyds Metals. We continue to build momentum across all business, translating operational execution into record financial performance.

Starting with the stand-alone numbers. To reiterate, the company has reported its highest ever quarter at half year revenue. Our total income for quarter 2 FY '26 stood at INR 25,754 million, up 75% year-on-year, driven by higher iron-ore dispatches, the commencement of pellet sales and improved logistics through the slurry pipeline. For H1 FY '26, total income came in at INR49,838 million, higher by 28% year-on-year.

EBITDA for the quarter was INR 8,693 million, up 95% year-on-year with margins at 33.75% expanding by 348 basis points. For the half year, EBITDA stood at INR 16,778 million with margins at 33.66% reflecting an improvement of 363 basis points. Profit after tax came in at INR6,056 million for the quarter and INR 12,402 million for the half year, both up 22% year-on-year.

These results highlight the growing strength of our integrated operations and the benefit of higher value-added contribution from pellets. As mentioned by Rajeshji, we are getting more and more close towards creating a resilient business, which has minimum to least impact on account of steel cycle volatility. Our margin improvement is both year-on-year and quarter-on-quarter is a validation of our approach.

Having said that now, moving to the segment performance. In iron production for quarter 2 FY '26 stood at 3.42 million tons, while sales were 2.5 million tons up 77% and 10% year-on-year. Realization averaged INR 5,571 per ton stable

sequentially. EBITDA per ton improved to

INR1,781, up 7% year-on-year. These numbers have to be viewed in perspective that despite quarter 2 being the traditionally challenging quarter for mining, due to monsoon, we were able to report such robust growth in production and dispatches.

The newly commissioned pellet plant at Konsari has been ramping up well and has achieved full utilization within 4 months of commencement. This is quite a significant milestone for us. In quarter 2 FY '26 pellet production stood at 0.78 million tons, with realization at INR 9,916 per ton and EBITDA per ton at INR5,039. The slurry pipeline and captive ore supply has ensured cost efficiency and strong margins right from the start.

In the DRI and Power segment, DRI volumes stood at 88,200 tons, up 4% year-on-year. Though realizations were muted due to market softness, power volumes were stable and lower, fuel cost -- and lower fuel costs helped maintain operating profitability. On capital expenditure, our focus remains on disciplined execution. We have commissioned our DRI expansion in Ghugus in this quarter, and the plant is ramping up well as we speak. We have spent INR 24,117 million during the first half of FY '26 with work progressing simultaneously across all active projects.

Let me also touch upon the Thriveni as well. Thriveni is our subsidiary, which is engaged in MDO and its related services. On a consolidated basis, Thriveni Earthmovers and Infra Private Limited delivered a steady performance. Quarter 2 of the financial year is always a challenging quarter given the monsoon period. This year, monsoon was extended across India, which affected volume to a large extent. However, the team has been quite upbeat for remainder of the year.

To sum up, quarter 2 FY '26 has been a milestone quarter, record revenues, margin expansion, new capacities coming online and successful strategic integration. Each part of the business is now contributing meaningfully to our consolidated strength. With continued execution discipline, the benefit of new capacities and operational synergy from Thriveni and the pellet plant ramp-up, we are confident of sustaining this momentum through the rest of FY '26.

Thank you very much. And we can now open the floor for questions.

Moderator: The first question is from the line of Vikash Singh from ICICI Securities.

Vikash Singh: Congratulations on good set of numbers. Sir, just wanted to understand our iron ore selling strategy going forward, given that the iron ore prices in the domestic market are slightly under pressure. So we are going to have almost 14 million, 15 million tons extra volume. So would we push more volumes or the pricing is something which we keep in mind because that extra volume would further degrade our pricing scenario. So I just wanted to understand overall scenario, how do you see this and the balancing between volumes and realization?

Riyaz Shaikh: So iron ore strategy, we would like to fill our full EC capacity, which this year stands to around 22 million tons. Given the last few months of extra rain, we may have -- we reach between 20 million, 22 million tons. In terms of pricing, pricing is a little down this last 2 months. But prior to that, it has been a little better than the previous quarter year-on-year.

So it is not that it is entirely down. It is softer in a softer regime. And that is the cyclicity of the business, which we are addressing. But we have well executed marketing strategy, including

pelletization, including -- using internal DRI as well as captive or nearly captive consumers. So we are quite comfortable in our marketing strategy.

Vikash Singh: Noted. Sir, since we are selling more on the West Coast and international prices are on a declining trend, just wanted to understand your views. Do you see further downside this to the pricing

? Or what is the discounts domestic prices are trading at versus the international imported landed price?

Riyaz Shaikh: International price versus domestic price, I think we are trading at a premium of around 35% to 45% roughly, yes, not at a discount to the international price. International price currently, say, January is around \$100 for a 61% grade, we are selling at a higher price ex people's factories.

So there is a premium.

Vikash Singh: So there...

Riyaz Shaikh: Sorry, there's a discount which is -- I'm sorry, there is a discount which is slightly lesser. It's a steady thing. And I think India is quite deviated from the international pricing in that way. So I don't think that the further reduction has had any effect on the Indian pricing. The pellet prices has come up and come down more because of the steel market, steel cycle being a little weak.

Vikash Singh: Noted. So you don't foresee much of the risk going ahead?

Riyaz Shaikh: I don't foresee anything more than 2%, 3% market up or down in the next 6 months to 9 months.

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Vikash Singh: Noted. And sir, regarding Thriveni, if I remember when we were doing the merger, our guidance for FY '26 was somewhere around INR 8,000 crores with almost INR 2,800 crores of EBITDA, first half seems to be on the upside. So, do we want to change the guidance on Thriveni? And what caused this basically lower-than-expected achievement?

Rajesh Gupta: The guidance at the time of this merger, when we had bought in this guidance numbers, this was based on 26 million tons of EC of Lloyds metals itself, which we were expecting it to have getting it in the last quarter of the previous year. That has -- which we received only in the month of June this year.

So first quarter, almost after -- at the end of the first quarter. So accordingly, we have already changed this guidance. Whenever we're talking on to everybody, it is -- it won't be those same numbers. Our EBITDA should be anything around INR 2,000 crores to INR 2,000 crores -- for this year, it should be around INR 2,000 crores to INR 2,200 crores.

Vikash Singh: Noted. And, sir, just lastly...

Rajesh Gupta: And all this additional EC and the ramp-up in Surjagarh mines as well as the other mines, will all happen in the second half of this year. So we are very confident to getting reaching those numbers.

Vikash Singh: Noted. Sir, just lastly on our upcoming integrated 3 million ton steel plant. So sir, since you are talking about starting the project as soon as first quarter '27, could you give us the product mix which we are thinking of producing there?

Rajesh Gupta: The 3 million to 3 ton steel plant, we're not talking of starting the project...

Riyaz Shaikh: It is a half 50-50 product mix. HR would be 50...

Rajesh Gupta: We will start the work in mid - to end '27, not the plant. We are restarting the composition a little bit. And the land is under acquisition right now. We've given the detailed project study to be made to a big Chinese consultant to understand the full technology upheaval that has happened in the last 3, 4 years and take advantage of that.

So the product will ultimately be a mix between flat products, value-added flat products, value-added structural steel and color coated in terms of value-added HR coils and flat products. It should be a mix between both. Prior to that, in the next year, we should be able to commission our steel plant at Chandrapur, which will be 1.2 million of wire rod plant.

Vikash Singh: No. Actually, what I was coming from your Slide 23, where it has denoted that the construction work itself will start from Q1 FY '27. So based on that, basically, I was just thinking our product profile, basically, how much of the HRC, how much of the TMT or if we are putting CRC, all these would have been...

Rajesh Gupta: Now 3 million tons of...

Vikash Singh

ng: Already worked out. So that's how I was actually questioning the...

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Rajesh Gupta: Around 3 -- the current project is based on around 3 million tons of HR coil with further downstream of 2 million tons of cold rolling and HR pickled and further downstream of around 0.5 million tons of color coated and galvanized, that was originally envisaged. And we are under the process of restudying that mix and overall size of the plant, which will come back shortly.

We have not started anything other than land procurement at the present point of time.

Moderator: The next question is from the line of Divy Agarwal from Ficom Family Office.

Divy Agarwal : A couple of questions from my side, sir. Sir, firstly, on the gross margin front, so the gross margin has reduced around 79% in the current quarter versus an average of around 87%, 88% historically. So I just wanted to know what led to this deduction? And will it continue in the coming quarters?

Riyaz Shaikh: No, there is no such deduction in the gross margin in this quarter. You're talking of the consol numbers or the...

Divy Agarwal: Stand -alone basis, sir.

Rajesh Gupta: Which is all improved and...

Riyaz Shaikh: It should improve further in the next quarter.

Divy Agarwal: Sure, sir. And secondly, sir, on the Thriveni part. So in the last quarter, it was mentioned that the EBITDA margin should be around 33%, while the numbers reported were around 16%. So just wanted to know what are the -- what is because of this divergence?

Riyaz Shaikh: I'll request Mr. Naredi to address this question.

Management: Yes. Normally, our standard EBITDA margin in our business is around in between 35% to 40%, and we had projected 33%. But last time, it did not reach 33%, it reached only 16.5% in the last first half. The reason being due to lower production, as you are aware, that all our costs are almost fixed, our equipment costs, labor costs, these costs are almost fixed.

And only the variable cost is about the fuel cost. Since there was a lower production almost INR8 million to INR 10 million due to what we had planned initially, what was in our forecast, due to that, our production -- our EBITDA margin has gone down. And ultimately, it has impacted on our profitability margin percentage also.

But next quarter -- next half as well as for both the quarters and next half since the volumes are going to be high, ultimately, overall, we'll be able to maintain. And as everybody is aware that since we had to scale up the production to gear up the equipments and all those things, mobilization and all these things, we need to keep on deploying our manpower and equipments at the various sites for LMEL as well as in Odisha other places. So all these things we have incurred costs. And due to that, our EBITDA margin in terms of percentage or in terms of absolute numbers have gone down in this first half.

Divy Agarwal: So from next quarter, would it be back to around 30%, 33%?

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Management: Yes, absolutely.

Divy Agarwal: Right. And lastly, on the DRI part, so the realization has been low since like 2, 3 quarters. So what's the realization right now? And are you seeing any signs of improvement there?

Rajesh Gupta: DRI in the secondary steel market, both are suffering quite a lot right now. And the only rainbow that you're seeing is a little reduction in coal price, which has reached its bottom, international coal. I think over the next 2, 3 months, the pricing will come back, especially I think the next quarter. This quarter, I'm still seeing a very subdued market.

Moderator: The next question is from the line of Hardik Gori from Abans PMS.

Hardik Gori : Congratulations on a great set of numbers. Could you share the EBITDA per ton number for DRI in this quarter?

Riyaz Shaikh: The EBI

TDA per ton for DRI in this quarter has been -- H1 has been INR3,879.

Hardik Gori: Okay. And what is the number for Q2?

Riyaz Shaikh: INR3,150.

Hardik Gori: Got it. Got it. And what was the IPS benefit in Q2 FY '26?

Riyaz Shaikh: IPS we got around INR 94 crores as a benefit in Q2.

Hardik Gori: All right. All right, sir. And lastly, sir, if you could share the realized slurry benefit in this quarter?

Management: Slurry per ton ?

Hardik Gori: Yes, slurry benefit per ton basis.

Riyaz Shaikh: See, as we've been stating, we saved around INR 600 per ton on the slurry pipeline. Around INR600 has been the saving due to the slurry pipeline.

Moderator: The next question is from the line of Ritesh Bhagwati from Alfa Plus Capital.

Ritesh Bhagwati: My question pertains to our debt situation. So from a stand-alone to consol, I see, we have increased to roughly around INR 8,000 crores, that's like an addition of INR 6,000 crores. So is it like a project related mostly or it's primarily coming from Thriveni's consolidation? That's my first question.

Riyaz Shaikh: Yes, it's actually coming from Thriveni's consolidation. So INR 6,000 crores -- including the RPS, the redeemable preference shares issued to the promoters for taking over of those accounts.

Ritesh Bhagwati: Okay. And also, if you could share any comments on our negative cash conversion that we see on a consol basis?

Riyaz Shaikh: Could you repeat that question?

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Ritesh Bhagwati: If it's possible, can you share any comments on our negative cash conversion, CFO on our consol basis versus the stand-alone?

Riyaz Shaikh: Versus the standalone. Part of it is because of the debt I mentioned. Working capital might be a reason for that. I think we'll get back to you, if you can just get in touch with us to Chintan or myself later on, then we'll get back to you on that in detail because as such, we're not able to get what are -- any negative guidance.

Ritesh Bhagwati: Sure, sir. I'll do that.

Moderator: The next question is from the line of Vinit Thakur from Plus91 AMC.

Vinit Thakur: I just wanted to know what is your estimated iron ore supply shortfall that you expect in current year 2026? And what would be your time line for the third pellet plant?

Rajesh Gupta: The maximum that we can do in iron ore this year is around 22 million tons. We would do a minimum of 20 million, 21 million tons of dispatches from the mine. Part of that will be used internally for the pellet and the DRI, the balance will be sold. We will not be having any stock to a large extent. What was the second part of your question?

Riyaz Shaikh: Third pellet...

Vinit Thakur: What would be your timing for the third pellet plant?

Rajesh Gupta: Third pellet plant will be '28, '29 around the time that the third phase of the beneficiation plant is commissioned.

Vinit Thakur: Okay, sir. Noted. And has the IPS benefit been recognized? And what is the total planned capacity of your pellet plants that you're expecting?

Riyaz Shaikh: Total capacity for my pellet plants would be 12 million tons, floating taking all 3 in those lines. And IPS, yes, we've already started. In this quarter, we've got INR 94 crore, that has been identified.

Moderator: The next question is from the line of Bhavik Shah from Invexa Capital.

Bhavik Shah: My question is related to the debt. So, at the time of Thriveni acquisition, we were told the enterprise value was around INR 5,000 crores, so around INR 4,950 crores of debt. But now when we see the September balance sheet, a gross debt stands at around INR 8,000 crores -- INR 7,980 crores versus INR 756 crores in March. So, there is an addition of almost, say, INR 7,000-odd crores. So, is this like you have extra debt from Thriveni?

Riyaz Shaikh: It's a console number, that INR 7,900 crore is a consol number with Lloyds metals also in it. So

as in Lloyds -- as in for Thriveni, the number was around INR 5,000 crores. I don't -- when we had INR 5,600 crores, which is now around INR 6,000 crores, which is on account of the scaling up of the operations. So that's a continuous business. We have to go on for the equipment and -- plus we also have a cash balance of INR 400 crores. So the net cash would be always INR 5,600 crores.

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Bhavik Shah: Okay. So, we have taken around INR 6,000 crores from Thriveni as debt, right?

Riyaz Shaikh: Yes, including BRPL.

Bhavik Shah: Understood, sir. Understood. And sir, regarding like capex, we have done around INR 2,900 crores...

Riyaz Shaikh: INR 2,400 crores in this half year.

Bhavik Shah: Okay. So, what is the guidance for the remaining year?

Riyaz Shaikh: We should be doing around INR 5,000 -- of INR 4,500 crores to INR 5,000 crores in this year. And the next 2 years also should be around INR 6,000 crores, INR 6,500 crores.

Moderator: The next question is from the line of Siddharth Gadekar from Equirus Securities Private Limited.

Siddharth Gadekar: Sir, my first question is on the Bharat Wire Ropes acquisition where we have acquired some CCPS. Can you just share the rationale behind that? And how do we see that conversion happening over the next 2, 3 years?

Riyaz Shaikh: See it was purely a financial investment. There is no strategic direction attached to this transaction. It is -- this company's position as an industry with a long-term potential. For the risk-reward standpoint, the opportunity was compelling. We are looking at around something around 18% to 20%. And within 18 months is what's supposed to be converted. So that is what we are looking at.

Siddharth Gadekar: Okay. Sir, second question is on the Thriveni operations. When we had done the acquisition we had given a road map where our mining expansion would go up to almost 123 million, 124 million tons once LMEL also ramps up. Where do we stand on that? And over the last 12 months, have we acquired any new projects? Can you give some more color that how should we see '27 and '28 incrementally going ahead?

Rajesh Gupta: In the last year -- this year, we are expecting some increase in our mining operations in Odisha

and two new projects which we are proposing to start is one is Indrani Patnaik mines and another is MGM Mines . These are the 2 mines which we propose to increase in Odisha. And in -- on the coal side, there is a -- we have got a contract from NTPC, it's 3 million tons . So that we are also -- now the coal has been already taken out and it will start immediately in this financial year. And the major impact would be the Surjagarh operations where earlier the capacity was 10 million, now we have got that capacity to increase to 26 million. So these 2, 3 things taken together is going to increase the production this year.

Siddharth Gadekar: Sir, by FY '28, any guidance you want to give in terms of volumes for Thriveni?

Rajesh Gupta: FY '20...

Siddharth Gadekar: FY '27 or '28?

Rajesh Gupta: FY '27, we can just give you right now.

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Riyaz Shaikh: We'll come back to you by -- before the end of this conversation about '27. We just total up all these figures, and we'll come back to you in the meantime, let's continue with the other questions.

Rajesh Gupta: FY -- revenue guidance of around INR 7,800 crores to INR 8,000 crores of top line. Tons and cubic meter, I'll just work out and I'll share those things during this...

Moderator: The next question is from the line of Tanmay Choudhary from Ventura Securities.

Tanmay Choudhary : My first question is on the -- can you just give me the ballpark number for the captive consumption like for the entire FY '26, like 22 million tons are targeting, how much goal for the...

Rajesh Gupta

: Can you repeat the question, be a bit louder?

Tanmay Choudhary: Am I audible right now?

Rajesh Gupta: Yes, now it's better.

Tanmay Choudhary: Yes. I'm asking like can you give me the ballpark number for the captive consumption over the open market side for the pellet and DRI side for the full year?

Rajesh Gupta: For the next year, the total market -- the self consumption would be around 8 million tons for the pellet plant give or take 0.5 million tons and around -- out of that 8 million ton , 1 million ton or 800,000 tons will be used internally and around 200,000 tons for the DRI, so around 1 point -- 1 million ton , 1.2 million tons will be used for DRI and 8 million ton for pellet.

Tanmay Choudhary: And for the open market iron ore?

Rajesh Gupta: The rest will be open, iron ore, which is, say, around 20 -- sorry, 18 million tons .

Tanmay Choudhary: Okay. And sir, in the second half of the financial year, we're targeting for around 12 million to 14 million tons of -- so can you just throw some light of the evacuation plan and the customer concentration profile for the supply of it?

Rajesh Gupta: The customer profile for the iron ore has remains the same. We are 100% serving our customers in the Chandrapur area, 100% -- not 100%, but out of the non-capital consumption in Raipur, most of the iron ore pellet producers are using from us around 70%, 75 %. A lot of the quantity around 40% -- 35%, 40% is going to JSW and JSPL, 100% of our product is going -- of their requirement is being fed by us to them and to Sunflag, which is more or less remained constant for the last 6, 8 months, so it' s quite steady.

On the pellet front, we are, again, in our captive area of Chandrapur and Telangana is more or less 100%. We are feeding to RINL. We are feeding to Bhilai, also export around 70,000 tons , 60,000 tons per month we are exporting. So by and large, that is the route we are looking at other markets also. And we have zero stock at the moment.

Tanmay Choudhary: Understood, sir. And sir, like what would be your framework for the evacuation like? How much you are targeting per day of evacuation through transport and through rail and through pipeline?

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Rajesh Gupta: Look, by pipeline next year would be around 25,000 tons to 28,000 tons and around 60,000 tons by truck to the siding and to the rest of the market.

Moderator: The next question is from the line of Dhiraj Khadilkar, an Individual Investor.

Dhiraj Khadilkar: Yesterday, we get an update regarding the purchase of 290 acres of land from Bilt Graphic Paper Product Limited . The queries will -- what will be this land be used for? Is it for a wire rod mill or something else? And another query is regarding any update on coal mining block at Madhya Pradesh?

Rajesh Gupta: On the land, the land will be used, it's around 10 kilometer from our Konsari factory. It will be used for 2, 3 purposes, including partly housing, which already exist on the land. We'll also be using it as a switchyard station for the MSEDCCL support syste m. Regarding Madhya Pradesh mining, there is no update at the moment. It is still under study and things like that.

Moderator: The next question is from the line of Siddharth Gadekar from Equirus Securities Private Limited.

Siddharth Gadekar: Sir, just a couple of more questions. So first, on the 1.2 million ton BHQ that you have mined, have you already booked these costs in the quarter? And going ahead, will we see some more BHQ mining done before the BHQ plant comes online?

Rajesh Gupta: The costs have been booked and --- lying-in stock .

Siddharth Gadekar: And over the next 12, 15 months before the BHQ plant comes online, will we see more production on the BHQ side also?

Rajesh Gupta: Yes. Yes, the mining plan indicates that. The exact figures, we would know as the mining progresses.

Siddharth Gadek

ar: So this would be over and above the 22 million ton guidance that we are talking about, right?

Rajesh Gupta: This is over and above the 22 million tons.

Siddharth Gadekar: Okay. Sir, secondly, on the BHQ plant, when do we expect the first plant to get commissioned and about the ramp -up also how should we think about that?

Rajesh Gupta: Next year, last quarter should be the first unit. There are -- basically there are 3 units of 15 million ton input, each of these 3 units are -- have seen module of 5 million. So basically, we have million 9 models of 5 million tons each. And starting next -- last quarter of next year, we would be doing one, one module every month -- for the first 6 modules. And then based on that, along with the steel plant, we'll be doing the last module.

Siddharth Gadekar: Sir, broadly by FY '28, we should have around 15 million coming from BHQ?

Rajesh Gupta: Output of 10 million tons, input of 30 million tons .

Siddharth Gadekar: Okay. Got it. Sir, secondly, on the pellets, incrementally with our second pellet plant coming in also next year, how should we think about the customer profile moving?

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Rajesh Gupta: Customer profile is increasing. We are looking, like I said, at more markets towards the south of India and also more exports with CBAM and all that, we are looking to also export into Europe and things like that. So we're looking at various options and -- we have done the overall working. And at this moment, it's too early to divulge that in the public. But we're very confident of the marketing strategy of that. Like I said earlier, our cost of conversion, our captive mining, etcetera, makes us the lowest -cost producer. Our market strength in India is there, and we hope to capture that also in the international market. Right now, most of our exports are going to China, but we are looking at other areas in Far East, Middle East as well as Europe e.

Siddharth Gadekar: Sir, lastly, this quarter, did we have any trading volumes also from pellets or only our own production?

Rajesh Gupta: Can you repeat that question, please?

Siddharth Gadekar: Did we have any trading volumes also from our associated companies on the pellet side?

Rajesh Gupta: So this quarter, the trading was around 2 lakh tons , but of iron ore -- pellet, sorry..

Moderator: The next question is from the line of Vignesh SBK from Ksema Wealth.

Vignesh SBK: So just want to touch up on the debt numbers. So considering the capex of INR6,000 crores, how should we see the debt numbers going forward...

Riyaz Shaikh: INR9,500 crores of an NCD issue. That is what we have planned. So going forward, that is something what we are planning to raise that debt over the next 6 months from now. And working capital is something that we have now -- we've got sanctioned of around INR 800 crores of working capital.

Vignesh SBK: So for FY '27, debt number should be around INR 9,000 crores, like INR 7,500 crores plus...

Riyaz Shaikh: It will be also repaying because the Thriveni loans are getting repaid also every quarter. And even we start repaying from this month as the loans, what we have taken on a short -term basis will all start being repaid. So it would be somewhere -- it should be around INR 6,000 crores -- with the NCD is a big amount, so it should be around INR 8,000 crores.

Vignesh SBK: Okay. But any other plans for future, it should be around debt raising or mostly equity kind of thing which we are planning for?

Riyaz Shaikh: We are planning to do mostly, it should be the lease debt, so more of internal approvals as such, which will be continuously flowing in. So we're planning aiming for a debt to EBITDA of 1, that's what our aim is, though it would be higher sometimes and it will be always a trailing the next year EBITDA. So we're working on those lines.

Vignesh SBK: Okay. That was helpfu

I. And just on the Thriveni EBITDA, any guidance for the next year?

Revenue, I guess it's around INR 8,000 crores you are guided for? How about the EBITDA number, sir?

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Riyaz Shaikh: INR8,000 crores and around 30%, 35% of opex EBITDA. So I think INR2,000 crores is the right figure that we can look at given the vagaries in this year.

Vignesh SBK: Okay. Okay. And just regarding the IPS benefit from now on, annually, how much should we expect, sir, as a total amount, how much should be releasing?

Riyaz Shaikh: IPS would be around INR 1,000 a ton for the pellet and around INR 1,200 for the DRI's additional capacity. So around INR 350 crores to INR 400 crores.

Vignesh SBK: Around -- annually, approximately INR 400 crores. Okay.

Rajesh Gupta: It keeps on increasing as we add on the new products.

Moderator: The next question is from the line of Sumangal Nevatia from Kotak Securities.

Sumangal Nevatia: Sir, my first question is on the pellet. So our margins at around INR 5,000- odd per ton is much higher than the industry standard. So if you can explain what are the economics here? And assuming today's price, do we expect similar margins to continue on expanded volumes also in coming years?

Rajesh Gupta: So the level of margin is, like I mentioned earlier, amongst the highest in the country, 3, 4 reasons. Number one is captive mine. Number two, captive transfer by the slurry pipeline, saving of INR600 for us and INR 1,000 for many other players. Number 3 is an operating cost, which is around INR 300 to INR 400 lesser. And number four, destination to destination our selling price is around INR 200, INR300 higher than anybody else.

So given the factor of all of this, like I have kept saying that our company, we are building a cyclical group industry. So the pellet industry, which is not having a very nice time in the rest

of the player -- with the rest of the players. Because of all these reasons, we are quite happy -- we can be happy, but we are quite happy with the progress. The plant has performed very well as for textbook operations.

Our fuel cost is INR 9.5. We are going to further reduce our conversion cost by going green in the fuel by LNG in this year -- this month, maybe early next month. 25%, 35% of our power would be green in the next 6 months. And all put together, we would save another INR 100, INR150 per ton from these 2 factors alone. So all focused on being cyclical proof. That is our mantra, and we stand by it.

Sumangal Nevatia: Understood. So say INR 4,000 to INR 5,000 range is sustainable. That is what we can assume?

Rajesh Gupta: Given today's market, at least next to 3 months, I would say a little better or the same. Yes.

Sumangal Nevatia: Understood.

Riyaz Shaikh: I don't see it going below INR 4,000 because even at the export level it's INR 4,000.

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Sumangal Nevatia: Okay. Got it. And sir, one last question on the BHQ plant. Now given the mining has started, what are the reasons for the delay in the beneficiation plant? Or is it some sort of inventory? And are we looking at and then only we would commission...

Rajesh Gupta: Talking of first time industry in the country in one of the very difficult terrains. One of the reasons is that we are waiting for the final clearance for the land. Number 2 reason is that we are identified all the technology and doing the engineering in full depth so that when we go there, we can go full blast. By that time, our pellet plant construction would also be over so that the team can fully focus on that side. So with all of that, I think it's -- it's from the original schedule, we are plus/minus 6 months. So it's within the thought process that we had originally.

Sumangal Nevatia: Understood. And sir, margins would be similar, lower royalty will offset the high

her mining costs,

etcetera. Is that the right understanding?

Rajesh Gupta: Yes.

Moderator: As there are no further questions, I would now like to hand the conference over to management for closing remarks.

Rajesh Gupta: Thank you, everybody. Thank you for all the support, and we hope to perform well with your blessing and the blessing of the market. The steel industry is going through a tough cycle at the moment, and we hope to cross this by the time our steel plant starts so that when we are on the other side of a steel cycle, we are in full swing on the steel schedule as well. Thank you again.

Moderator: Thank you. On behalf of Equirus Securities Private Limited, that concludes this conference.

Thank you for joining us, and you may now disconnect your lines.

Call: Feb 2026

09th February, 2026

To,
BSE Limited National Stock Exchange of India Limited Phiroze Jeejeebhoy Towers, Exchange Plaza, Bandra Kurla Complex,
Dalal Street, Mumbai – 400001 Bandra (East), Mumbai - 400 051
BSE Scrip Code: 512455 NSE Symbol: LLOYDSME

Sub: Transcript of the Conference Call for investors and analysts for Q3 & 9MFY26

Dear Sir/Madam,

Pursuant to the Regulation 30 of the Securities and Exchange Board of India (Listing Obligations and Disclosure Requirements) Regulations, 2015 (" Listing Regulations "), and in furtherance to our intimation dated 29th January, 2026 regarding Conference call with Analyst(s) /Investor(s) held on Wednesday, 04th February, 2026 we would like to inform that the transcript of the aforesaid conference call is attached herewith and the same is also available on the website of the Company at <https://lloyds.in/investors/analyst-and-investor-meets-and-presentations/> .

The same may please be taken on record and suitably disseminated to all concerned.

Thanking you,
Yours Sincerely,
For Lloyds Metals and Energy Limited

Akshay Vora
Company Secretary
Membership No.: ACS43122

Encl.: as above.

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Lloyds Metals and Energy Limited
Q3/9M FY '26 Earnings Conference Call "
February 04, 2026
MANAGEMENT : MR. RAJESH GUPTA – MANAGING DIRECTOR –
LLOYDS METALS AND ENERGY LIMITED
MR. RIYAZ SHAIKH – CHIEF FINANCIAL OFFICER –
LLOYDS METALS AND ENERGY LIMITED
MR. CHINTAN MEHTA – CHIEF INVESTMENT OFFICER
– LLOYDS METALS AND ENERGY LIMITED
MR. S.K. NAREDI – DIRECTOR FINANCE – THRIVENI
EARTHMOVERS AND INFRA PRIVATE LIMITED
MODERATOR : MR. PARTHIV JHONSA – ANAND RATHI SHARE AND
STOCK BROKERS LIMITED

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Moderator: Ladies and gentlemen, good day, and welcome to Lloyds Metals and Energy Limited Q3 FY '26 Earnings Conference Call hosted by Anand Rathi Share and Stock Brokers Limited. As a reminder, all participants' lines will be in listen-only mode and there will be an opportunity for you to ask questions after the presentation concludes. Should you need assistance during this conference call, please signal an operator by pressing star then zero on your touchtone phone .
Please note that this conference is being recorded.
I now hand the conference over to Mr. Parthiv Jhonsa from Anand Rathi Share and Stock

Brokers Limited. Thank you, and over to you.

Parthiv Jhonsa: Thank you, Ikra. Good evening, everyone, and thank you for joining us today. We at Anand Rathi are pleased to host Lloyds Metal and Energy Limited Q3 and 9 Months FY '26 Earnings Conference Call. We have with us today from the management, Mr. Rajesh Gupta sir, Managing Director; Mr. Riyaz Shaikh, CFO; and Mr. Chintan Mehta, CIO.

Without further ado, I would now like to invite Mr. Rajesh Gupta sir to initiate the proceedings for the call, which would then be followed by question-and-answer session. Thank you, and over to you, sir

Rajesh Gupta: Good evening, everyone, and a warm welcome to all the participants. Thank you, Parthiv and Anand Rathi for hosting this call. We truly appreciate the interest and time from all our investors, analysts and stakeholders.

Let me start with the headline numbers before we go to the operative narrative, where we have got the highest -- INR11,000 crores we have crossed in consolidated revenue, which is a very, very significant milestone for us. And as you might have seen the presentation, the EBITDA and the PAT match that. I would like to express that this current top line -- current bottom line was our top line around 2 to 3 years back, and we hope to achieve the same in the future as well. I will take a small deviation from my usual remarks today on the ferrous side and start with copper. Copper, as we know, is a new gold for the new age economy. Structurally, the world is entering a phase where copper demand will remain strong for decades while supply will remain constrained. And this is where we believe our entry timing is right.

The copper project in the DRC, Democratic Republic of Congo, in the Katanga area will mark a very important milestone in our history. When we expanded our operations in Gadchiroli, the region was considered difficult and impossible, and we ourselves had failed in execution where we have now learned a lot.

The market as well as the local communities have appreciated the efforts that we have put in, in developing the economy and therefore our business. And we generally believe that over time, the same narrative will emerge for Congo, Katanga as well as other parts of the world.

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For this, I would also like to take a moment to acknowledge the leader of the Congo team, Mr. Surya Narayan, who is the leader and the Director of the Congo team. Projects of this nature require not just capital, but deep operational leadership, which we already have with Mr. Surya as well as other core colleagues from other parts of the operations.

Now let me come back to the pellet operations. Execution continues at a breathtaking pace. Multiple projects are progressing simultaneously, and most importantly, on schedule. The second pellet plant is now commissioned in Q2 FY27 and the 1.2 million ton wire rod mill by Q4 FY27.

While operation -- operating our pellet plant, we have seen opportunity to unlock latent capacity, and optimizing similarly for pellet plant number two, we will increase the capacities of both these plants to 10 million tons from earlier 8 million tons. These projects will improve our

value-added mix and enhance margin stability. Logistics remains one of our most critical pillars of cost leadership.

Our first 85km pipeline is running smoothly and has led us to plan our Second Slurry Pipeline from Hedri to Chandrapur. The key change is the introduction of a stockyard at Chandrapur to move beneficiated ore also through the pipeline route. This will give us advantage for direct access to railways near Chandrapur, and also obviously of saving of INR850 for the sale material and around further INR250, that is around INR1,250 for the material that would be used for the pellet plant in Chandrapur.

We are by this removing the inefficiency of the mine by -- which doesn't have a rail head. Details of this plan are covered in the presentation. Coming to operational performance, Iron Ore dispatches have grown meaningfully, supported by the slurry pipeline which is working very well. Very strong operational discipline and strong execution.

Pellet plants we have achieved within three-four months of commissioning optimal utilization and are now looking at debottlenecking it. Our DRI plants, both of which are commissioned, and the power plants are operating at optimized levels and contributing steadily in a very difficult environment of DRI. On the demand side, both Iron Ore and pellets have witnessed strong demand in the domestic as well as international market, and product has been very, very well accepted.

We expect the buoyancy of the market to continue, supported by infrastructure, steel demand, and of course the economic growth in the country. Let me spend a few moments of time on the MOU with Tata Steel. We have signed a non-binding MOU with Tata for multiple collaboration, to strengthen the ecosystem in Gadchiroli area, in the eastern coast -- eastern belt of India, and

of course we have also signed the shareholder agreement for BRPL pellet plant along with the conversion pellet agreement which gives us a steady cash flow in BRPL.

To summarize, we remain very buoyant on our ferrous operations. Iron Ore volumes are expected in line with the EC to grow in Q4 as well as FY27, and value addition plans continue, and FY27 will mark our formal entry into steelmaking. And lastly but not the least, Copper will

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act as a strong growth engine over the medium term. Now I hand over the call to Riyaz ji and Naredi ji, who will take you through the detailed figures.

Riyaz Shaikh: Thank you, Rajesh ji. Good evening everyone. I'll start with a quote that we strongly relate to at Lloyds Metals. As Satya Nadella says, "Growth is not just about size, it's about mindset, learning, and execution." This philosophy resonates very well with what we are seeing in our business today: Scaling responsibly, improving structurally, and executing with discipline.

With that context, I will take you through the standalone financials and operating performance for Quarter 3 and the 9 months ended FY26, focusing on numbers, margin, and capex. This has been a very strong quarter and nine-month period for us on a standalone basis. In fact, Quarter 3 and 9-month FY26 are the best we have seen so far in terms of revenue, profitability, and margins.

Quarter 3 FY26 standalone, the total income came in at about INR3,875 crores, up 129% year-on-year. EBITDA was INR1,317 crores, which is a 137% year-on-year increase. PAT stood at INR889 crores, up 128% year-on-year. For the 9-month FY26 standalone, the total income was INR8,859 crores, up 59% year-on-year. EBITDA came in at INR2,994 crores, a 74% year-on-year growth. PAT was INR2,129 crores, up 71% year-on-year.

With regards to the margins, margins have remained very healthy and stable. Quarter 3 EBITDA margin was about 34%. 9 months EBITDA margin stood at roughly 33.8%, which is almost 280 basis points higher year-on-year. This improvement is not one-off; it

's structural and is coming

from higher share of value-added products, specially pellets, benefit of the slurry pipeline which has started flowing into the P&L, better utilization across mining, pellet, and DRI operations.

Operational highlights: On the operational sides, Iron Ore production was 5.49 million tons in Quarter 3 and 12.87 million tons for 9-month FY26. Dispatches were largely in line, which is

4.1 million tons in Quarter 3 and 10.1 million tons for the 9 months. EBITDA stood at INR1,825 per ton in Quarter 3 and INR1,951 per ton for 9 months FY '26.

Pellets have been a key positive this year. Pellets production was 1.14 million tons in quarter 3 and 1.95 million tons in 9 months FY '26. What's encouraging is that this run rate was achieved within just 3 to 4 months of commissioning. Realization in quarter 3 was about INR10,289 per ton and whereas EBITDA per ton was roughly INR4,535, supported by captive iron ore, slurry-based evacuation and strong demand -- domestic demand.

DRI volumes were around 0.12 million tons in quarter 3 and 0.29 million tons for the 9 months.

DRI expansion was commissioned during quarter 3 and operations are now stabilizing. Value-

added mix: Value-added products are now forming a meaningful part of our revenue mix. For 9 months FY '26, value-added products accounted for roughly 35% of standalone revenues.

This mix shift is central to improving margin stability, reducing volatility and enhancing overall return metrics. Now coming to the capex update on a standalone basis. Let me quickly touch upon capex. The standalone capex during 9 months FY '26 was about INR4,236 crores. This

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was largely towards pellet plant 2 DRI expansion, the 1.2 million ton steel plant at Chandrapur, the first module of the beneficiation plant.

Importantly, capex execution is on track and within approved budgets. Touching upon the balance sheet and cash flow. Despite the high level of capex, the balance sheet remains comfortable. Strong EBITDA generation has supported internal accrual-led funding and controlled leverage. Working capital continues to be well managed, helped by faster dispatch cycles and healthy demand conditions.

Looking ahead, the outlook looking ahead, iron ore volume should remain strong in quarter 4 FY '26. We aim to exit FY '26 with 20-plus million tons volume on ore. Pellet operation will continue to run at optimal utilization. DRI contribution will improve further as operations stabilize. Overall, we expect margins to remain robust, supported by a value-added mix and ongoing logistic efficiencies. To sum up, standalone performance in quarter 3 and 9 months FY '26 has been very strong. Margins are holding up well on a structural basis. Capex execution remains disciplined.

With that, I'll hand it to Naredi ji for Thriveni performance.

S.K Naredi : Thank you, Rajesh ji and Riyaz ji. Good evening, everyone. So Thriveni growth has always been about disciplined execution, consistency and doing the fundamentals right day in and day out. Let me take through -- take you through the Thriveni's performance for Q3 and the 9 months ending FY '26.

From a financial perspective, this has been a strong and improving period for Thriveni. In Q3 FY '26, the total income stood at about INR2,200 crores with EBITDA of roughly INR550 crores, translating into an EBITDA margin of close to 25%. For the 9 months, revenue were around INR5,480 crores with EBITDA of approximately INR1,080 crores and margin of about 20%.

The improvement in margin reflects better operating leverage, higher equipment utilization and continued focus on cost discipline across various projects. Operationally, our coal mining operations continue to perform exceptionally well. At PB West, we achieved the highest distinction of a 5-star rating from the Ministry of Coal, ranking number one

among more than

380 opencast mines in the country.

December saw a record monthly coal production of 17.7 lakh tons and the in-pit crushing and conveying system commissioned earlier has already handled close to 15 lakh tons, significantly improving the efficiency. PB North West, our another coal block has also commenced production and dispatches and we expect this project to scale meaningfully over the next few quarters.

Odisha remains a key growth driver for us. Several mines have seen capacity enhancements. And overall, Odisha volumes are expected to grow by nearly 40% year-on-year in FY '27. This scale-up is being driven by faster statutory clearances, improved infrastructure and focused execution at site.

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In Gadchiroli, which many of you are familiar with, the environmental clearance has been increased from 10 million tons to 55 million tons, including BHQ. Alongside scale, we continue to push sustainability-led initiatives such as electrification of mining equipment and LNG hybrid deployment, which are helping us optimize costs while reducing our carbon footprint.

We have commenced MDO and exploration activities at Geomysore India Private Limited from January 26. This is a gold mine. This asset provides long-term visibility with a targeted EBITDA of --- contribution of around INR60 crores in FY '27 and we see potential upside as exploration progresses. Internationally, we are rationalizing lower-margin operations in Indonesia and redeploying our equipment to higher return opportunities.

Overall, Thriveni's focus remains very clear. Scale responsibly, execute efficiently and protect margins through productivity and cost optimization. The pipeline for FY '27 looks very strong, and we are confident of sustaining both growth and profitability. With that, I'll hand it over to

Mr. Parthiv, who can open the floor for question and answer. Thank you.

Moderator: Thank you very much. We will now begin the question and answer session. The first question is from the line of Amit Dixit from GS Financial. Please go ahead.

Amit Dixit: Yes. Hi, good evening everyone and thanks for the opportunity. Congratulations for a very good set of numbers. A couple of questions from my side. The first one is on the MoU that we have with Tata Steel. So just wanted to understand the various facets of this MoU. While you have explained in your prepared remarks, Tata Steel also held a concall in which they explained a few things?

But just wondering that in mining, when we are so strong in this region, why do we need someone else? I mean it might be Tata Steel, of course, no doubt they are experts. But what

expertise we are actually looking to get from Tata Steel and is there something that goes beyond mining, let us say, into steel where we might get some kind of consultation from them? And if there is any -- is there any scope of having a long-term iron ore supply agreement to them? I

mean, just wanted to explore these points?

Rajesh Gupta : The MoU with Tata has two parts. One is the BRPL SHA and the BRPL ownership and conversion contract, which is executed. The second future exploration of opportunities, there are two areas that we are looking at. One is the Eastern area of the country where, for example, Tata may have some assets where we can act as a contractor as an MDO contractor maybe or where they may need a pipeline to a certain area where we have some expertise, which Tata has not yet developed or maybe we have some land in Paradip, which we can try to utilize in a better way.

A lot of opportunities are being looked at in the Eastern belt.

In the Gadchiroli area, we are looking at whether we can bid jointly or opportunities come up with government trending system where we can get ore at a relatively better pricing, better commercials. This would not be from the existing mine. It will be for future

re expansions. We are always open to partnerships because that is a way to develop fast and Tata is one of the finest companies in the country, not one of the -- I would call them the finest company in the country. So definitely, it's an honor to be partnered with them.

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Amit Dixit: Okay . Okay, great. The second question is essentially on the copper. So, I mean, it is indicated in the presentation that there are certain mines also associated with it. First of all, Congo is not exactly the best place to work, and then, you know, mining, I know several companies who have failed because of various reasons?

So what is it that we see in Congo, and are these mines yet operational, or at what stage of exploration they are? You have indicated some numbers, but these numbers seem to be more for the processing side. Just wanted to understand the backward integration part of it, a little bit more. And if you can also mention the grade of copper that you expect over there ?

Rajesh Gupta: We are looking at Democratic Republic of Congo, Katanga area. This area by itself and DRC by itself is the second largest producer of copper in the world at the moment, after Chile. Number one. Number two, the copper majors, Glencore etcetera, are all based in copper -- in this area. There are 60 to 80 companies small and big operating, and the infrastructure, the systems are there in place to take care of very many things.

The political stability in this country is much better and particularly this part of the -- the Southern part of the area, and it's a very economically based country and area, not politically worrying. Not zero politically worrying, there would be some worries obviously, but it is well , well sustained. The mining leases that we have are 16 or 18 leases, I'm forgetting the number right now, 18. 18 leases over 100 square kilometers -- sorry, 16 leases over 100 square kilometers. Exploration is going on.

We have already found copper at good depths. 1.5% to 2% copper is also available, 0.8% is also available, oxides are available. And the 10,000 to 12,000 tons is a direct output of the plant that we are talking. We can, for that, for the Cathode plant, the leaching and Cathode plant, we could take the ore from our own mines which we have already started accumulating, as well as from bought out mines.

At the end of the day, it would be an integrated operation of around 30,000 tons per annum, which may take 2-3 years to achieve. We believe that in the next year, financial year '27, 10,000 tons of operations would be achieved at a fairly integrated mix of ore.

Amit Dixit: Great sir. Just if I can squeeze one more. Just wanted to get the status of BHQ plant ?

Rajesh Gupta: BHQ plant, the land is under -- land procurement is under control and the engineering is complete, the ordering is complete. We have ordered the equipment from the best possible companies in the world to take care of any exigencies because it's a newer technology in India, so we're not, you know, taking any chances on the technology part of it. We have worked with the Chinese and now with the -- with FLSmidth also. And we are hopeful of getting it commissioned by December '27 or so.

Amit Dixit: Okay . Great sir.

Rajesh Gupta: Latest by that time. Latest by that time and, yes .

Amit Dixit: Okay sir, great. Thank you so much and all the best.

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Moderator: Thank you. The next question is from the line of Jashandeep Singh Chadha from Nomura. Please go ahead.

Jashandeep Chadha: Hello, hi. Thank you for the opportunity, and congratulations sir on a great set of numbers. Sir, my first set of questions are around iron ore. Firstly on your guidance, FY26 guidance is close to 20 to 22 million ton. If I assume that you will be doing 3 million ton of pellets also

, that is

close to 4.5 -5 million ton of iron ore . 10 million tons of iron ore you have still done, which means close to 6 to 8 million tons of volumes you are forecasting for fourth quarter of FY26?

Lloyds has not done -- you know, anytime such volumes in one quarter. Just wanted to understand what is the confidence behind giving such guidance and what are the challenges that the company can face in meeting those guidance? My first question is this sir.

Rajesh Gupta: The volume in this year -- in this month, that is January, is around 2.4 million tons -- 2.5 million tons, which crosses the 26 million ton overall, and definitely will achieve the 20 million -21 million ton target for the year. We have to appreciate one thing that at the moment we have to - the problem is not in the marketing of it, the problem is not in the mining of it. The area that we are right now focusing on solving the problems are on the logistics side.

Right now we are moving around on an annualized basis around 4.5 million tons of ore by the pipeline. And come by April we will be able to do 9 million tons. The second plant would be come by June, the second slurry pipeline -- the pipeline would be ready to take the second pellet plant input, so 9 million ton would move out of that. And right now we are producing around -- transporting by truck around 70 %-60% more than the overall requirement. It is a tough job. We are very confident of achieving 21. That's why we have given a confident -- a guidance of 20 to 22 million tons for the year. We believe that quarter guidances and directions are lesser -- quarter guidances are lesser important for a company of our nature, and our overall direction of decadal growth or at least 3-year growth is what we are -- what we are -- what I am focusing on. Operational efficiencies are looked at every level, and you can see that in the increase in the revenue, in the margin also, 280 basis point is a factor of whatever Riyaz said plus a cost control system also. So everything has been factored in when we have made the guidance.

Jashandeep Chadha: Understood sir. And thank you so much for such an elaborate answer. My second question is also around, you know, iron ore only. Sir, we have seen that the benchmark domestic iron ore prices have come down in this quarter. With that regard, I just wanted to understand how much, you know, the realization has been impacted for Lloyds ? And how much margin compression EBITDA compression we can see in the fourth quarter ?

And then again related to iron ore only, I just wanted to understand what is the capex for the slurry pipeline ? And can you also, you know, for our analysis, can you also tell us how does it compare with the P eers?

Rajesh Gupta: Compare to the P eers?

Jashandeep Chadha: Peers sir, your P eers!

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Rajesh Gupta: Other company. Okay. The benchmark has come down and so as the basis of benchmark come down from 62% to 61%. So if you currently look at benchmark price of \$103, it amounts to around \$108, which is around \$3 -\$4 higher than the same amount last year -- same period last year. So I think the benchmark has not really come down, it's gone up.

Jashandeep Chadha: Sir domestic -- I was talking about domestic iron ore.

Rajesh Gupta: Domestic iron ore, I don't know by what stats you are saying it's come down. In the -- some of the competition has increased the prices over the last 2 months, both the months. The auctions that have come out have been very strong. Steel benchmark is very strong. So at the moment, I do not see any indication of the steel industry or iron ore industry being soft in India at all. At the moment. Maybe 1-month back, 1.5-month back it was different, but that's part of the cyclical nature of the business.

Jashandeep Chadha: And sir on slurry pipeline, you know the capex and...

Moderator:

Sorry to interrupt you Mr. Singh, can you rejoin the queue for more questions?

Jashandeep Chadha: I mean it's part of my question only. I have asked you that one only?

Riyaz Shaikh: On the slurry pipeline. On the slurry pipeline, as you as you might be knowing, we had planned for another 5 million tons of slurry pipeline connecting our -- the mines to the Chandrapur plant in -- Ghugus plant in Chandrapur. Now what we have now doing is we would be -- we have increased the capacity of that, we will be now making it a 16 million tons slurry pipeline so that we cover the entire 26 million tons of dispatches through slurry pipeline .

So it will be one will be -- one is existing which is there as a 10 million tons, this is a second slurry pipeline which will be a 16 million tons slurry pipeline which will be taking us more to the markets as well as to the -- to our Chandrapur plant. And the total cost for this we also in fact have a second phase on it, the slurry pipeline which will be connecting to more of the markets as well as the ports.

So the total cost envisaged is around INR8,000 crores on this particular project, but we will be doing it on phase wise. So the first phase of up to Chandrapur will be around INR2,000 crores - - INR2,500 crores.

Jashandeep Chadha: Thank you so much sir. I'll join back the queue.

Moderator: Thank you. The next question is from the line of Prateek Singh from IIFL Capital. Please go ahead.

Prateek Singh: Hi, thanks for the opportunity, and congrats on a good set of numbers. The first question, Gupta ji, largely on BHQ project. Given the fact that bulk of our volumes going ahead would be coming from BHQ . How confident are we in maintaining the fact that the cost of production of BHQ would be similar to our current cost of production, given that we'll have to mine more material, there will be beneficiation cost also? I understand that we save a bit on royalty, but do you think there is any risk of operating cost overrun in BHQ going ahead?

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Rajesh Gupta: BHQ, the royalty saving, based on the existing proposals of the government as well as existing policies as well as future proposals of the government, would the royalty savings would offset the cost of processing the ore -- the BHQ to ore. Please also fact or in that the grade of ore from 62-64 would become 66%-67%, and that gets a very high premium.

So the cost of ore versus the selling price or the usability of ore becomes much better. The BHQ beneficiation or beneficiation of ore in general has been accepted by the government as a very, very important aspect of the national policy of steel, and that therefore we expect lot of support on the royalty front from that. Does that answer your question?

Prateek Singh: Yes, so just going into a bit more detail here, sir. So royalty, if our current realizations are let's say 6,000, and royalty all in, let's say, 20%, so 1,200 odd royalty, and even if royalty on BHQ is let's say zero, so INR1,200 per ton of saving plus let's say some premium because of higher grade...

Rajesh Gupta: Royalty is not zero. Royalty would be around from 1,200 would come down to around INR 200 rupees. And processing of the ore would involve some power, which is the biggest cost. We are working on getting greening our power also as well as other operations, and that's where that's what I said we are using the best technology to ensure that the systems are very, very strong and uptimes and efficiency of the plant is the best.

Prateek Singh: Okay, understood, sir.

Rajesh Gupta: The premium that we would get on this output of product if I were to sell all the ore would be around INR1,400 a ton also. You have to also factor that in.

Prateek Singh: Understood sir, understood. And the second question is largely on the slurry pipeline, 85 kilometers...

Moderator: Sorry to

interrupt you Mr. Singh, as we have a long queue, can you please rejoin for a follow-up question?

Prateek Singh: Yes sure.

Moderator: Thank you. The next question is from the line of Vikas Singh from ICICI Securities. Please go ahead.

Vikas Singh: Thank you for the opportunity. Sir, my first question pertains to our copper mine, as you stated that it was an operational mine. So just wanted to understand had the existing promoters was facing any difficulty in terms of producing and ramping up of the mine, and that's why we were got the chance to get some stake there?

And secondly, on the management bandwidth, we are doing too many things simultaneously. So just wanted to understand the management bandwidth in terms of managing and looking after the timely completion of all these projects. How should we look at it?

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Rajesh Gupta: Number one, on the existing promoter, they are more involved in commercial activities and general traders in the country. They had got this mine as an opportunity, mine and the copper plant has been set up by them as well. The copper plant is running -- is set up, but not running. They lost the bandwidth to run it, and that's where we come in.

We have Mr. Prabhakaran and the erstwhile Thriveni had been looking at DRC for a long period, and that's how the opportunity comes to us of investing in that. There have been no problems.

Again I repeat, there are around 70-80 plants including Glencore and Ivanhoe and the best companies in the world running copper mines there and copper operations. So that's not a worry that we are -- we foresee in a very serious way.

In terms of operational bandwidth, we have scaled up -- first let me give you a little bit of history.

We scaled up from around INR500 crores to INR10,000 crores or in this year maybe INR13,000 crores over 4 years. We have proved to the market, we have proved to ourselves, we have proved

to our team, and our team has proved to us that we can take care of growth in a sustainable, sensible, economical, and business-like manner. And we continue to do that. Number one.

Number two, as far as Congo particularly is concerned, one of the Promoter Directors would be involved full-time there. Apart from a very, very professional team who has been involved in mining operations, and we have hired experts on copper side also -- on the copper manufacturing side also.

The technicality of the leaching process and the cathode process is not a very -- is not a super technical or a super new invention, and that can be taken care of by the team that we have ensured already on the job at the site as we speak. I think that should -- we are confident of sustaining this growth in a very sensible way.

Vikas Singh: Noted sir. Sir second question pertains to Thriveni. While the top line growth for. ..

Moderator: Mr. Singh, sorry to interrupt you. As we have a very long queue, can you please rejoin for a follow-up question?

Vikas Singh: I'll rejoin.

Moderator: Thank you. The next question is from the line of Vedant Sarda from Nirmal Bang Securities Private Limited Please go ahead.

Vedant Sarda: Thank you for the opportunity and congratulations on the great set of numbers. Sir, my question is, we are hearing that government is taking various measures to ensure availability of iron ore, like they have to bring our iron ore, iron product sizes at par with international markets. So we can complete and export our iron goods. So, can you comment on the pricing outlook going forward and how to look at this?

Rajesh Gupta: See, if you look at iron ore in India, the growth is around 5%-6%, the steel growth is around 8%-9% even now. If you look at 5 years CAGR, it is 5%-6% for iron ore and around 9%-10% for steel. So, there has been a continuous shrinkage of the supply, extra supply and therefore exports

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either in the form of low-grade iron ore or in the form of pellets have reduced. So, the overall supply-demand gap is very, very favourable in supply of iron ore, number one.

Number two, as we go forward, over the next 5 years, around one-third of the capacity which is premium-free will go into auction over the next 5 years and that will add to the, not the lesser supply, but definitely to a higher cost mechanism for the industry.

So, we are pretty confident of our commercial part of selling iron ore and over a period, our value-added business will be quite a lot and we can therefore be well equalized in both iron ore as well as value-added products like pellets or steel as well in the future.

Vedant Sarda: Thank you for explanation, sir. Thank you so much.

Moderator: Thank you. The next question is from the line of Harsh Shah from Seven Rivers Holding. Please go ahead.

Harsh Shah: Good afternoon, sir and our heartiest appreciation for excellent execution over the last 3 years.

Sir, my first question is on the MoU with Tata Steel, given that it could end up being quite an extensive agreement eventually. So will it in any way affect or change our plans for the integrated steel plant, which would be our INR16,000 crore capex plan?

Rajesh Gupta: Our future steel plant in Gadchiroli is being looked at internally, nothing to do with the Tata MoU. Any Tata MoU -- any Tata setup together would be for a different plant than that.

Harsh Shah: Okay. And sir, one bookkeeping question. What would be the warrants outstanding now as of today?

Rajesh Gupta: What is the?

Harsh Shah: Outstanding warrants as of today.

Rajesh Gupta: We should be getting around INR900 crores from it. I'll give you, I have got the number, but the value around INR900 crores is pending, which would be coming up in the month of March. That is something - the time between 15th or 18th March that will happen. So we should be getting it.

Harsh Shah: Okay. And sir, on the copper part, the 10,000 metric ton capacity which we have, what would be the average realization and EBITDA margin on those?

Rajesh Gupta: This is copper cathode. So the current copper price is around \$11,000 -- \$11,500, \$12,000. And normally, there is a premium to Congo because of the transport cost. So the -- that's the approximate range. And the margins that we anticipate are approximately 30%, 32%. So that gives that INR500 crores, INR700 crores that we're talking about next year.

Harsh Shah: Okay. And since we have 50% stake in this JV and this is relating to this? So are we the MDO partner here or mining will be done by someone else?

Rajesh Gupta: Mining would be by Thriveni, by a subsidiary of Thriveni in that area, yes.

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Harsh Shah: Okay, sure. Thank you so much.

Moderator: Thank you. The next question is from the line of Hardik Gori from Abans Investment Managers. Please go ahead.

Hardik Gori: Hello, sir. Thank you for the opportunity and congratulations on a great set of numbers. Firstly, on the growth outlook for our MDO business in FY '27? And secondly, what was the IPS benefit for Q3?

Rajesh Gupta: IPS benefits, we have been drawing the benefits from day 1 of the pellet plant production and this year has been around INR130 crores. The Thriveni outlook is around 40% increase in iron

ore non- Lloyd metal. Around 60%, 70% increase in the Lloyd metal because of the BHQ increase, 15% in NTPC, that is both the Pakri Barwadih mines, around INR60 crores EBITDA they have come up directly with the EBITDA figure expected for the gold mine.

Management: Goldmines is 0.3 million tons.

Rajesh Gupta : 0.3 million tons output and that would be the profitability. There will be some reduction in volumes in Indonesia and in the barytes operations. Overall, a top line growth of ar

ound 15% to

20% and a bottom line growth of around 35%, right?

Hardik Gori: Got it, sir. And our expected debt trajectory on a consolidated level?

Moderator: Sorry to interrupt. Please rejoin the queue for more questions.

Hardik Gori: All right. Thanks.

Moderator: Thank you. The next question is from the line of Vinit Thakur from Plus91 AMC. Please go ahead.

Vinit Thakur: Sir, I would like to know what would be the expected debt consolidated figure for the year and what would be our peak debt?

Riyaz Shaikh: As on 31st December, if I would say, the consolidated debt, net debt was around INR7,100 crores.

This year, we should be not more than that. And FY '28 is when I would say the peak debt. When we reach the peak debt, we should be -- on a consolidated basis, should be around INR10,500 crores, INR10,600 crores. So we are always targeting at 1 is to 1 debt to EBITDA and that is what we are working on.

Vinit Thakur: Thank you, sir.

Moderator: Thank you. The next question is from the line of Shubham Harne from Purnartha Investment Advisors . Please go ahead.

Shubham Harne : The question was I think EBITDA per ton for pellets has declined on a Q -on-Q basis. Last quarter, it was INR5,000 per ton . This quarter, a little less around INR4,000 or so. So any reason for that?

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Rajesh Gupta : DRI is one of the most challenging businesses like some other questioner asked earlier about the down cycle. It's most affecting the secondary steel market and that. Prices on pellets, if you're asking has gone up.

Shubham Harne: The EBITDA per pellets?

Rajesh Gupta : If you look at the pellet prices, the pellet pricing has gone up. Therefore, pricing is showing that there's a pressure on that, right, EBITDA on DRI pricing. So basically, it's a -- it was a cycle. The cycle has crossed the hump.

Riyaz Shaikh: The pellet prices in quarter 2 was around INR11,000, is what we had got in average realization and it has come down to INR10,000 in quarter 3. That is why the margins have been reduced.

Rajesh Gupta : The pricing is lower because we have added more export to the mix. As the volume has picked up, we have had to add some volume of export. The EBITDA is still very strong and much stronger than the rest of the industry put together.

Shubham Harne: Okay. Got it, sir. Thank you so much.

Moderator: Thank you. The next question is from the line of Tanmay Choudhary from Ventura Securities . Please go ahead.

Tanmay Choudhary: Sir, given Lloyd's ongoing capex pipeline, so can you just outline the expected funding mix and cash outflows over next 2 years and also the scheduled debt repayments and principal payment providing not declining any dividend?

Riyaz Shaikh: The debt schedule and all, we can give it to you separately. I won't be able to do that. But yes, the capex outlay is around INR14,000 crores from this year and the next year. We would be around -- we intend to do around INR6,000 crores from debt and then the balance should be from the internal accruals. That is where we are working on.

Tanmay Choudhary: Okay. And sir, just last one question. In PPT, we have mentioned the realization of pellet increases because of the geographical location. So can you just throw some light on it?

Rajesh Gupta : Sorry, can you repeat your question?

Tanmay Choudhary I'm saying in the PPT, we have mentioned the realization of pellets increases because of the geographic location. So can you just throw some light on it?

Rajesh Gupta : Geographically -- I mean, I cannot relate directly to the PPT question, but geographically our location is such that we can market to -- we have been very strong in marketing to the South as well as the Chandrapur area itself. So that's why our realization in pellet is around INR4,500 and the EBITDA is around INR4,500 crores per ton because of the market -friendly nature as well as

o

ur costing and logistics cost. So I think that's where -- does that answer your question? Or is there something specific?

Tanmay Choudhary: No, sir. Like I'm asking about the realization?

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Rajesh Gupta : Realization is a factor of trade versus market and that's where we are. Being actually located, it helps, the location helps. That's how we are better than others.

Moderator: Thank you. The next question is from the line of Karthik Srinivas from Unifi Mutual Fund. Please go ahead.

Karthik Srinivas : Sir, I just had one question just on the policy level. Now that many mines are coming up for auction till 2030 and there is significant demand-supply gap between iron ore and steel, is there any possibility that the government has to intervene and put a cap on the auction premiums? And is there a risk that we run -- because if the government have intervene and put a this thing on the auction premiums or change some of the policies at a policies front?

Rajesh Gupta: The government we believe is still believing in free market, and the premiums are quoted by the biggest consumers of iron ore, which are one of the biggest -- some of the biggest corporates in the country. So we have not seen any policy change or policy announcement which would indicate that there's being a cap on the premiums being put.

Karthik Srinivas: Okay sir, thanks.

Moderator: Thank you. The next question we have is from -- a follow up question from Jashandeep Singh Chadha from Nomura. Please go ahead. Hi, thank you for the opportunity again.

Jashandeep Chadha: Sir, my question was regarding Thriveni . Just wanted to understand, you know, on the remarkable performance, the EBITDA has doubled quarter-on-quarter. I wanted to understand that the proportion of the EBITDA, so is it the large chunk of increase, is it coming from increased volumes from Lloyds, or there are other major heads also because of which the EBITDA has improved? And wanted to understand how should we, model the growth in EBITDA going forward till FY '28 if you can help sir?

Management: In Q3 the EBITDA is increased mainly because up to Q2 due to rains and other local factors, the EBITDA was -- the production was lower, so and the EBITDA was lower. And Q3, when the rains were not there, we came to our original strike rate and the EBITDA was normal as what we had planned.

And for the next year what we are targeting -- Q Q4 again the Lloyds will be doing the full production. This year also we are -- in Q4 we are starting one new mining lease and next year we are getting 3 -4 new contracts and extended capacity. So the volumes will be higher and accordingly we don't face -- see any challenge in EBITDA.

Jashandeep Chadha: Understood sir. So just concluding that, so this appears to be the normal run rate for EBITDA and as contracts increase and volume increase, there will be, growth from here onwards. Is my understanding right sir?

Management: Yes.

Jashandeep Chadha: Okay. Thank you so much sir. Thank you.

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Moderator: Thank you. The next question is from the line of Rushabh Dhruv from Uttam Investments. Please go ahead.

Rushabh Dhruv: Yes. So my question is regarding iron ore sales volume. So for this quarter we just did around 4.1 million tons, right? Then why is this PPT also showing 5.39 million tons? What's the difference here?

Riyaz Shaikh: That that also includes the internal transfers. That's how it was. That is the dispatches from the mines.

Rushabh Dhruv: Okay , okay. So it's captive, right?

Riyaz Shaikh: The sales figure is 4.1 million. Which is there...

Rushabh Dhruv: Sales is 4.1. Okay. Thank you.

Moderator: Thank you. The next question is from the line of Prateek Singh from IIFL Capital. Please go ahead.

Prateek Singh: Hi. Thanks for the opportunity again.

Just wanted to get a sense as to when we had showcased the transaction with Thriveni back in December '24, we had given a sense of an EBITDA of

around INR3,500 crores in FY '27 by Thriveni . Is that something which we stand by or are on track right now as well, or is that number a bit changed up or down?

Management: FY '27 the EBITDA of Thriveni should be close to INR3,000 crores.

Prateek Singh: Understood, understood. Thanks, that's all from my side.

Moderator: Thank you. The next question is from the line of Divya Agarwal from Ficom Family Office . Please go ahead.

Divya Agarwal : Yes, hi sir. Thanks for taking my question. Sir, my question is on Thriveni MDO business. So in Q2 call you guided to achieve EBITDA of around INR 2,000 crores to INR2,200 crores for

FY '26. However, if we see 9 months, the total EBITDA stands at around INR 1,100 crores. So do you still stick to your earlier guidance or would you like to revise it downwards?

Management: We stick to the guidance.

Divya Agarwal : You stick to the guidance, sir?

Management: Yes, yes, we stick to the guidance.

Divya Agarwal : And on the revenue guidance as well, just wanted to know for FY '26 and '27, what would be the revenue guidance for Thriveni ?

Management: FY '26...

Divya Agarwal : FY '26 and '27. For the entire year FY '26 and entire year FY '27?

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Management: FY '26 and FY '27.

Divya Agarwal : Right, right sir.

Management: Yes, so FY '26 we are looking at a revenue guidance of around INR 7,500 plus crores. And FY '27 revenue guidance of INR10,000 plus.

Divya Agarwal : INR10,000 plus crores.

Management: Yes.

Divya Agarwal : And last year sir just what would be the actual PAT for...

Moderator: Mr. Agrawal, sorry to interrupt you Mr. Agrawal. Please rejoin the queue for more questions.

Divya Agarwal : Sure, sure. Thanks.

Moderator: Thank you. We'll take the next question from the line of Parthiv Jhonsa from Anand Rath Share and Stock Brokers Limited. Please go ahead.

Parthiv Jhonsa: Hi, thank you for the opportunity and thank you for allowing us to host the call. My quick question is on again on Thriveni MDO. A couple of quarters back you had given us the guidance for almost up to '28 and '29. I believe sir has given the EBITDA guidance of about 30% in '27. Thereafter, is it possible to give a guidance of '28 and '29 because I think it was about 32%-odd give or take, considering you are going to do 40% higher volumes on iron ore non- Lloyds and for the other minerals as well? Is it possible to give some guidance?

Rajesh Gupta: '28-'29, see it's a contracting company, we are looking at contracts on a continuous basis. It would be very difficult to see, give a further guidance than what we have. Even the guidance that Mr. Naredi just gave would have some surprises upwards because some contracts would come up hopefully future.

Parthiv Jhonsa: Absolutely, absolutely. Yes. Okay. And sir is it possible to repeat that number that 40% increase in iron ore and everything? I think I missed a couple of them actually. For next year?

Rajesh Gupta: The internal -- sorry, the external iron ore figure is around 40% increase in '27, FY '27. The external coal, that is NTPC contract is around 15% growth, correct me if I'm wrong Mr. Naredi. There would be a reduction of around 65% in the barytes operations. There would be reduction of around 25% in the Indonesian operations. Add to that Gold and Copper of the Katanga area . With that we expect that figure that Mr. Naredi just gave us.

Parthiv Jhonsa: Perfect. Sounds great sir. Thank you sir.

Moderator: Thank you. Ladies and gentlemen, due to time constraint, that was the last question. I would now like to hand the conference over to Mr. Parthiv Jhonsa for closing comments. Over to you.

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Parthiv Jhonsa: Thank you all for joining us for the conference call today. We at Anand Rath Share and Stock Brokers Limited would like to thank the management for giving us this opportunity. This concludes this conference call. Thank you everyone and have a good day.

Moderator: On behalf of Anand Rath Share and Stock Brokers Limited , that concludes this conference. Thank you for joining us , and you may now disconnect your lines.

Call: May 2026

11th May, 2026

To,
BSE Limited National Stock Exchange of India Limited Corporate Services Department Corporate Communications
Department
Phiroze Jeejeebhoy Towers, Exchange Plaza, Bandra Kurla Complex,
Dalal Street, Mumbai – 400001 Bandra (East), Mumbai - 400 051
BSE Scrip Code: 512455 NSE Symbol: LLOYDSME

Sub: Transcript of the Conference Call for investors and analysts for Q4FY26

Dear Sir/Madam,

Pursuant to the Regulation 30 of the Securities and Exchange Board of India (Listing Obligations and Disclosure Requirements) Regulations, 2015 (" Listing Regulations "), and in furtherance to our intimation dated 29th April, 2026 regarding Conference call with Analyst(s) /Investor(s) held on Wednesday, 06th May, 2026 we would like to inform that the transcript of the aforesaid conference call is attached herewith and the same is also available on the website of the Company at <https://lloyds.in/investors/analyst-and-investor-meets-and-presentations/> .

The same may please be taken on record and suitably disseminated to all concerned.

Thanking you,
Yours Sincerely,
For Lloyds Metals and Energy Limited

Akshay Vora
Company Secretary

Enclosure: as above

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May 06, 2026
MANAGEMENT : MR. RAJESH GUPTA – MANAGING DIRECTOR –
LLOYDS METALS AND ENERGY LIMITED
MR. RIYAZ SHAIKH – CHIEF FINANCIAL OFFICER –
LLOYDS METALS AND ENERGY LIMITED
MR. S.K. NAREDI – DIRECTOR OF FINANCE –
THRIVENI
MR. HEMANKUR UPADHYAYA – DEPUTY CHIEF
FINANCIAL OFFICER – LLOYDS METALS AND ENERGY
LIMITED
MODERATOR : MR. SHIVANSH SINGH – EQUIRUS SECURITIES
PRIVATE LIMITED

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Moderator: Ladies and gentlemen, good day, and welcome to the Lloyds Metals and Energy Limited Q4 FY '26 Earnings Conference Call. As a reminder, all participant lines will be the listen-only mode and there will be an opportunity for you to ask questions after the presentation concludes. Should you need assistance during this conference call, please signal an operator by pressing star then zero on your touchtone phone. Please note that this conference is being recorded.
I now hand the conference over to Mr. Shivansh Singh. Thank you, and over to you, sir.
Shivansh Singh: Good afternoon, everyone, and thank you for joining us today. We at Equirus are pleased to host

Lloyd Metals and Energy 4Q and FY '26 Earnings Call. We have with us today Mr. Rajesh Gupta, Managing Director; Mr. Riyaz Shaikh, Chief Financial Officer; and Mr. S.K. Naredi, Director of Finance from Thriveni.

We would like to begin the call with brief opening remarks from the management, following which we will have the forum open for an interactive Q&A session. Before we start, I would like to point out that some statements made in today's call may be forward-looking in nature, and a disclaimer to this has been included in the earnings presentation shared with you earlier. Now I would like to invite Mr. Rajesh Gupta to initiate the proceedings for the results call. Over to you, sir.

Rajesh Gupta: Good afternoon, everyone. A very warm welcome to all the participants joining us on this call today. Thank you Shivansh, and the entire Equirus team. We deeply value your continued support and engagement. It fills me with immense pride to share that Lloyds had crossed the converted market cap of INR1 lakh crores, a milestone that we have seemed distant not long ago.

This milestone belongs first and foremost to every single investor, each and every one of you who backed us through our 50-year journey through our early days of uncertainty and up to this milestone. This I'm saying as a guy who for years thought that IR meant Industrial Relations only.

Your patience is a reflection of trust you have placed in us, and we take that responsibility very seriously. Our sincere gratitude to all our investors, analysts and stakeholders joining us on this call and on this journey.

Before I speak about this -- our performance, I want to take a moment to acknowledge our team at the mine, at the plants and all the offices all over the world. What has been achieved by us in the FY '26 is quite extraordinary. It did not happen by accident. It happened because the team - - because of a team that showed up every day with clarity of purpose and relentless focus on execution.

In the last 5 years, our CAGR on revenue is up by 109%. And on PAT, the CAGR is a whopping 139%. This shows that we are a 50-year-old start-up. This year, our standalone profit crossed INR3,100 crores on a standalone basis and INR3,829 crores on a consolidated basis.

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Consolidated revenue crossed INR17,000 crores, fast approaching the \$2 billion mark. On operations, our iron ore scaled from 10 million to 22 million tons, which is a 120% growth in a single year. The pellet plant commissioned at the fag end of Q2 reached 100% capacity utilization within just 4 months, 3 million tons in 9 months, a ramp-up that very few plants anywhere in the country have achieved.

DRI volume scaled 56% year-on-year with the new kiln ramping up steadily as the pellet plant. Going on with to the projects, we have invested heavily for the future, INR13,500 crores in the last 4 years, and this will continue. Konsari, in Gadchiroli, we have completed the 2 pellet plants reaching capacity of 8 million tons, making us the largest merchant pellet player by far. And we also commissioned along with the 85-kilometer slurry pipeline, which is delivering now cost

savings and operational stability. In the mine at Hedri, we have completed our mine capacity increase from 3 million to 55 million tons with a sellable output of 26 million tons over the last 4 years.

The BHQ beneficiation progressing. Pilot plants results have delivered excellent yields and major engineering contracts are completed, construction machine mobilized. All major machines are ordered on a key European supplier, and we are well in target of first phase readiness by December 2027.

This plant, the BHQ beneficiation is a trailblazer in India and will lead to greening of our company in a steel cycle in very dramatic ways. Meanwhile in Chandrapur, the DRI capacity doubled, our power capacity has tripled to a stable 100 megawatts, sorry, and it is stabilized. The steel plant that is a blast furnace, arc furnace, coke oven and rolling mill of 1.2 million tonne wire rod is well underway for commissioning for last quarter this year. The engineering of this third pellet plant is also nearing complete in Chandrapur, along with a 195-kilometer pipeline from Hedri to Ghugus via Chandrapur stockyard. This pipeline will reduce logistic cost for most of the iron ore output by us by more than INR500 a ton and is in advanced planning stage.

A few milestones for us on the efficiency front. The EBITDA margin has held steady at approximately 34% across both the last 2 quarters, demonstrating structural cost efficiency and not one-off gains. Return on capital employed stood at 56% ex CWIP for FY '26 and return on equity at 37%. These are world-class metrics.

Pricing parity with competition is maintained along with the volume increase of 120% and new products like pellet started. Thriveni ranked number 1 among 383 open cast mines in India by the Ministry of Coal, a reflection of operational excellence across the group. Other than

Surjagarh, the growth in Thriveni operations in Odisha and Jharkhand continue with 3 new mining operations starting.

A few key updates on copper. Copper, which is a new gold and Congo, which is our new Surjagarh is led by Surya. I want to congratulate his team and him for successful commissioning of the Surya copper plant in 6 months.

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We are the first Indian integrated player in the copper business. Copper is the backbone of energy transition, electrification and renewables. It is a perfect point to our one mine portfolio and also our international entry into critical minerals. We have defined pathway to expand capacity to 30,000 tons per annum at Surya mines.

In addition, we have acquired 49% in CHEMAF Group. This is the first year after the U.S. and Congo signed a critical mineral agreement in December 2025, and we are proud to be at the forefront of the strategic realignment in global critical minerals.

CHEMAF is a large operating copper cobalt platform in the Katanga copper belt with 50-plus permits. Cobalt capacity is expected to scale to approximately 20,000 tons in the 2 operating plants. Along with this, we will be achieving 100,000 tons of copper over the next 3 to 5 years from both CHEMAF and Surya.

Let me give you our FY '27 outlook briefly. The steel markets and therefore, iron ore are as strong as ever, especially in Indian market. Our FY '27 guidance reflects the next change in our scale, iron ore production at 26 million tons, dispatches of 27 million tons, pellet of 7.75 million to 8 million tons, DRI at 825,000 tons and a formal entry into steelmaking with wire rod mill production at around 150,000 tons.

We expect annual cost savings to surpass INR2,000 crores per annum as all logistics and sustainability initiatives are maturing by March '28. FY '26 has been a year of extraordinary achievement. Our financials have never been stronger.

Our operational foundation has never been robust and our strategic pipeline in pellets -- in pellets and steel and now in copper has never

been more exciting. We remain deeply grateful to all our investors, partners and every member of our team.

Without taking more of the time, I hand over the call to Riyaz. Mr. Naredi and Mr. Hemankur will take you through the detailed financial operations of the Thriveni and the Congo operations as well. Thank you once again, everybody.

Riyaz Shaikh: Thank you, Rajesh ji. Good evening, everyone. I want to open with a line from Aristotle that I believe captures exactly what FY '26 means for us. We are what we repeatedly do. Excellence then is not an act but a habit. That is precisely the story of our FY '26 numbers. The margins you will see today are not a onetime event. They are the outcome of systems we have built, disciplines we have embedded and habits of execution that run deep across every function of this organization.

With the context, I will take you through the stand-alone financials and operating performance for Q4 and the full year FY26, focusing on the numbers, margins and capex. For the financial highlights for quarter 4 FY26 stand-alone, this has been the strongest quarter we have ever reported on a stand-alone basis.

The total income came in at INR4,977 crores, registering a remarkable 310% year-on-year growth. EBITDA was INR1,679 crores, up 498% year-on-year, a near six-fold jump in absolute Lloyds Metals and Energy Limited

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profitability. PAT stood at INR1,066 crores, up 368% year-on-year. EBITDA margin expanded to 33.73% in quarter 4, an improvement of more than 1,000 basis points year-on-year.

For the financial highlights of the full year FY26. FY26 without doubt, the best year Lloyd Metals has ever had across every single metric. Total income for FY26 stood at approximately INR13,838 crores, up 104% year-on-year. We more than doubled our revenues in a single year. EBITDA came in at INR4,673 crores, growing 133% year-on-year.

PAT was INR3,194 crores, up 120% year-on-year. EBITDA margin for the full year stood at 33.77%, up 418 basis points year-on-year. The margin improvement is not one-off. It is structural and is coming from higher share of value-added products, especially pellets in the revenue mix, benefits of the slurry pipeline, which has started flowing meaningfully into the P&L, better utilization across mining, pellets and DRI, operating leverage as volumes scale significantly.

Coming to the operational highlights of iron ore. Iron Ore production for quarter 4 FY26 was 9.09 million tons, up 529% year-on-year. For the full year, production stood at 21.96 million tons, up 120% year-on-year. Iron Ore sales volume for quarter 4 FY26 was 6.16 million tons,

up 271% year-on-year. For FY26, total sales were 16.18 million tons, up 71% year-on-year. Realization per ton stood at INR5,848 in quarter 4 and INR5,806 for the full year. EBITDA per ton was INR1,894 in quarter 4 and INR1,930 for FY26, reflecting strong unit economics. Our monthly run rate in April 2026 is already at approximately 2 million tons, underpinning a strong start for -- to FY27.

Now for the operational highlights for pellets. Pellet production for quarter 4 FY26 was 1.08 million tons and for the full year was 3.03 million tons. The pellet plant commenced commercial production at the fag end of quarter 2 FY26. Within 4 months of commissioning, it has already reached 100% capacity utilization, which is an exceptional execution outcome.

Realization per ton for quarter 4 FY26 stood at INR9,590, supported by strong product quality and strategic geographic positioning. EBITDA per ton for pellets stood at INR4,040 in quarter 4, robust margin driven by captive iron ore, slurry pipeline-based evacuation and strong domestic demand.

I'm also pleased to share that the second pellet plant was commissioned in May 2026. This takes our total pellet capacity to 8 million tons per annum and positions us strongly for FY27 volume growth. For the operational highlights of DRI a

nd Power, DRI sales volume for quarter 4 FY26 was 188,000 tons, up 171% year-on-year.

For the full year, DRI volumes were 480,000 tons, up 56% year-on-year. DRI realization stood at INR27,306 per ton in quarter 4 with EBITDA per ton of INR7,999 strong unit economics.

Power volumes were up 48% year-on-year in quarter 4 FY26.

The value-added mix. Value-added products now account for 32% of FY26 stand-alone revenues, up from 20% in FY25. In terms of EBIT contribution, the share is 30%, up from 11%

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in FY25. This mix shift is central to improving margin stability, reducing volatility and enhancing overall return metrics.

With pellet plant 2 now commissioned and the wire rod mill on track, this VAP share is expected to improve further in FY27. Coming for the capex update, the company has incurred capex of approximately INR13,500 crores during FY24 to FY26. FY26 stand-alone capex alone was close to INR8, 100, reflecting the significant investment phase we are currently in.

Key projects funded into 2 pellet plants, TRI expansion, slurry pipeline and the ongoing capex of the steel plant. Importantly, capex execution is on track and within approved budgets. To give further color on capex of INR13,500 crores, we have capitalized INR5,100 crores of assets comprising mainly of pellet plant 1, slurry pipeline and the DRI plant. INR1,850 crores is capital advances, remaining is CWIP, which you can see is in our published numbers.

The balance sheet and the net debt. Stand-alone net debt as on 31st March 2026 stands at INR3,901 crores, a manageable level given our EBITDA generation. Despite an intensive capex cycle, the balance sheet remains comfortable. Strong EBITDA has supported internal accrual-led funding and controlled leverage.

Working capital continues to be well managed, held by faster dispatch cycles and healthy demand conditions. To summarize, FY26 stand-alone performance has been extraordinary across every metric. Margins are structurally strong. Capex execution remains disciplined and the pipeline into FY '24 is the strongest it has ever been.

With that, I will hand over to Narediji for Thriveni's performance.

S.K. Naredi: Thank you, Rajeshji and Riyazji. Good evening, everyone. For us at Thriveni, growth has always been about disciplined execution, consistency and doing the fundamentals right day in and day out. Let me take you through Thriveni's performance in Q4 and the full year FY26.

Financial overview, TIEPLFY26. From a financial perspective, FY26 has been a transformational year for the Thriveni. The total income for the full year stood at approximately INR8,000 crores, to be precise INR7,997 crores with an EBITDA of INR1,990 crores and EBITDA margin of approximately 25%.

This compares to the EBITDA of INR1,062 crores and margins of approximately INR16 crores in FY25, a nearly doubling of EBITDA in a single year. In Q4 FY26 specifically, EBITDA was INR910 crores with margins of 36%, reflecting exceptional operational -- operating leverage as volumes scaled.

Cash PAT for the full year stood at INR1,196 crores with PAT margin of approximately 15%. The improvement in margins reflects better operating leverage, higher equipment utilization and continued focus on cost discipline across all project sites.

Now I'll come to the operations at Gadchiroli. The environmental capacity at Surjagarh mines has been increased from 10 million tons per annum to 55 million tons per annum, a massive regulatory win that unlocks significant volume headroom. FY27 volume growth is expected to

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be more than 75%, including BHQ, underpinned by full-scale operations at Central Hill and completion of FY27 equipment mobilization as per schedule.

We have now deployed 88 electric equipment units at the mine and 20 electrical units at the railway siding that firmly establishes our

green mining credentials. BHQ verification plant, exploration has commenced with 22 large-scale equipment mobilized, 14 mobile crushers and 26 heavy earthmoving machines are also deployed for BHQ crushing at the mine. We have also established a full EV and LNG ecosystem at Surjagarh mine, 100-ton diesel dumper has been successfully converted to LNG hybrid operation, which is a significant sustainability milestone.

Now Odisha operations. Our Odisha operations also continue to scale meaningfully. One of the MGM mines has been awarded the prestigious 5-star rating by Indian Bureau of Mines, which reflects our operational quality. Gwalior Iron Ore mine production has also been enhanced from 7.4 million tons per annum to 9 million tons per annum.

Sarojini Pradhan mine has scaled up from 0.57 million tons to 4.9 million tons per annum. These are significant capacity additions. Dalpahar iron ore mines, it's a new mine and the operations are expected to commence in Q1 of FY27 with FY27 production target of 3 million tons.

Lasarda-Pacheri mines, again, a new mine, the MDPA has been signed and operations are to commence in Q1 FY27 with the FY27 production target of 1.5 million tons per annum. Sree Metaliks mine capacity has been increased from 1.5 million tons to 1.8 million tons. Overall, the Odisha operation volumes are expected to increase by 39% year-to-year to 34 million tons to 35 million tons in FY27.

One of the mining lease, Sagasahi mine was selected for the 11th FICCI Excellence Award, an acknowledgment of our operational and sustainability standards. Now coming to coal. Thriveni Sainik Mining, our subsidiary, PB West and PB Northwest, PB West has achieved the highest distinction of the 5-star rating from the Ministry of Coal, ranking number 1 among 383 open cast mines across India, which is an extraordinary distinction.

PB Mine was also awarded the overall winner at the 68th Annual Mine Safety Week, receiving the Suraksha Shikhar Gold Award. Iron Ore set a national record in FY25, '26, completing over 1,400 houses, which is 143% of the previous year's target and acquiring over 420 acres of land, which is 103% of the target.

A record yearly performance at PB West that OB removal has been at 72.8 million BCM. Coal production was 17.5 million tons, coal crushing and dispatch 17.4 million tons. IPCC commissioned on 11th August '25, handling 2.89 million tons. Electrical loading 21.8 million BCM that is up by 80% year-on-year. Electric drill 1.5 lakh meters, that is up 45% year-on-year. Wireless communication system implemented across all HEMM and mid-scale equipment.

Now coming to international and new ventures. International, on Indonesia, we are rationalizing lower-margin operations and plan to redeploy equipment to higher return opportunities in Congo and PNG. On Geomysore Gold Mining, our MDO and exploration contract commenced in Lloyds Metals and Energy Limited

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January '26, we have a targeted EBITDA contribution of approximately INR60 crores in FY27, a meaningful new revenue stream with further upside as exploration progresses.

Outlook. Thriveni's focus remains clear, scale responsibly, execute efficiently and protect margins through productivity and cost optimization. The pipeline for FY27 looks strong across Gadchiroli, Odisha and coal operations. We are confident of sustaining both growth and profitability.

With that, I hand over the mic to Hemankur sir. Thank you.

Hemankur: Yes. Hello. We'll open up for the questions.

Moderator: Thank you. The first question is from the line of Amit Dixit from GS. Please go ahead.

Amit Dixit: Yes, hi. Good evening, everyone and congratulations for good performance. A couple of questions from my side. The first one is on Slide number 25, where you have this arrangement with Tata Steel on the BRPL project.

Just wanted to understand the economics of this because you have mentioned that the free cash and the

profit accruing to us is quite substantial. So just wanted to understand the capex part of it and how we are looking at operations to ensure that these kind of numbers in terms of free cash accrue to us?

Management: Thanks, Amit, for the question. So as you rightly said, I mean, this is a business which is already in place. So for generating this kind of free cash flow, the amount of sustaining capex is not much. So that's why the free cash flows are high because this is a take-or-pay contract that we

have with Tata Steel as a captive consumer.

This is of great strategic benefit to Tata Steel because this operates a pipeline, which is near about the mine mouth of their existing mines and it opens up near the Kalinganagar plant within the 5-kilometer radius. So because of which the entire capacity is dedicated to them. And as a part of our shareholder agreement, this was agreed as a margin for the existing assets. So that's why this is a large amount of free cash flow.

You would also recall that we had signed an MOU with Tata Steel for evaluating multiple projects, which involved some of the projects that we'll be picking up with them. It involved working on slurry pipelines for their projects. It involved steel plant facility in Gadchiroli and it also involved new MDO projects that we'll be doing with them. So given all of that, we are progressing on some of those projects.

So as of now, those projects, capex is still being finalized because they are still in the discussion and finalization stage. But some of these free cash flow will go towards generation and development of those projects. But we have -- we intend to maintain high return on capital for such projects so that it is deployed and suitable for maintaining the high return on capital that we have.

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Amit Dixit: Sir, just a related question to this because our expertise in laying slurry pipeline in record time is quite well documented. So is there some exclusivity that you have with Tata Steel or you can approach any other steel player because a lot of them are looking for....?

Rajesh Gupta: No, there is no exclusivity.

Amit Dixit: Okay, okay, okay. The second question I have is on the Congo operations and congratulations for starting the copper operations over there. Just wondering what kind of incremental capex you expect to incur in both copper and cobalt project to reach the capacities that you have mentioned?

Also on the related note, this geography is not the easiest one to work. So what specific steps you are taking to ensure that -- because you have started operations and I would say I don't recall any other company that has done that in such a small time.

Management: Yes. So thanks again, Amit. Yes, definitely, it's a new territory, and that's why the new opportunities are coming out of it. And that's why we see that this was a very unique case which presented us an asset which was near operational. So to answer the first question, how much capital expenditure will be required? This plant is near about 85% to 90% complete. We are already engaging with the EPC players. These are world-class EPC players. So we are getting them back on the ground. I think within this month, we are getting them up and running.

In terms of completion of the plant, the total plant capex initially was near about \$1.1 billion, out of which \$800-plus million has already been spent. Based on our current evaluation, including the initial working capital and the mine development, which will be treating these plants, it would require near about \$200 million to \$260 million. We are still working on the exact numbers, but this is a fairly broad estimate which can be taken at the moment.

In terms of players who are operating and working in the mines in Congo, it's a fairly established mining destination. It had its challenges earlier. But given the rising demand of copper and cobalt

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as a strategic material for defense products, particularly apart from the batteries, this is something which is of great importance to U.S.

So U.S. because, I mean, U.S. has also started realizing that a lot of supply chain of critical minerals is basically residing with China. And whenever the tariff barriers and different problems happened, they saw that the supply chain can be choked. So that was one of the key things which kind of drove us to this because having this kind of an asset at such a large scale, yes, you're right, it is a high risk if we were doing it alone.

But that risk is mitigated by the fact that we are partnering with the U.S. and U.S. has a strategic and critical minerals deal, which was signed in 2025. So in fact, we have very strong support from U.S. and given the kind of support that U.S. is building with DRC, there is a strong cooperation. And this is the first project under this, so flagship project. So it becomes derisked by the same amount.

It's something what you can probably see with Surjagarh, like it was one of the first projects that we opened up here. So of course, risk was there, but this was the first project in Maharashtra. So for Maharashtra Iron ore was new. And now Maharashtra is looking at opening up many more

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mines and coming up additional iron ore. So this gives us a good entry and also helps us build a very strong partnership with U.S. because they see us as reliable, credible operator.

So in difficult terrains wherever the U.S. companies are not able to operate or not able to scale

as fast as they would want the supply chains to be built, we would be a partner of choice. So this is an alternate to China on the global scale, and that's why we see this partnership is something which will be quite important and also derisked in the entire process because of the presence of U.S.

Moderator: The next question is from the line of Vikas Singh from ICICI Securities.

Vikas Singh: Congratulations on very good set of numbers. Sir, my first question pertains to Thriveni. If I look at our iron ore ramp-up has been largely been done, while the coal has not been ramping up. So are we going to expect volume growth in this segment? Because if I remember correctly, a couple of quarters back, we have given a pretty good numbers in terms of revenue guidance on the Thriveni side. And what has caused this margin expansion on the year-on-year basis from EBITDA margin of 16% to 26%?

Rajesh Gupta: In iron ore, we are starting 2 new mining leases. And for the other mining leases where we are already doing, we have got the environmental clearances enhancement. And due to that, the iron ore production is going to be higher as compared to the earlier year. And in respect of coal, as we stated, Indonesian operations, we are slightly slowing down due to lower margins.

And Jharkhand operations, the contract volumes and all these things we are achieving. So yes, we'll be increasing our revenues quantity in iron ore more as compared to coal. And Surjagarh also, we have got a large expansion. So there also, we are going to increase it. So this is the reason that iron ore expansion will be much more as compared to coal.

Vikas Singh: Okay. Sir, just a follow-up question on this. In the remarks, somebody said that 37%, 39% higher iron ore production could be there. Would our revenue follow the similar model or the rates are different and revenue growth would be lower than that?

Rajesh Gupta: No, no, revenue growth will be there, and we'll be getting the benefit of economies of scale. So our revenues will be much, much better.

Vikas Singh: So would that go in tandem with the volume assuming the same kind of rates we are getting across the board or the intensity would be lower than the volume growth? That's what I was asking effectively.

Rajesh Gupta: More or less, it will be the same.

Riyaz Shaikh: To

p line would be more or less the same. Bottom line will be faster because of economies of scale.

Vikas Singh: Noted, sir. Sir, my second question pertains to our realization this quarter. If I see iron ore and pellet, there was a deviation. One has gone up on a sequential basis while the pellet realization

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has gone down, which is a little bit surprising. So could you explain what has happened there?

And what is the spot realization? Have you also taken price hike today?

Rajesh Gupta: What has gone down?

Vikas Singh: Sir, pellet realization sequentially was down as per our own presentation, while the iron ore has been up sharply. So just wanted to understand...

Rajesh Gupta: As volumes have gone up in pellet, we have had to search new markets, and that is why the pellet realizations are a little lower because the newer markets are at a distance. Some tenders were there earlier, which we have not been able to re-establish again. And we've been doing a little bit more export. On the pricing of iron ore, it's more or less driven by the market. We are in line with the rest of the market and the steel market.

Vikas Singh: Noted, sir. And sir, lastly, if you could give us some update on your BHQ project because next year, if I remember correctly, we wanted to do more of a low-grade beneficiation versus the high-grade sales.

Rajesh Gupta: So our -- in my opening remarks, I mentioned that by December 2027, BHQ first phase of 30 million tons input and around 12 million tons output would be commissioned. And the land is with us. The equipment has been mobilized -- the construction equipment has been mobilized. The crushing of the material has started, and we'll be pushing the material on to the site and getting it evacuated from the site in this year.

And over the next 2 years, that material will be accumulated there. And as far as the project itself is concerned, we are going ahead with -- the total engineering is more or less complete. The main ordering of 85%, 90% has been ordered with 5-star parties. The pellet plant has helped us a lot in establishing the final engineering, and that is the status.

Vikas Singh: Since we are beneficiating and the mining ratio to output is lower, do we expect that once the BHQ picks up our overall blended EBITDA per ton on the iron ore side at least would settle on a lower scale?

Rajesh Gupta: We think it's on a higher scale because BHQ beneficiated ore will be 66%, 67%. The cost upside is around INR200, INR300, I think we explained in the last con-call and particularly with the revised notification of the government on reduced royalties. So the upside on the cost will be around INR200, INR300. The upside on the selling price or on the usage level, even if we do it

internally, will be at INR700, INR800. So we think that the EBITDA will go up once the BHQ is commissioned.

Vikas Singh: Sir, wouldn't the mining cost per ton of the final material would be 3x higher, 2.5x higher, so that should get added in the cost, not only under beneficiation?

Rajesh Gupta: Much bigger scale volumes. So we would have -- like I said, the total cost would be in that range that I just mentioned. And the royalties are much less.

Vikas Singh: This is adjusted for the mining ratio you're talking about.

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Rajesh Gupta: Absolutely. I'm talking about net visible ore.

Moderator: The next question is from the line of Jashandeep Singh from Nomura.

Jashandeep Singh: Congratulations for a great set of results. Sir, my first question is regarding capex. You were highlighting how much capex will be required for the second copper stream that you have entered. I just wanted to understand with that in mind, what will be our FY27, '28 capex guidance for consol Lloyds now?

And in line with that, with capex increasing, the earnings are also increasing significantl

y, but

what will be sustainable net debt to EBITDA or leverage numbers for the company? And is the company looking for any deleveraging in FY27-'28? That will be my first question.

Riyaz Shaikh: Thanks Jashandeep. The total capex excluding the ISP for the Konsari unit is around INR28,000 crores is what we have of which we have already spent, as I mentioned earlier is INR13,500-odd crores. So that remains with the INR14,500 crores to be spent over the next 2 years.

Next year, our plan is around between INR10,000 crores to INR11,000 crores is what we are planning to spend because that will include a lot of portion from the BHQ plant and the ISP at Chandrapur. It should be around INR10,500 crores. And next year, it should be INR12,500 crores plus, yes, in '27, '28 by that time, we would be clear on the larger steel plant at Konsari and also the copper. So all those expenditures will be further included in this and should be a larger number.

Jashandeep Chadha: Sir, largely copper capex will start from FY28, is that right? And also on deleveraging or your sustainable net debt to EBITDA?

Rajesh Gupta: FY27 also, there will be copper investments. Yes.

Management: So actually, majority of the copper investment will get done in FY27. So we should have the revenues and profitability from copper coming in from FY28 because as I said the plants are near about 85% to 90% complete. So we want to get them running ASAP and that's why a large part of the capex will actually be done this year.

Rajesh Gupta: And to this we would have to add Thriveni capex. Although, since you asked for consolidated, Thriveni capex would be around INR1,000 crores this year in the coming year -- this current year.

Jashandeep Chadha: And the INR10,000 crores to INR11,000 crores also includes Thriveni and copper there, is my understanding right, sir?

Riyaz Shaikh: No. That's on a standalone basis.

Jashandeep Chadha: Sir, how much will be console?

Riyaz Shaikh: In terms of capex, you are asking? So basically, on a console basis, copper will be as I mentioned earlier near about USD200 million to USD260 million. So we can add near about INR2,000 crores for that.

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Rajesh Gupta: INR15,000 crores roughly.

Management: Console number 15000 crores for capex in this 26-27.

Jashandeep Chadha: And any plan of deleverging Thriveni because most of the debt on the console book is from Thriveni. So any plan for the next 2 years to reduce the debt on Thriveni? And what is your target net debt to EBITDA that the management is internally working with?

Riyaz Shaikh: Thriveni debt, yes, we are looking at. We have plans of reducing RPS as it was just paid around INR700-odd crores in this month of April for the RPS. So that INR2,100 crores in the debt is RPS of which INR700 crores is RPS. Over the next 3 years, the INR2,000 crores reduces the debt automatically comes down and the regular payments are also.

Jashandeep Chadha: Understood. And sir, my last question, again, because Lloyd is expanding and growing at such a rapid pace, will all the capex, will the company be able to manage all the capex for internal accruals or is there a plan or is management looking towards raising some more capital either through debt or equity in near future? How is management looking towards it?

Riyaz Shaikh: Yes, debt we would be raising. As we have mentioned, we should have a proper mix of debt.

The debt should be around 1, 1.5x of the EBITDA, not more than that. That is what our numbers

would be. Equity as of now, we've not planned of anything and we don't -- in near future, so we don't intend on that.

Rajesh Gupta: Any equity would be if ever would be in the books of Thriveni if we go for an IPO in that company at a later stage, not in this year.

Jashandeep Chadha: Understood, sir. And sir, my last question will be largely towards the new government regulation, which came, which is no

w is fixing ASP for iron ore grade below 45% with the close to two-third of your reserves being in that category. While I understand beneficiation will be there and you will be selling, output will be higher grade. But just wanted to understand how does that regulation or how does the management look at that regulation, whether they will benefit in terms of royalty or whether there will be benefit in more offtakes happening of the lower grade? Just wanted to understand that?

Rajesh Gupta: So the royalty is paid on material going out of the mine and the lower grade of less than 45 or less than 35 would be going out of the mine and paying a royalty at the rate of 50% or 75%, respectively. So that would reduce our BHQ output cost to the BHQ plant. So it helps us in terms of reduction of cost.

Jashandeep Chadha: Understood, sir. And just one last question. Sir mentioned that INR2,000 per tonne saving coming from largely from transport. can you have a breakdown of that and how much will be coming from which this particular plant?

Rajesh Gupta: I mentioned INR2,000 crores over the next -- once the second pipeline is commissioned from Hedri to Ghugus via the Chandrapur stockyard, all our 16 million tonnes of material, which is now being transported to the railway sidings or to various customers by truck, INR600 to, INR500 a ton would be saved, so that itself is INR1,000 crores plus whatever pipeline we're

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already doing right now plus our solar projects and other green initiatives plus various initiatives during all the sites. So we have calculated a total of INR2,000 crores per year going forward from 2028 onwards.

Jashandeep Chadha: Understood, sir. Thank you so much for this and I will join back the queue.

Moderator: Thank you. The next question is from the line of Ritesh Bhagwati from Alpha Plus Capital.

Ritesh Bhagwati: Thanks for taking my question and first of all, congrats on great set of numbers. Firstly, it is in regards to our DRC assets. So we saw our commercial production of 12,000 ton per annum copper cathode plant at Surya Mine got commissioned in March '26. And plus we have done an acquisition of another 49% stake in Chemaf.

So what I want to, first of all, understand is how are we seeing this ramp-up of 10,000 tons per annum to 30,000 tons per annum happening? So what is the time line for that? Secondly, what I also want to understand is how are we seeing this integration of DRC assets happening and what sort of revenue and EBITDA contribution can we see in this financial year?

Management: Thank you. So I'll explain on both the assets. So the first asset actually was commissioned and started producing copper plates in March 2026. So we have produced near about 700 to 750 tons of copper as of date. The plant as per budget is able to produce near about 40 to 45 tons per day. We are having certain supply shortages on the sulfuric acid because it's an inland country. So because of it, there is a slightly lower volume than expected. But good thing is that with the plant that we acquired the other company, we have a sulfuric acid plant. So we are now continuing to supply sulfuric acid from that. So there is synergy between the two companies. So with that, I think we are looking at producing a total of around 9,000 to 10,000 tons of copper for the financial year ending this year.

Chemaf will not produce anything this year. It is expected to start production meaningfully by July of 2027 when the plants are expected to be commissioned. So a big uplift will come when those plants are completed and they start operating fully. They are fully integrated plants in terms of mine next to the plants. So we'll have near about 90,000 tonnes of copper production but starting from July 2027. Until then, we'll have around 800 to 900 tons of copper that we expect once we solve the sulfuric acid problems, which should be sorted

in the next 3 months. So that's broadly the production profile for the Congo assets.

Ritesh Bhagwati: So basically, I want to understand our stake acquisition that we have done for Lloyds Panguna, which we will engage with Bougainville Copper Limited. So if you can just provide some clarity on the strategy road map, anticipated time line for securing mining rights?

Rajesh Gupta: No asset has been taken over. It's -- we have created a company for future actions in that country. It is a very active -- was a very active mine 40 years back with port built, roads built and the mine commissioned and well established, etcetera, with fairly rich copper and gold deposit, but it's still in the discussion stage. We have got the rights only and nothing has been acquired and we, like I say, setting our foot into the area.

Ritesh Bhagwati: Okay. So just lastly, on our pellet plant. So like we have recently commissioned our second pellet plant as well. So what I want to understand is when do we expect both pellet plants together to reach the expanded capacity of 10 million tons per annum from our original 8 million tons per annum?

Rajesh Gupta: It's 8 million tons. 2 x 4, 8 million tons. The first plant -- the first 9 months of operation has achieved 3 million tons, which is within the capacity. We hope to repeat that in the second plant as well. And therefore, we hope to achieve 7.5 million to 8 million tons in this complete year.

Ritesh Bhagwati: Okay. Thanks a lot. That's it from my end.

Moderator: Thank you. The next question is from the line of Stuti Agarwal from Chhatisgarh Investments..

Stuti Agarwal: Yes. Firstly, congratulations for the team for the great set of numbers. Sir, my first question is the receivables increased from INR171 crores to INR1,480 crores on a consolidated number that is 3.24x. So is this from the Thriveni or from standalone mix?

Management: Last year, it was not a consolidated. Thriveni is just acquired in this year. So only 9 months have been consolidated. So if you're looking at the consolidated numbers, then it is not comparable if you compare it to the last year.

Stuti Agarwal: Okay. Got it. Thank you.

Moderator: Thank you. The next question is from the line of Parth Kotak from Plus91 Asset Management. Please go ahead.

Parth Kotak: Hi, thanks for taking mine and congratulations for a good set of numbers. Sir, actually, I have a couple of questions. The first one is an extension to the previous participant's question. I understand that now since MDO is integrated with our operations, if you could just give a bit of colour on our receivable days and inventory days and payable days for the consolidated entity going ahead. And second, sir, if you could just on an accounting side, provide the number for IPS benefit this year, it would be really helpful?

Rajesh Gupta: On the IPS benefits, basically, it is right now around 1 year in accrual, 1 year post the claim to be made. The claim would be made in June. for the last year. So we would get the money in June 2027 for current year. We're trying to see how that can be expedited. For the consolidated receivables data, I think this question is a very interesting question. We don't have a clear cut answer on why exactly that movement is there. We'll come back very shortly on that.

Riyaz Shaikh: In Thriveni, receivables is 15 to 30 days.

Rajesh Gupta: In Thriveni, the receivables are 15 to 30 days.

Riyaz Shaikh: Private miner owners, but in coal it is 15 days,

Rajesh Gupta: So we have to -- and so it is similar in Lloyd Metals. We'll figure out exactly the reasoning behind it and come back.

Moderator: Thank you. The next question is from the line of Amay Sharda from Purnartha Investment Advisors. Amay sir could you please go ahead. Since there is no reply from the line of Mr. Amay Sharda

. The next question which is from Harsh Shah from Seven Rivers Holding. Please go ahead.

Harsh Shah: Yes. Hi, good afternoon, sir. Sir in your slide you have given a guidance of 26 million tons for FY27 production of iron ore. Can you give us a split how much of this will be consumed internally for the downstream products, and what will be sold outside?

Rajesh Gupta: Around 8.85 million tons -- 8.8 million ton will be consumed internally for the pellet plant. And the DRI plant another 200,000 tons. So around 9 million tons will be consumed this year internally pellet plus DRI. Part of the pellet could also be consumed internally is the steel -- in the DRI plant.

Harsh Shah: Thank you.

Moderator: The next question is from the line of Siddharth Gadekar from Equirus Securities Limited. Please go ahead.

Siddharth Gadekar: Sir, first on the Chemaf acquisition, can you just speak on the debt that we have acquired with that entity? And how should one think about that?

Management: Yes. Thank you. I mean, yes, I think that needs a little bit of clarity because otherwise it may look that we have acquired a lot of debt. So we have become owners of the company. So, of course, the company was under stress. So there's a lot of debt which has accrued built up and they have spent that on the plant.

But as a part of the overall negotiation process, we have also made settlement agreements with the key creditors. So actually, the total debt which is there on the books of Chemaf is around USD800 million. Large creditors, mostly we have negotiated. And effectively, once we pay out

those creditors, this debt will be reduced by 475 million. So that's the amount of negotiation that has been done.

And the balance of the debt which will be remaining on the books, which is near about USD330 million, that is fully non-recourse and it will stay at the company level at Chemaf. Also, we are negotiating on that with some of the smaller parties, which are there. So we'll go through that process and possibly we can also receive some benefits from there. So that's broadly the current debt. For completing the plant, possibly we'll borrow additional \$200 million, which will also be nonrecourse to LMEL and borrowed at the asset level because the asset itself is near about \$1 billion, which is already put on the ground.

Siddharth Gadekar: So secondly, in terms of the ramp-up on Chemaf, how should one think about the ramp-up in this asset?

Riyaz Shaikh: So as I answered earlier, I mean, July 2027, we should see reasonably full commercial scale production. So we should be producing near about 8,000 tons of copper, including the Surya mine. So only Chemaf itself, it will be near about 6,000 to 5,500 tons per month.

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Siddharth Gadekar: Sir, and the entire debt will get consolidated into our console balance sheet or how should one think about that?

Riyaz Shaikh: Yes, that's right. So although we own 49%, but because we are having the operational control on the ground and we are the ones who are running the operations, which is typically for us as something which we like and control because effectively we need the operational controls to make the assets worth. So that is why because of that reason, even though we are 49%, we have operational control and thus it gets consolidated into our books.

Siddharth Gadekar: Okay. Sir, lastly, on the standalone operations on the pellet, we have spoken about some debottlenecking that we were doing on the standalone operation. So when should we start seeing the benefit of that debottlenecking coming in?

Rajesh Gupta: We are studying and applying to the government for relevant permissions. We should get that by year-end by FY'27, so next year we will see an increased production in that.

Siddharth Gadekar: So that will be for both the pellet plant or only the first pellet plant?

Riyaz Shaikh: Yes, both the pellet plants

Siddharth Gadekar: So effectively, we can go to 10 million tons of pellet capacity with these two plants?

Rajesh Gupta: No guidance on that, but yes, that is the target.

Siddharth Gadekar: Okay. Got it. Thank you so much.

Moderator: Thank you. The next question is from the line of from Netra Deshpande from Mirae Asset Sharekhan. Please go ahead.

Netra Deshpande: Good evening sir. Congratulations to you all for remarkable set of numbers, and metallic numbers for FY26. So to start with the first question, just would like to know, as have already said the estimated phase for the second cost and for the extending costs and what would be the timeline for that as the slurry pipeline for the project, the phase 1, the cost and already it was all clear in the earlier session. So can you throw some light?

Riyaz Shaikh: We're not able to understand the thing -- can you please?

Netra Deshpande: So what would be Phase 2 cost of and the time line for the overall total project for the slurry pipeline, capacity of utilization and overall volume. total take up and ramping up.

Riyaz Shaikh: The Phase 2 slurry pipeline is the 16 million tons what we are planning. This is -- the plants for the entire capex to be completed within 2 years, as we mentioned earlier also.

Netra Deshpande: Okay. And my next question is about what would be the revenue growth in terms of volume of iron ore and value-added products for FY27 and FY28?

Rajesh Gupta: There is no increase in volume. This is the maximized volume that we have. FY27 we just discussed. FY28 our steel plant would be operational fully. So we'll be having a production of 1

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million tons which is 75%, 80% of the capacity. Plus the pellet plant would be producing at 8 million, 9 million tons. So that will be the value added product range and relevantly DRI and pig iron etcetra would be also reproduced according to that.

Netra Deshpande: Okay. Thank you. And sir one more which is what would be the intersegment segment in terms of captive iron ore that they are using because after the exhibition as we can see that inter-segment revenue have ramped up. It is somewhere around 4000 crores FY26. So what would be for Thriveni MDO intra-group dealing worth something for FY27 and if you can put some light because captive transfer of INR907 crores, which we can see the reflection in this?

Rajesh Gupta: I don't think we are ready with that exact figure that you're looking for. We'll come back shortly on that.

Moderator: Thank you. The next question is from the line of Vedant Sarda from Nirmal Bang Securities Private Limited. Please go ahead.

Vedant Sarda: Thank you for the opportunity and congratulations on great results. Sir, we have guided 26 million ton of iron ore and double down on our pellet production and DRI production for FY'27.

So can you broadly tell us the revenue growth and EBITDA growth for FY27 on the current realization of iron ore?

Rajesh Gupta: I think the figures are all with you. We leave it to the analysts to analyze and confirm the figures.

Moderator: Thank you. The next question is from the line of Tanmay Chaudhary from Dolat Capital.

Tanmay Chaudhary: Hi, sir. Thank you for the opportunity. Sir, my first question is on the logistics side like what are our evacuation plan through the pipeline and the trucks and railway siding and specifically for feeding our recently commenced pellet plant?

Rajesh Gupta: Your question is not very clear, sir. Can you repeat it?

Tanmay Chaudhary: Yes, sir. I'm asking on the evacuation plant to the pipeline and on the transport side, like for feeding our recently commenced pellet plant?

Rajesh Gupta: So the recently commissioned pellet plant is being fed by the pipeline that was commissioned around a year back. The same pipeline is now feeding both the pellet plants that are commissioned. This product is being evacuated either by truck or by --

from a railway siding,

which is around 80 kilometers, 70 kilometers away. That's as far the evacuation for the current pellet plant and material into the pellet plant is concerned. Does it answer the question?

Moderator: Sir the line has dropped. Ladies and gentlemen, we take this as a last question. I now hand the conference over to the management for closing comments.

Riyaz Shaikh: Thank you, everybody. I guess we were able to reply to all your questions and queries. Once again, thanks, everybody. And if you have any further questions, you can get in touch with Mr.

Chintan Mehta or myself so that we can give you all the further reply. So thank you once again for participating and thank you, Equirus team for hosting us.

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Management: Thank you, sir.

Moderator: Thank you. On behalf of Equirus Securities Private Limited, that concludes this conference. Thank you for joining us. You may now disconnect your lines.